MONDAY
October 5, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
20 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 236
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

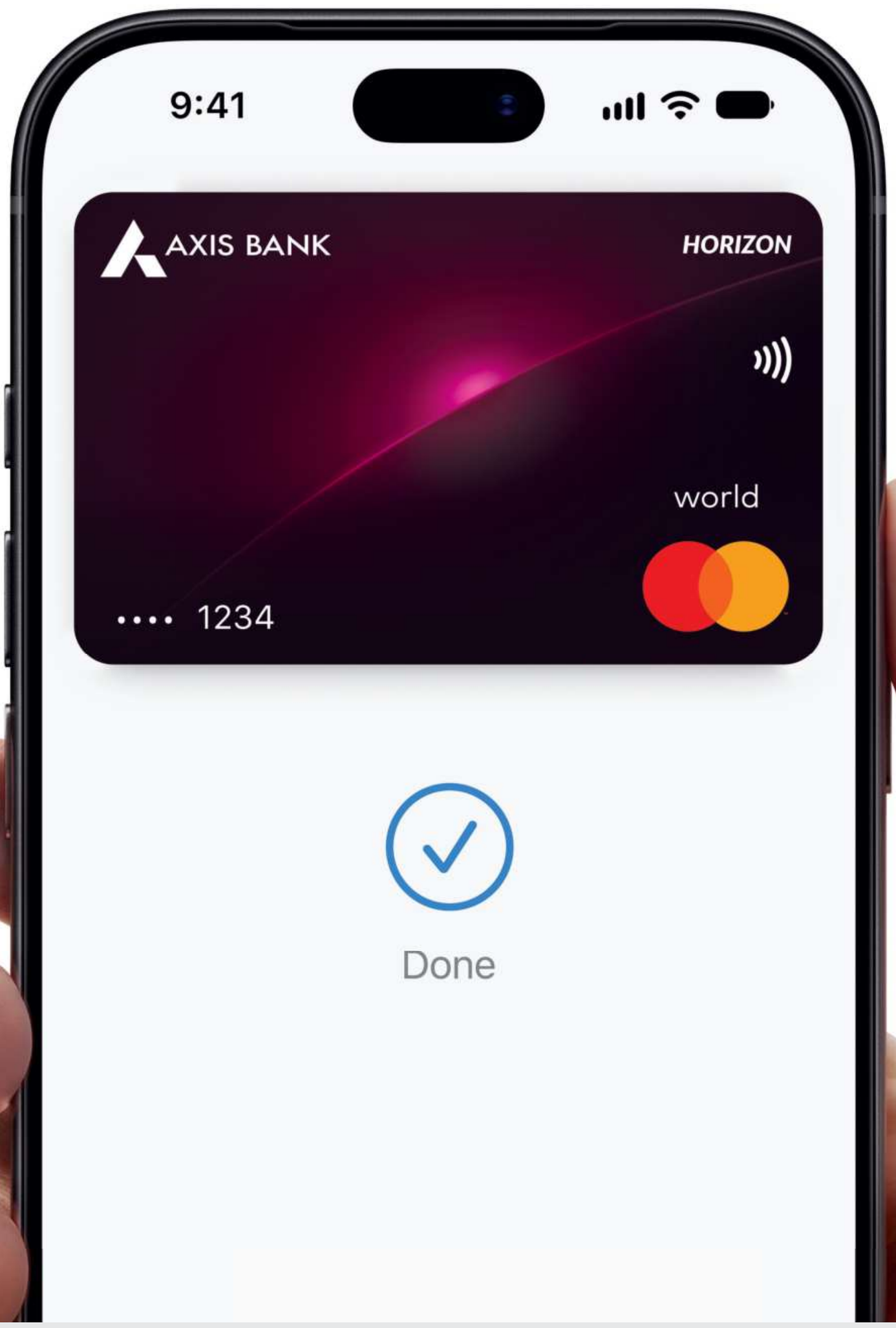
To subscribe,
give a missed call at
9828331787
or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna

AXIS BANK | Pay

Apple Pay is now in India.
With Axis Bank Credit Cards.

Now you can experience Apple Pay with Axis Bank Credit Cards.
It's an easy, secure and private way to pay.



T&C Apply. Apple Pay is available on Axis Bank Credit Cards across Mastercard & Visa networks.

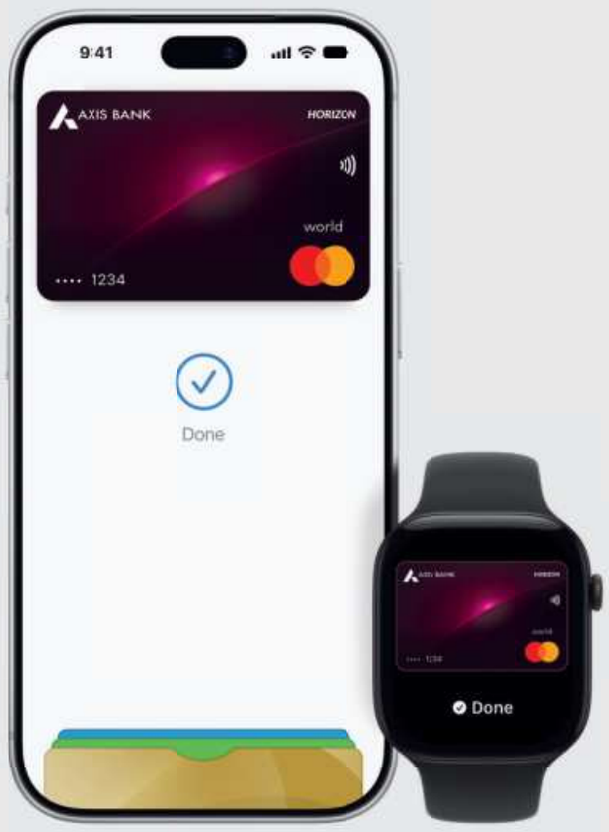
DON'T HAVE AN AXIS BANK CREDIT CARD? APPLY NOW

ADD AXIS BANK CREDIT CARD TO APPLE WALLET

TO KNOW MORE, VISIT
www.axis.bank.in/applepay

APPLE PAY ON ONE. APPLE PAY ON ALL.

Apple Pay makes it easy to pay with your Axis Bank Credit Card on your iPhone and Apple Watch.



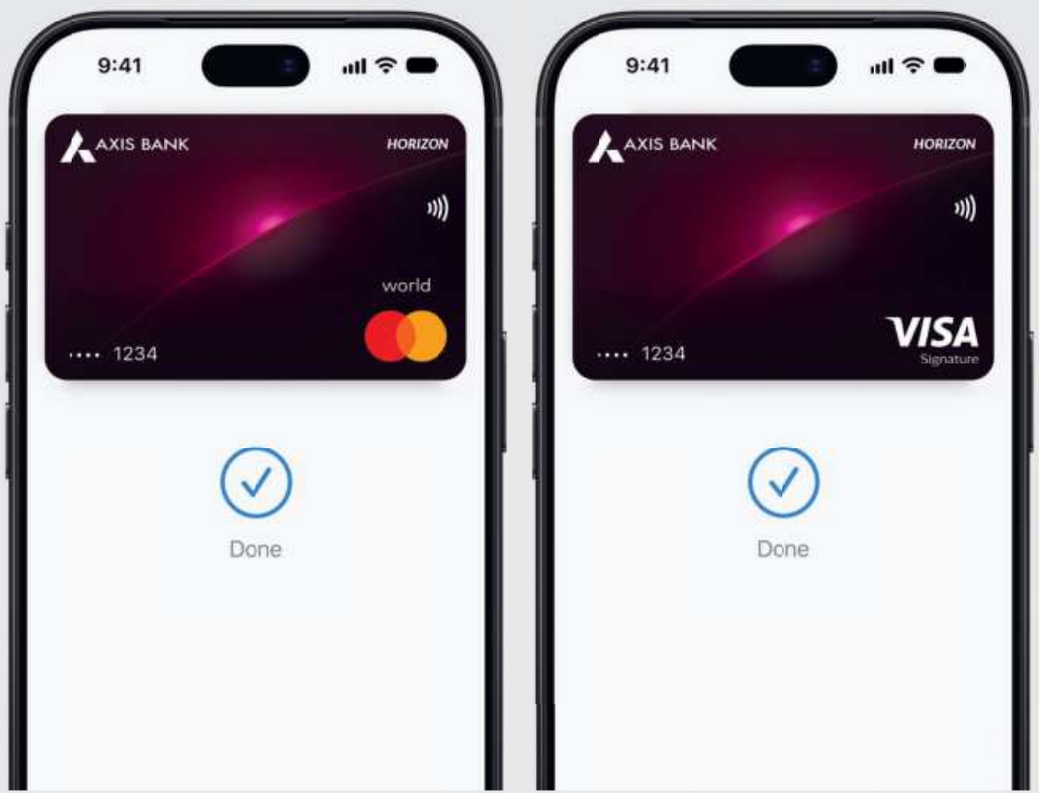


DESIGNED TO BE SECURE. SO ONLY YOU CAN PAY.

Apple Pay uses security features built into your supported Apple device, including Face ID, Touch ID – so only you can authorize payments with your Axis Bank Credit Card.

THE CARD BENEFITS YOU LOVE.

When you use your Axis Bank Credit Card with Apple Pay, you'll enjoy the features and benefits you love - just like you would with your physical card.



T&C Apply. Apple Pay is available on Axis Bank Credit Cards across Mastercard & Visa networks.

AXIS BANK

DON'T HAVE AN AXIS BANK CREDIT CARD? APPLY NOW

ADD AXIS BANK CREDIT CARD TO APPLE WALLET

TO KNOW MORE, VISIT
www.axis.bank.in/applepay

MONDAY
October 5, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
20 Pages ₹ 5.00

THE HINDU

www.thehindu.com

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Vol. 149 • No. 236
Regd. TN/ARD/110/2024-2026
RNI No. 1001/1957

To subscribe, give a missed call at 9828331787 or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna



'EXTREMIST AMBUSH'

Abducted man found dead in Manipur

NEWS » PAGE 10



IMPROVEMENTS PROPOSED

Services 'review' Agnipath as tenure of first batch ends

NEWS » PAGE 10



FOCUS ON NEGOTIATIONS

No military solution to war, says Iran Minister

WORLD » PAGE 14

UNILATERAL DECISIONS

An appalling state of affairs

Election Commission's conduct of SIR raises serious questions

EDITORIAL » PAGE 8



IRANI CUP

Mukesh and Akash bowl RoI to victory

SPORT » PAGE 16

Over 500 detained amid stir against CEC in Delhi

Police clash with protesters trying to reach heavily barricaded Jantar Mantar; BJP using Gyanesh Kumar to 'take away the right to vote', says Uddhav protesting with Opposition parties in Mumbai

Lavpreet Kaur
Chinmay Gaikwad
NEW DELHI/MUMBAI



AISA leader Neha Bora climbs a police barricade as protesters attempt to march towards Jantar Mantar on Sunday. PTI

Protests seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and the suspension of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls entered their third day on Sunday, with demonstrations continuing in New Delhi and Mumbai.

The protests, which began on Friday, included leaders of Opposition parties, civil society activists, and members of youth and student organisations.

On Sunday, confrontations took place in New Delhi between protesters, who were trying to reach Jantar Mantar, and the Delhi Police, who had heavily barricaded the area. The police stopped the march on Ashoka Road and detained around 500 people. A Delhi Police official said 110 detentions were recorded.

In Mumbai, Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray and Maharashtra Navnirman Sena chief Raj Thackeray led a march seeking the CEC's removal and the scrapping of the SIR. The Shiv Sena (UBT) chief described the CEC as a "weapon" in the hands of the BJP and claimed that the ruling party was using him to "take away the right to vote". "You can control institutions, but streets belong to us," he said, adding that the removal of "around 13 crore names" from draft rolls across the country amounted to disenfranchisement.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10

Disenfranchising people a violative act, says SC judge

NEW DELHI

Stressing that disenfranchising millions was an "intrinsically arbitrary" act, Justice Ujjal Bhuyan of the Supreme Court on Sunday said that any process that makes people second class citizens was violative of right to equality. He was speaking at the NALSAR in Hyderabad. » PAGE 11

NEARBY



Bypoll campaign draws to a close

CHENNAI

The high-decibel campaign for byelections in the Assembly segments of Madurantakam and Dharapuram ended on Sunday. » PAGE 6

Plea filed against *Vettri Payanam*

CHENNAI

A petition in the Madras High Court has challenged the constitutional validity of the government's *Vettri Payanam* scheme. » PAGE 6

EDUCATIONPLUS » PAGE 5

Keralam orders graft inquiry against CEC

G. Anand
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM



Gyanesh Kumar

Amid protests seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, the Congress-led government in Keralam on Sunday sought to revive a 20-year-old corruption allegation against him, when he was the State's Public Works Department secretary, by ordering a preliminary inquiry by the Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB).

Keralam Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala's office told *The Hindu* that the Minister had ordered VACB Director Manoj Abraham to investigate the accusation that persistent efforts to extort bribes from PATBEL consortium, an Indo-Malaysian firm contracted under the Kerala State Transport Project, allegedly resulted in significant losses to the exchequer and the suspected death by suicide of Lee See Been, the project's chief engineer, in Kuala Lumpur, in November 2006.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10
SUICIDE ABETMENT CASE » PAGE 7

FIR against Karnataka BJP agent for over 7,500 Form 7s

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

A first information report has been registered against a booth-level agent (BLA) of the Bharatiya Janata Party in Karnataka after he repeatedly attempted to file Form 7 applications against more than 7,500 electors in the Ballari City Assembly constituency claiming they were either "absent or had shifted". After his claims were rejected, the BLA, T. Srinivas Mothkur, sought "revision" of their names by submitting objections, even though the electors figured in the draft roll.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 7

Talking to both Kyiv, Moscow: Jaishankar

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI



S. Jaishankar

India is going "beyond advocacy" on the Russia-Ukraine conflict, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar said on Sunday, indicating for the first time that New Delhi is involved in conveying messages between Moscow and Kyiv on agreements for maritime safety in the Black Sea and grain export.

Speaking at a German think tank's event, Mr. Jaishankar responded to questions about India's close ties with Russia by pointing out that it has "stood by India" in difficult times. He also took aim at global superpowers, calling the U.S. a "lonelier power", while China sets itself apart as a "unique country". He suggested that other countries could seek to build coalitions to work on issues like international peace and security.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10
MEETING WITH PAPARO » PAGE 12

Four children drown in lake in Chromepet

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The residents alerted the police that four bodies were floating in the lake

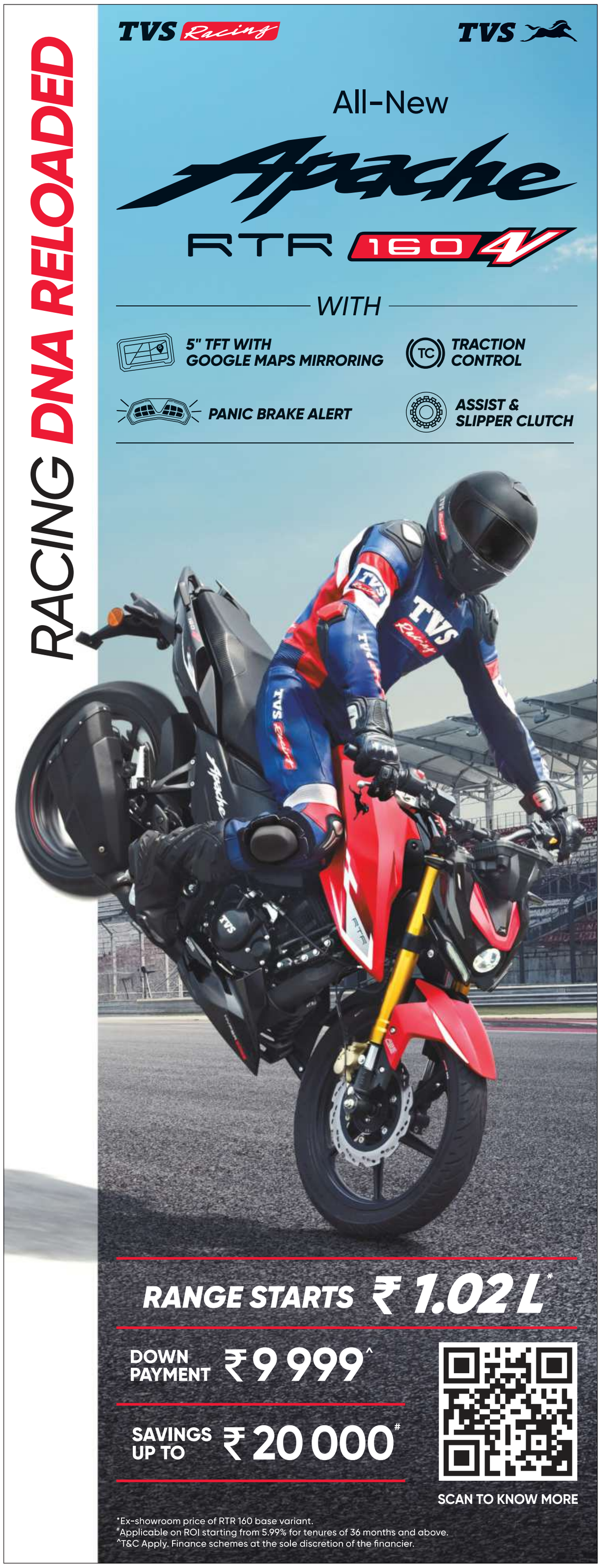
Four children, including two girls, drowned in the Periya Eri in Chromepet on Sunday.

A senior official of the Tambaram Police Commissionerate said the deceased – Yuvanesh, 10, Pooja, 13, Khushi, 13, and Devadharshan, 12 – all residents of Lakshmipuram of Chromepet, had gone for a swim in the lake, located on Thiruneermalai Main Road, on Saturday evening, without informing their parents.

Subsequently, Kirubakaran, father of Devardarshan, and Dhayalan, father of Yuvanesh, filed a missing complaint in the Chromepet police station.

On Sunday, the Chromepet police were alerted by the residents in the vicinity of Periya Eri that four dead bodies were floating in the lake.

The police rushed to the lake and, with the help of the fire and rescue services personnel, recovered the bodies of the four children and sent them to the Tambaram Government Headquarters Hospital for a post-mortem.



INBRIEF



Over 1,000 participate in Wildlife Trail Run at Vandalur

Around 1,200 people participated in the Wildlife Trail Run 2026 organised by Arignar Anna Zoological Park (AAZP) at Vandalur on Sunday, as part of Wildlife Week celebrations. An official release said that the 5-km run was flagged off by Kakarla Usha, Additional Chief Secretary, Environment, Climate Change and Forests Department, along with senior Forest Department officials and AAZP Director Ritto Cyriac. Participants took a pledge to protect wildlife and conserve nature before the run. The event was conducted in four categories, with male and female winners in each category receiving trophies and cash prizes.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (October 5, Monday), the following articles are available:

- Does a visa guarantee entry into India? **newsth.live/visaentry**
- Letting the wind flow freely is the secret to cooling our cities **newsth.live/windflow**

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Winged visitors from afar return to city's wetlands as migratory season commences

A grey-headed lapwing, a long-distance migrant from East Asia, arrived earlier than usual at the Pallikaranai marshland; terek sandpiper, lesser sand-plover, marsh sandpiper, and black-tailed godwit were also spotted; several shorebirds were sighted at the Adyar estuary by a birdwatcher



Grey-headed lapwing



Grey-bellied cuckoo



European roller

Geetha Srimathi
CHENNAI

The first signs of winter are arriving in Chennai, albeit not in the form of cooler mornings, but on wings. Birdwatchers across the city have begun spotting migratory species, signalling the start of another season for the movement of birds travelling thousands of kilometres to southern India.

At Pallikaranai marshland, K.V.R.K. Thirunaranan of The Nature Trust, which has been documenting birds in the marsh for over a decade, had a surprise this year with the early arrival of a grey-headed lapwing, a long-distance migrant from East Asia.

Mr. Thirunaranan said its arrival has usually been around the first week of October. But this year, it arrived on September 20, almost two weeks earlier than usual. Weather conditions, rainfall, food availability, and conditions along the migration route could have played a role, though the exact reason remains unclear, he added.

Terek sandpiper, lesser sand-plover, marsh sandpiper, and black-tailed godwit were also spotted at the marshland, which continues to face pressure from urbanisation.

At IIT-Madras, avid birdwatcher Prof. Susy Varghese has spotted paradise flycatcher, blue-tailed bee-eater, and booted eagle on the campus, which harbours considerable biodiversity.

At the Adyar estuary, birdwatcher Arun Pravin has recorded several shorebirds, including caspian terns, whiskered terns, Eurasian whimbrels, European roller, and common greenshanks. Some of these birds travel thousands of kilometres along routes spanning Northern Europe and Central Asia.

Further south, the Nemmeli salt pans have also come alive with bird activity. Birdwatcher Claudia Pinheiro, who recently visited the site with colleagues for a survey, said they recorded 56 species in just two hours. "Among the highlights was a huge flock of garganeys spread across the salt pans, and more than 600 greater flamingos were seen flying overhead, which was cool to watch," she said.

Ms. Pinheiro is hoping for another special sighting this season – the Demoiselle crane, a rare visitor around Chennai.

The species was spotted near Nemmeli towards the end of last year's birding season.

Dengue testing stepped up across city, over 4,500 cases recorded this year

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI



Principal Secretary to Government, Health and Family Welfare Department, Darez Ahamed and GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran inspecting the special fever prevention medical camp held in Teynampet Zone on Sunday.

With dengue cases crossing 4,500 in Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) areas, the Health Department has directed that all fever cases be tested, Principal Secretary to Government, Health and Family Welfare Department, Darez Ahamed, said on Sunday. He added that no dengue deaths had been reported.

Speaking to reporters after inspecting dengue prevention works in the Teynampet Zone, Mr. Ahamed said the State had recorded 20,000 cases so far, and that all fever cases were being tested to identify and manage the disease.

In Chennai, 16,254 tests have been conducted and 4,592 people have been affected by dengue this year. The number of cases recorded in September was 1,293. More than 100 medical camps were being held every day, and 3,703 mosquito eradication workers had been deployed, Mr. Ahamed said.

Mr. Ahamed inspected a medical camp at East Namasivayapuram, and mosquito eradication works, including drone-based larvicide spraying, along the Cooum. He also went door-to-door, distributing awareness pamphlets, on Sunday.

GCC Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said dengue incidence was gradually declining and that intensive prevention works would continue.

He said that desilting of 44 waterways and drone-based biological solutions were being undertaken.

A total of 1,400 km of the 1,600 km of stormwater drains, identified with blockages, had been desilted, he said. The remaining 200 km would be completed within the week, he added. Chennai has over 3,000 km of stormwater drains, besides 250 km under the Highways Department. Priority works under the Mamallan Reservoir project are planned for completion in October, he said.

Dr. Sameeran said ₹100 crore had been allocated for monsoon precautionary works and there was no shortage of funds for these works.

For long-term capital works, the GCC plans to tap foreign financial assistance schemes, including those of the World Bank and JICA, he said.

The Commissioner further said that fines, totalling ₹7.2 lakh, had been imposed in the past month on commercial establishments, organisations, and houses for failing to remove garbage.

Narcotic drug offences: bail can be denied even after one year of incarceration, says HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

In a case booked for possession of narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances, courts can deny bail even after one year of incarceration if there are reasonable grounds to believe that the accused could be guilty of the offence, the Madras High Court has held.

Justice N. Ramesh said the right to speedy trial of an accused must be read alongside and not in displacement of Section 37 of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985, which imposes restrictions on grant of bail to the accused booked under the Act.

The judge refused to grant bail to Muneer Sheik, who was arrested along with his co-accused Javeed, by the Manavala Nagar police in Tiruvallur district on October 14, 2025, for being in possession of 55 grams of methamphetamine.

The accused had reportedly told the police to have purchased 45 grams from a Nigerian national and the rest of 10 grams from absconding accused Kayum Bhai in Mumbai. The Forensic Sciences Department had confirmed that the seized substance was indeed methamphetamine.

Any quantity above 50 grams had been classified as 'commercial quantity' under the NDPS Act and hence the petitioner, if convicted for the offence, would have to suffer rigorous imprisonment for not less than 10 years and the sentence could be extended even up to 20 years under Section 22(c), the judge said.

The petitioner's counsel sought bail on the ground of long duration of incarceration, but Government Advocate (criminal side) M.M.I. Khaleel vehemently opposed the plea and contended that the police had already filed a charge sheet against the accused before a special court for NDPS Act cases.

After hearing both, the judge pointed out that Section 37 of the NDPS Act categorically states that every offence punishable under the Act shall be cognisable and no person accused of an offence under it shall be released on bail unless the public prosecutor was given an opportunity of hearing.

Further, Section 37(1)(b)(ii) mandates that when a public prosecutor opposes a bail application, the court should not grant bail unless it is satisfied that there are reasonable grounds for believing that the petitioner is not guilty of such offence and he is not likely to commit any offence while on bail. "I am not satisfied that there are reasonable grounds for believing that the petitioner is not guilty of the offence alleged," the judge said while dismissing the bail plea.

Surveillance strengthened on paddy movement in Tiruvallur

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

The Tiruvallur district administration has tightened surveillance on movement of paddy after complaints of bags being brought in by traders to direct procurement centres (DPCs).

Farmers have alleged that traders, including a few from neighbouring States, submit papers belonging to farmers and sell procured paddy.

"This, we hear is happening in Ponneri and Uthukottai areas. It should not be allowed. Farmers who are in distress seem to be pledging their crops with the traders and then giving the harvested crop to them. As the payment at the DPC may be better, the farmers are giving their adangal and chitta," said a farmer, who did not want to be named.

Inspection at border checkposts

District Collector S. Kavitha said that inspections were being carried out at border checkposts, teams of officials from the Revenue and Agriculture departments are being told to verify registrations and the quantity of procurement and the variety.

"We have created awareness among farmers that a two-year procurement ban would be imposed on those who gave their adangal to traders. The digital crop survey has been made mandatory from crop standing in the fields. If there are any discrepancies, special teams have been formed to verify the farmers' fields," she said.

Andhra Pradesh truck seized

Following such measures, a team of Revenue Department officials have seized a truck containing 16 tonnes of paddy from Andhra Pradesh in Anna Nagar in Uthukottai taluk.

Tiruvallur district has around 1.06 lakh hectares of land under paddy cultivation. This time, of the 70 DPCs approved, 58 have been opened and are functioning.

"The remaining will be opened based on the harvest schedule in those taluks. So far 9,600 tonnes of paddy have been procured from 1,300 farmers," an official source said.

CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras
Today: 6.00 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall - The Music Academy Madras – HCL Concerts – Ranjani Ravindrabharathy (Vocal), V. Mridula (Violin), Veeramraju Lakshmi Ajay (Mridangam).

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,
East Mada Street, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004
SOOPER PRESENT
"Multi-Lingual Theatre Festival" from October 5 to 10, 2026 daily at 6.30 P.M. Today: 5th Oct: 6.30 pm: Inauguration: Sri N.Ravi, Chairman, Bhavan's Chennai Kendra presides, Chief Guest: Sri S.G.Venkatesh, Director Technical, CPCL. 7.00 pm: Bengali - "Haripodogunin" by Bengal Association. Tomorrow: 6th Oct: Malayalam "Chillara Samaram" by Theatre Kochi. High Tea at 6.00 pm. All are Welcome.
In Association with : Nalli

Sunaada Satsang, 24992672
Lecdem on Composers of Bhajans and Abhangs. Dr. Premeela Gurumurthy, Pakkala Ramdas, R. Suresh (Tabla). Today 6.30 p.m. at Ragasudha Hall.

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
☎ 044-28576300
☎ Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

CLASSIFIEDS MART

TO ADVERTISE VISIT
www.thehinduads.com
CALL: 044-28576300 ▪ TOLL FREE: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised space sellers

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, MOHAN Bala Subramaniam Ramakrishnan, s/o Kalimuthu Ramakrishnan, r/o Old No. 21, New No. 33, 2nd Main Road, Kalaimagal Nagar, Ekkatuthangal, Chennai – 600032, have changed my name to Mohan Balasubramaniam.

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, RAJESH Kumar Prajapati father of Jitesh Kumar resident of SMQ No. 128/4 DC 1, Air Force Station Avadi, Chennai–600055 have changed my name from Rajesh Kumar Prajapati to Rajesh Kumar vide Affidavit dated 28–09–2026 before notary V Ganesh Rao Chennai

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, PRIYA Kumari spouse of Jitesh Kumar resident of SMQ No. 128/4 DC 1 Air Force Station Avadi Chennai–600055 have changed my name from Priya Kumari to Priya vide Affidavit dated 28–09–2026 before notary V Ganesh Rao Chennai

PEST CONTROL

NETLON SAINTGOBAIN SS Doortype SV Trading Authorised Dealer:9940386715

HEALTH

HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Ngr. 60min– 999/– 9042 18 28 28

BODY MASSAGES Avl at Alwarpet @ PIVOT SPA. Ct: 97909 67299

TENDERS

PACIFICA COMPANIES

TENDER NOTICE

CIVIL CONTRACTORS

ARE INVITED FOR CORE & SHELL WORKS (E/W, PCC, RCC, B/W, PLASTER WORKS) FOR HIGH-RISE & LOW-RISE BUILDINGS WITH/ WITHOUT MATERIAL, LABOUR & EQUIPMENT AT SIRUSERI & PADUR, CHENNAI.

Call : +91 9994111585
Email : elancheral@pacificacompanies.in

Xpressions

GREETINGS



CLASSIFIEDS SPECIAL





N. Ragunanthan, Head of Orthopaedics, Rathi Med Speciality Hospital, with IIT-M Director V. Kamakoti at an event. R. RAGU

City hospital launches programme for fresh meniscus transplant

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Rathi Med Speciality Hospital launched a fresh meniscus allograft transplantation (MAT) programme as part of the Chennai Knee Course 2026 on Sunday.

The programme was inaugurated by IIT-Madras Director V. Kamakoti and Health Secretary Darez Ahamed. The programme involves using a healthy meniscus from selected patients undergoing total knee replacement as a fresh graft for patients whose damaged meniscus cannot be repaired or reconstructed. The hospital said it had received a licence, valid until December 2030, from the State government to perform the procedure. The programme is led by N. Ragunanthan, Director, Head of Orthopaedics, and Consultant Surgeon of the hospital.

The conference, titled 'The Meniscus 360° – From Repair to Transplant', discussed meniscus transplantation and knee preservation. The hospital also presented its Kinematic Knee Treatment and KPA Knee Preservation 360° approach for patients below 60 years of age.

Weekend night bike racing on key roads in city puts residents, motorists on the edge

More than 100 motorcycles perform stunts on arterial roads such as Anna Salai, and in Guindy, Valluvar Kottam, Kodambakkam, and Anna Nagar; youth dies after falling from flyover; residents demand crackdown on midnight racing as speeding bikes disturb sleep and raise fears of accidents

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Residents and motorists in the city are alarmed by the growing number of teenagers taking part in bike racing at night, mainly during weekends, posing a serious threat to motorists and other road users.

A section of residents staged a protest at Valluvar Kottam on Saturday night, demanding that the city traffic police take stringent action to curb the nuisance. The residents said they were unable to sleep due to the noise caused by the bikes and expressed concern over the danger posed by reckless riding.

The issue came into renewed focus following the death of 21-year-old R. Sri Gugan of Raja Annamalaipuram, who worked as a mechanic. In the early hours of Sunday, Gugan was riding his friend's bike when he lost control of the vehicle on the flyover on Sardar Patel Road, near IIT-Madras.

The bike crashed into a barricade on the flyover, following which Gugan fell from the flyover and died. The incident has once again highlighted the dangers posed by reckless and high-speed riding on city roads, particularly during the night.


Videos of bike racing and stunts have gone viral on social media, prompting netizens to demand stern police action.

Residents staged a protest at Valluvar Kottam saying they were unable to sleep due to noise created by the racing bikes

Saturday night menace

More than 100 motorcycles were reportedly involved in racing and performing stunts on arterial roads such as Anna Salai, and in Guindy, Valluvar Kottam, Kodambakkam and Anna Nagar on Saturday night.

Videos of youngsters engaged in bike racing and stunts have since gone viral on social media, prompting netizens to demand stern action from the city traffic police against the groups involved. Motorists have also complained that many of the riders either remove their number plates or fold them to make the registration numbers difficult to identify.

S. Ramesh, a resident of Adambakkam, said he was driving on Jawaharlal Nehru Salai near Ashok Pillar on Saturday night when he saw more than 15 motorcycles racing from Guindy towards Vadapalani. "The riders were speeding and racing alongside each other, creating anxiety among other road users. I did not see any police personnel along the stretch," he said.

T. Purushoth, a resident of Anna Nagar 3rd Avenue, said motorcycle stunts had become a common sight on weekends in recent months, particularly near the food streets late at night. "Youngsters ride rashly in these areas. Those approaching Anna Nagar tend to drive cautiously until the Anna Nagar Arch, where police personnel are stationed. But once they get onto the flyover, some riders begin driving recklessly," he said.

He added that some riders were also seen performing stunts with the motorcycle's centre stand engaged, causing sparks to fly as the vehicles moved on the road. According to him, roads behind the food streets in Anna Nagar have become a venue for such activities.

A retired city police official said enforcement against such violations needed to be stricter. He alleged that policemen were sometimes sympathetic towards violators, particularly underage riders involved in bike racing. He pointed to the action taken by police in Thoothukudi on Saturday, where cases were reportedly registered against the parents of underage riders and the vehicles were impounded.

A senior city traffic police officer said the motorcycles involved in racing and stunt riding on Saturday night were being identified.

"An action plan is being worked out to put an end to this menace," the officer said.

Residents seek measures to prevent flooding, curb pollution

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Residents of Tiruvottiyur sought measures to prevent flooding, curb industrial pollution, provide pattas and basic amenities, and strengthen healthcare and waste management, at a grievances meeting held in Ernavoor on Sunday.

The Federation of North Chennai Residents Welfare Associations (FNCRWA) and the Village Coordination Committee organised the 'Tiruvottiyur Makkal Sangamam' at the Perundalaivar Kamarajar Mandapam.


G.K. Venkatkumar, Assistant Commissioner of Police, Ennore, addressing a grievances meeting at Kamarajar Mandapam, Ernavoor, in Tiruvottiyur Zone on Sunday. B.JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Among the demands were the raising and strengthening of both banks of the Buckingham Canal by one metre, measures to prevent industrial wastewater and thermal power plant ash from entering the canal and estuary, deepening and widening the Ennore estuary to facilitate the discharge of Kosasthalaiyar river water into the sea. Association president T.K Shanmugam also sought the extension of Chennai Metro Rail to Ennore, completion of the Annamalai Nagar-Wimco Nagar railway subway, playgrounds, and gymnasiums. A self-certification system was also sought for individual houses up to 3,000 sq.ft, excluding multi-storey buildings.

Tiruvottiyur residents seek action against industries violating pollution control rules

They sought action against industries violating pollution control rules, including continuous monitoring of air, water, and soil quality and transparent disclosure of the findings. The demands also included regular drinking water supply, underground sewerage connections and integrated stormwater drains. They also sought pattas for eligible long-term residents of government and temple lands, while protecting water bodies and catchment areas.

Sale deeds were also sought for those who had paid for houses built by the Tamil Nadu Urban Habitat Development Board.

SBI general INSURANCE
SURAKSHA AUR BHAROSA DONO

OFFICE PREMISES REQUIRED

SBI General Insurance Company Limited invites online offers from owners, ready for possession premises on lease rental basis, for commercial/office use for **TIRUNELVELI (TAMIL NADU)** of the Company, having carpet area of 139.35 sq. mts. (1500 sq. ft.) in the range of +10% & -5%, preferably on the main road within range of maximum 1 kilometre of the following areas-

1. **TIRUNELVELI NEW BUS STAND ROAD**
2. **PALAYAMKOTTAI ROAD**
3. **VANNARAPETTAI ROAD**
4. **JUNCTION ROAD (RAILWAY STATION)**
5. **NGO COLONY ROAD**

The format for submission of online Technical Bid containing the terms and conditions along with Commercial Bid can be viewed from the Company's website- **www.sbigeneral.in** under the head 'Tenders & Procurement'.

The prospective Landlord will have to fill up Supplier register Form. After successful registration, they can participate through online RPF/Tender.

The offers complete in all respects should be submitted online on or before **3.00 pm** on the **(22/10/2026).**

Premises offered should have title clearance / permission for commercial usage, clear provision for telephone / data connectivity and Occupation Certificate. Incomplete offers will be rejected. Company reserves the right to accept or reject any or all offers without assigning any reasons who so ever and no correspondence will be entertained in this regard. **No brokerage shall be paid.**

Head – Infrastructure Management
SBI General Insurance Company Ltd.

Disclaimer: SBI General Insurance Company Limited. Corporate & Registered address: 9th Floor, A&B Wing, Fulcrum Building, Sahar Road, Andheri East, Mumbai - 400099 | IRDA Reg No 144 dated 15/12/2009 | CIN: U66000MH2009PLC190546 | SBI Logo displayed belongs to State Bank of India used by SBI General Insurance Company Limited under license

Police nab 3 migrant workers over murder of their co-worker

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Velachery police on Sunday arrested three men in connection with the murder of their fellow migrant worker from Odisha following a dispute over the online transfer of wages.

Police said the accused – Qasim and his accomplices Sheriful and Tabir, all from Bihar – were involved in the construction of a house in IOB Colony of Velachery. Ranjan used to transfer their wages to them via UPI. On Saturday, he was found dead with fatal injuries. The Velachery police sent the body to the Government Royapettah Hospital for a post-mortem.

The victim was stabbed after an argument with the accused over an online transaction

Initial investigation found that a dispute arose between Qasim and Ranjan after ₹45,000, which was intended to be transfered to Qasim's mother via UPI, was transferred to a different bank account.

Qasim stabbed Ranjan to death following an argument over the transaction.

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	36	24
Chennai Airport	36	27
Chennai City	35	27

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be dry. The day will be very warm and uneasy. The night also will be uneasy.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C The weather will be dry. The day will be very warm and uneasy. The night will be comfortable.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

Timings
CHENNAI

MONDAY, OCT. 05		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:57
RISE	00:56	SET 14:07
TUESDAY, OCT. 06		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:56
RISE	01:56	SET 14:54
WEDNESDAY, OCT. 07		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:55
RISE	02:52	SET 15:37





Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin 603209. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

Fisherfolk oppose plan to build Secretariat at Foreshore Estate

They hoist black flags to mark their opposition to the proposal. They demand that the govt. return the lands belonging to Srinivasapuram, build new houses for 15,000 fishermen along the Marina Loop Road, and discuss the matter with them

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI



Strong opposition: Fishermen along the Marina Loop Road on Sunday raise black flags on boats, fish stalls, and homes, during a protest against the State government's proposal to establish a new Secretariat at Pattinapakkam. (PTI, R. SENTHILKUMAR)

Sunday morning witnessed peaceful protests in villages along the Marina Loop Road, with fishermen hoisting black flags on boats, fish stalls, net mending sheds and homes, to mark their opposition to the new Secretariat.

They demand that the State government return the lands belonging to Srinivasapuram to the village and drop the proposal to construct the Secretariat at Foreshore Estate.

Residents of Srinivasapuram took out a march, carrying black flags through the narrow roads of the hamlet.

"The lands originally belonged to fishermen. They were taken over by the [Tamil Nadu] Housing Board with the promise that we will get homes built on them. But we were cheated. We want those lands to be returned to us," a fisherman said.

Among their demands is the construction of new houses for 15,000 fishermen and their families living along the Marina Loop Road, as most of their houses were built 40 to 50 years ago.

The fishermen have submitted their demands to the Chief Minister's Special Cell. "We hope the government will take a positive decision on the issue. Since we are the stakeholders who matter the most, we request the government to appoint someone to listen to our grievances before taking such a major decision. We are holding protests only because nobody has discussed the issue with us," said fishermen leaders G.R. Vijayan and K. Bharathi.

Fishermen of villages such as Nochikuppam, Bhavanikuppam, Domingkuppam, Rajiv Gandhi Nagar, Mullikuppam/Srinivasapuram, Mullimanagar, Nambikai Nagar, Selvarajpuram and Irudayapuram have planned to hold a series of protests to draw the attention of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to their demands.

Abandon Pattinapakkam Assembly-cum-Secretariat complex project: PIL plea

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI



The petitioner points out that the Assembly and the Secretariat have been functioning from Fort St. George for decades. FILE PHOTO

The Madras High Court is all set to hear on Monday a public interest litigation (PIL) petition, which has sought a direction to the Tamil Nadu government to abandon its plan to construct a new Legislative Assembly-cum-Secretariat complex on 25.55 acres at Pattinapakkam (Foreshore Estate) in Chennai.

The petition has been listed for admission before the First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan. Chennai-based advocate R.S. Tamilvendan had filed the petition.

The petitioner said he was shocked to come across news reports that the State government had given in-principle approval for the construction of the Assembly-cum-Secretariat complex on the land belonging to the Tamil Nadu Housing Board, which was originally meant for constructing low-cost flats for the people.

Mr. Tamilvendan said the Assembly-cum-Secretariat, currently located at Fort St. George, was the ideal location since it was close to the Puratchi Thalaivar M.G. Ramachandran Central Railway Station, the Madras High Court buildings, the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital, and many other public facilities.

He brought to the notice of the court that both the Assembly and the Secretariat had been functioning from Fort St. George for decades.

Though the DMK government of 2006-2011 built a new complex on Anna Salai, the subsequent AIADMK government converted it into a government hospital.

Claiming that the existing buildings at Fort St. George could be renovated instead of ₹1,200 crore being spent on a new complex, especially at a time when the government was facing a severe financial crisis, the petitioner said the interests of the fishermen residing in and around Pattinapakkam could also be protected if the proposal was dropped.

He also told the court that the construction of the new complex could lead to heavy traffic congestion in the locality and that a representation made by him to the government authorities in this regard on September 12, 2026, was considered. He urged the court to stay the construction until the disposal of the petition.

Two students killed as two-wheeler hits median

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUVANNAMALAI

Two college students were killed in a road accident when the two-wheeler they were riding hit a median on the Chittoor-Cuddalore Highway in Ethal village in Tiruvannamalai on Sunday. The deceased were identified as S. Krithik, 20, and M. Priyadarshan, 20. They were both residents of Chennai, and were studying at a private deemed university in the city.

An initial inquiry revealed that they were returning to Chennai after offering worship at the Parvathamalai Temple near Arani when the incident occured. A case was registered by the Vadavanakkampadi police and an investigation is under way.

A national record, three medals, and a homecoming

The Hindu Bureau
COIMBATORE



Nation's pride: Vithya Ramraj with her three Asian Games medals during her homecoming at Meenakshipuram in Coimbatore on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Breaking a 42-year-old national record, winning three Asian Games medals, and returning to her native village made it a memorable week for 28-year-old athlete Vithya Ramraj of Meenakshipuram in Coimbatore.

On September 28, Vithya won bronze in women's 400 m hurdles at the Asian Games held in Japan this year, clocking a personal best of 54.75 seconds to become the first Indian woman to breach the 55-second barrier and better P.T. Usha's 55.42-second national record, set at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics.

She also won gold in the women's 4x400m relay and silver in the mixed 4x400m relay.

Vithya had equalled Usha's mark in 2023, but could not better it then. "I was sad then that I could not break the record. Now, I am happy that I have done it," she said.

Family's effort

For her father, S. Ramraj, a truck driver, Vithya's success is the culmination of several years of effort by the entire family.

"There were times when we did not have enough income to support her athletics. It was difficult to buy even a pair of shoes. We somehow managed to arrange the money for her. Her twin sister, Nithya, helped her with her salary, and I worked extra shifts and put together the money," he said.

The twins developed their taste for sport at school, where they played hockey. Their physical training teacher encouraged them to pursue sport as a career, eventually leading them to the Sports Hostel for Girls in Erode when they were in Class VII. "It was there that they began concentrating on athletics. Later, they chose different events. Nithya pursued the short sprints, while Vithya took up the 400m hurdles," Mr. Ramraj said.

The family's role in Vithya's career was not limited to meeting expenses. Her mother, R. Meena, travelled with her for competitions, while the twins continued their education alongside athletics.

"We had not thought that she would excel this much. Sports helped her complete her schooling and her undergraduate programme," Mr. Ramraj said.

Vithya credits coach Nehpal Singh Rathore with helping her build the discipline and endurance required to compete at the highest level. Years of rigorous training, she said, taught her to stay the course through every race.

"If not for him, I would not have reached this level," she said. "I would just focus on the runner ahead of me after receiving the baton and try to outrun her. In every race, I give my fullest," Vithya said.

"Setting the record is a proud moment, but I know there is more to achieve. I want to perform well at the international level and aim for better performances at the upcoming World Championships and Olympic Games," she said.

On Saturday, Vithya returned to Meenakshipuram in a procession from Nachipalayam, where villagers burst firecrackers, distributed sweets, and showered flowers on the Asian Games medalist and national record-holder.

Adhere to timelines for the disposal of retired staff's representations, says HC

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI



The right to submit a representation to authorities for the redress of grievances is a constitutional right, says the court. FILE PHOTO

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has directed Tamil Nadu Chief Secretary and Secretary to Human Resources Management Department to issue instructions to all the departments to scrupulously adhere to the prescribed timelines for receipt, consideration, and disposal of representations submitted by retired government employees, their family members, and the public.

Justice B. Pugalendhi directed that the mechanism for monitoring the disposal of representations should be effectively implemented. Failure, without sufficient cause, to dispose of a representation within the prescribed time should be viewed seriously. Appropriate disciplinary action should be taken against officers responsible, he said.

Article 350 of the Constitution provides that every person shall be entitled to submit a representation for the redressal of any grievance to any officer or authority of the Union or a State in any of the languages used in the Union or the State. The right to submit a representation to the authorities for the redressal of grievances is a constitutional right, the court said.

The court said the instructions issued by the government, in the form of government orders, circulars and office manuals, prescribing the time limits for disposal of such representations were to ensure that the right was meaningfully exercised and grievances brought before the authorities were dealt with within a reasonable time.

The instructions constitute an essential aspect of the duties of government employees entrusted with the receipt and disposal of such representations. Failure to discharge such obligation within the prescribed time would amount to dereliction of duty and may, depending upon the circumstances, constitute misconduct, the court said.

The court said such persistent inaction, despite repeated instructions and judicial intervention, cannot be permitted to become an accepted feature of public administration.

The consequence of such avoidable litigation was not confined to the consumption of valuable judicial time. It also resulted in avoidable expenditure both to the litigant and to the State, the court said.

The court was hearing the batch of petitions filed by retired government employees and legal heirs of deceased government employees seeking family pension, revision of retirement benefits and payment of arrears.

The court directed the authorities concerned to dispose of the representations in three months.

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar,
Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/PMC/ETND-EP-10/2087/2026-27 Date: 03.10.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR PROVIDING PROJECT MANAGEMENT CONSULTANCY SERVICES
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB is inviting tenders under Quality Based Consultancy System (QCBS) as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Consulting Firms under two cover system for the following works :

Name of the Works: (1) Project Management Consultancy Services for the work of Formation of Industrial Layout including construction of Roads, Construction of RCC Side Drains, RCC Cross Drainage Works, Retaining wall & HDPE Dual Water supply pipeline in Sector-1 for Sub Layout in KGF Industrial Area, Bangaradagani Village, KGF Taluk, Kolar District. **(2)** Project Management Consultancy Services for the work of Formation of Industrial Layout including construction of Roads, Construction of RCC Side Drains, RCC Cross Drainage Works, Retaining Wall & HDPE Dual Water Supply pipe line in Sector-2 for Sub layout in KGF Industrial Area, Bangaradagani Village, KGF Taluk, Kolar District. **(3)** Project Management Consultancy Services for the work of Improvement to Industrial Layout including reconstruction and re-surfacing of 12m wide and 18m wide roads including flexible pavement, construction of RCC side drain, RCC cross drainage in Bommasandra Jigani Link Road Industrial Area, Anekal Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District. **(4)** Project Management Consultancy Services for the work of Improvement to Industrial Layout including Reconstruction and resurfacing of 12m & 18m wide roads including flexible pavement, construction of RCC Side Drains, RCC Cross Drainage in Bommasandra 1st, 2nd & 3rd Phase Industrial Area, Anekal Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District.

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **22.10.2026** upto **4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**

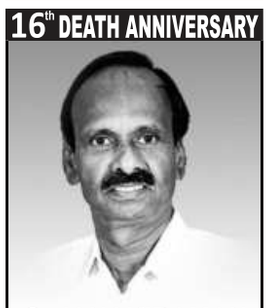
Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru

DIPR/CP/3069/SMCL/2026-27

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

16th DEATH ANNIVERSARY



S. JANAKIRAMAN
Managing Partner
Elegant Publicities
Golden memories will remain forever in our hearts.
Remembered by:
Family Members & Staff

9TH ANNIVERSARY



P.RAJADURAI
M.A.MPhil.Phd.
Retired Principal
S.B.K.College, Arupukottai
Expired on 05.10.2017
Fondly Remembered by:
Dr.R.Arunmozhimaran
M.S.Ortho
& Family

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES
To dedicate a space in this section,
Please contact: **044-28576300**
from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161
from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
For Placing Advertisements Online log on to www.thehinduads.com
DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

EDUCATIONPLUS

Intensive versus extensive reading

How are the two different and why both approaches need to complement each other to encourage students to read

K. Elango

Academia is in a 'reading crisis', increasingly perplexed by a persistent question: how can students be persuaded to read, including their own textbooks?

The common allegations – excessive screen time, dopamine-driven digital addiction, shrinking attention spans, a craving for constant stimulation, complex grammatical structures, and dated linguistic expressions – are unquestioningly valid, but do not show a trajectory for restoring students' interest in reading.

Two approaches

Digital natives, paradoxically, read constantly, often, far more than previous generations. From their birth, they are exposed to screens (big and small) that have made reading almost as natural as fish take to water.

Digital platforms offer far more convenience, including customisable fonts that reduce visual fatigue and encourage sustained reading; backlit screens enable reading even in darkness; hyperlinks provide instant access to dictionaries, translations, and reference materials; and annotation and highlighting tools make revisions far more efficient.

Consequently, students experience reading as an interactive, personalised, and highly responsive activity. They consider reading to be cool.

This experience turns topsy-turvy when students enter classrooms with their school bags: traditional textbook- and teacher-centric instruction transports them into an insipid world.

The prescribed iconic writers and the iconic pieces, ironically, bear little resemblance to their lived experiences. Pedagogical practices that rely heavily on line-by-line explanation, close textual analysis, and interpretation between and beyond the lines often fail to engage them. An equally heavy emphasis on grammar, vocabulary drills, fragmented language skills, and standardised question-answer formats further distances them from the intrinsic pleasure of reading.

Such intensive treatment of texts often results in cognitive fatigue, making meaningful reading a casualty. Incidentally, it is quite contrary to the way grown-ups engage with reading after school.

Many learners remark that a dissected approach to texts robs them of the joy of reading. Specialists consider such practices to undermine the fundamental objective of education: nurturing autonomous, lifelong readers.

Consequently, they advocate curricula that combine prescribed textbooks with extensive reading. Although the two approaches – intensive and extensive reading – are viewed as contradictory, they are actually complementary.

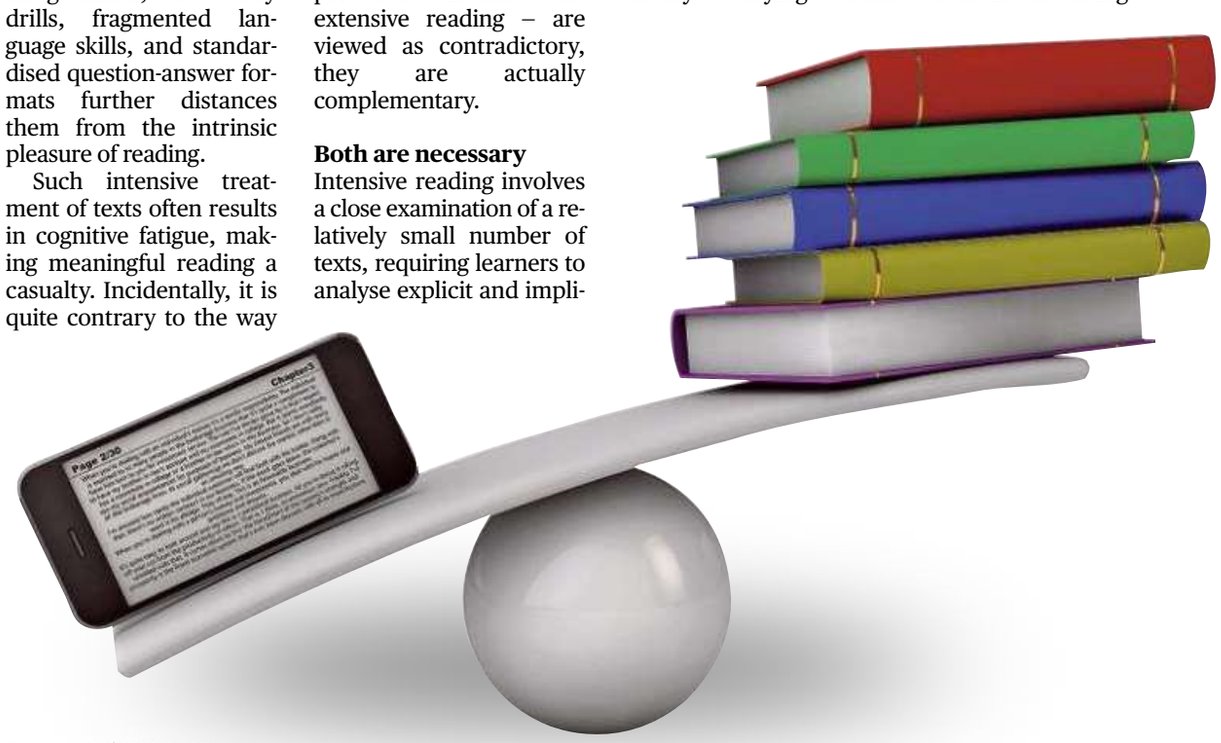
Both are necessary

Intensive reading involves a close examination of a relatively small number of texts, requiring learners to analyse explicit and implicit meanings, figurative language, syntactic features, intra- and inter-textual relationships and varying critical perspectives. It resembles almost a dissection in a biology lab. Undoubtedly cognitively demanding, academia continues to rely heavily on this approach, with literary studies representing its peak.

Extensive reading, conversely, is reading whatever one is interested in, obviously varying from person to person, ranging from periodicals (newspapers, magazines, journals) to multiple genres of fiction and non-fiction, such as sci-fi, romance novels, autobiographies, travelogues, and so forth.

Reflecting on his childhood, Shashi Tharoor remarked that he read "eclectically and indiscriminately", ranging from children's books to classics. Such freedom of choice is sure to cultivate lifelong reading habits among many.

The distinctions between the two approaches are self-evident: intensive reading emphasises features such as in-depth analysis, accuracy, limited texts, and detailed comprehension, while extensive reading prioritises fluency, larger volumes of texts, fast reading, and overall understanding.



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Above all, extensive reading is reading for pleasure, whereas intensive reading is associated with academic obligation. An effective curriculum requires both approaches to work in tandem rather than in competition.

Recognising the criticality of extensive reading, countries such as Japan, Indonesia, and Italy have established professional associations dedicated to promoting it. These organisations encourage learners to read widely for pleasure and fluency, and support teachers by publishing journals and organising conferences and workshops that foster a vibrant reading culture.

In India, the English Language Teachers' Association of India (ELTAI) has launched a student-led, pan-India reading movement to cultivate reading for pleasure and nurture lifelong readers.

Similarly, the debate between e-reading and print reading (p-reading) should not be considered an either-or choice. Learners, particularly in the foundational years, must become amphibious readers, moving effortlessly between digital platforms and printed books.

Such balanced engagement will ensure that the art of reading thrives in the era of AI when the 'death of reading' is predicted. Natural intelligence can be developed by reading. A nation that reads is a nation that leads.

The writer is a retired Professor of English, Anna University, and Chief Executive Chair of English Language Teachers' Association of India (ELTAI).

SCHOLARSHIPS

SML Mahindra Scholarship
An initiative of SML Mahindra Limited.
Eligibility: Open to daughters of drivers of heavy and light commercial road transport vehicles, who are studying in Classes 11 or 12 or pursuing UG, diploma or polytechnic courses in STEM and core Engineering fields with minimum 60% and family income of ₹600,000.
Rewards: Up to ₹30,000
Application: Online
Deadline: October 21
www.b4s.in/edge/SMLS1

Parivartan ECSS Programme
An initiative of the HDFC Bank
Eligibility: Students who are Indian nationals studying in school (Class 1 to 12) or in diploma, ITI, polytechnic, UG and PG (general and professional) courses and have minimum 55% in the most recent qualifying exam and have an annual family income not exceeding ₹250,000. Preference will be given to those who have experienced a personal/family crisis in the past three years that impacted their ability to continue their studies.
Rewards: Up to ₹75,000
Application: Online
Deadline: October 31
www.b4s.in/edge/HDFC63

NSP Post-Matric Financial Assistance Scheme
Offered by the Ministry of Labour and Employment, Government of India.
Eligibility: Wards of workers *beedi*, cine, IOMC, LSDM, or mica mine industries who are students in a government-recognised institution (from Class 11 to PG) and have passed the previous qualifying exam in the first attempt. Monthly income should not exceed ₹10,000 (*beedi*/mine industries) and ₹8,000 (cine workers).
Rewards: Up to ₹25,000 per annum.
Application: Online
Deadline: October 31
www.b4s.in/edge/MLE9

Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

Anandi Fellowship

Bombay Shaving Company invites applications for the Anandi Fellowship, which aims to identify entrepreneurial talent among young Indians through the Anandi-NEAT (Nationwide Entrepreneurship Acumen Test) 2026, to be held in December.

Eligibility: Students in Class 11 and 12, or in the first year of UG programmes. No start-up, prototype, or prior experience is required to register. The programme is designed to remain independent of a student's school or college background.
Deadline: October 15, 2026
For details, visit tinyurl.com/56w36f6c

Identify a mentor

Uncertain about your career options? Low on self-confidence? This column may help



OFF THE EDGE
Nandini Raman

I have completed my UG degree and have a strong desire to clear the TNPSC exam, but feel lazy and demotivated. How can I build a consistent study habit? Nithiyasri

Dear Nithiyasri,

Are you sure you are not overwhelmed by the massive syllabus? First, confirm that you have the official TNPSC syllabus (Group 1, 2, or 4, based on your target) and skim the broad subject heads (General Tamil/English, Indian Polity, Aptitude). Then collect Samacheer Kalvi textbooks (classes 6 to 10). These are easier to digest than advanced competitive exam guides.

Commit to studying for 15-20 minutes in a one-hour block. Pick the easiest or most interesting topic and slowly build the discipline to work through multiple hourly blocks and increase the study time. Start with 3-4 cycles a day and increase as you feel more confident. Pair your study session with a habit that you already enjoy. Mark detailed portions on a calendar — weekly, fortnightly, monthly — and measure your progress. Start solving old question papers. If you still do not make progress, identify a mentor and work with someone you respect and can be accountable to.

I am in the final year of Medicine but don't want to be a physician. While preparing for the UPSC, I realised that I love studying Economics. Will I be able to pursue a Master's in Economics? Name withheld

Before making any drastic changes, think through your decision. Economics in the UPSC General Studies focuses heavily on policy intuition, macro-trends, inflation, public finance, and descriptive analysis, whereas graduate-level Economics is predominantly Applied Maths and Quantitative Modelling. Test your comfort with formal quantitative economics: multivariable calculus, linear algebra, and probability/statistics. *Intermediate Microeconomics* by Hal Varian is the standard undergraduate textbook. If you enjoy the mathematical formulations of consumer choice and optimisation in this, you will thrive in an MA/M.Sc. Economics environment.
While an MBBS degree is a recognised Bachelor's degree, verify specific prerequisite course requirements for each institution. Programmes at Delhi School of Economics, ISI, IGIDR, or MSE usually mandate calculus, linear algebra, and statistics at the UG level or require competitive entrance exams like CUET-PG (Economics) or IIT-JAM (Economics). Universities abroad offer Conversion Master's in Economics or M.Sc. Economics tracks for non-Economics graduates with strong quantitative skills.

I'm doing B. Pharm, but I wish to go into banking solely for financial security. How can I make the switch? Reeva

Dear Reeva,

All major bank recruitment exams (IBPS PO, IBPS Clerk, SBI PO, RBI Assistant) require a recognised Bachelor's degree in any discipline. Start looking at the key notifications and prepare for these exams. You will need to master Quantitative Aptitude (Data Interpretation, Simplification), Logical Reasoning, English, and General Awareness tests.

Leverage your Pharma background and target specialised roles like IBPS Specialist Officer (SO) or Agriculture Field Officer (AFO) if eligible, or look for Credit Analyst or Technical Officer roles in commercial banks that evaluate healthcare and pharmaceutical business loans. Consider PG Diplomas in Banking as an alternative route for private banks. ICICI Manipal Probationary Officers Programme or HDFC Future Bankers train non-commerce graduates and guarantee placement.

Public Sector Banks come with an unmatched job security, standardised pay scales, allowances, and medical benefits. But there is high pressure to meet business targets, potential rural postings, and high entry competition. In comparison, private banks have a faster hiring process and quicker merit-based promotions but without job security. If financial stability is your primary goal, look at pharma-adjacent roles like Pharma Data Analytics, Regulatory Affairs, or Medical Writing. These provide higher entry pay and stronger work-life balance than entry-level private banking.

I am in the second year of B.Tech. Dairy Technology. I want to do a Master's in this field. What skills should I develop? Is it possible to work part-time alongside B.Tech? Rishad

Dear Rishad,

Focus on advanced quality assurance and microbiological testing techniques and chemical analysis, dairy process engineering and unit operations, HTST plants, spray drying, membrane filtration and homogenisation, and food safety management systems. Acquire certifications with conceptual clarity in HACCP, ISO 22000, and FSSAI regulations. Learn Modern Research and data skills and tools like R, SPSS, or Python for statistical quality control, analysis of variance (ANOVA), and response surface methodology (RSM). Build familiarity with analytical instruments like HPLC, Gas Chromatography (GC), Spectrophotometry, and Rheometers.

Part-time jobs may be difficult due to the rigorous, lab-heavy nature of your course. However, flexible remote or project-based work is possible. Consider tutoring for school-level Chemistry, Biology, or basic Maths on ed-tech platforms; explore technical writing or content development for food safety blogs, agritech startups, or educational portals; or assist researchers with literature reviews or statistical data entry remotely. Approach your professors for research assistantships that contribute directly to your Master's application through research publications and conference papers.

Disclaimer: This column is merely a guiding voice and provides advice and suggestions on education and careers.

The writer is a practising counsellor and a trainer. Send your questions to eduplus.thehindu@gmail.com with the subject line Off the Edge



INBRIEF



BJP condemns 'intimidation' of journalist by TVK workers

BJP Tamil Nadu president Nainar Nagenthran on Sunday condemned the alleged intimidation of a journalist by Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) workers at Dharapuram in Tiruppur district, after he shot visuals of some of them reportedly falling at the feet of Minister and TVK general secretary N. Anand. In a social media post, he said the journalist was threatened and his mobile phone was taken away after he recorded the visuals. He also alleged that the videos were forcibly deleted from the device. Mr. Nagenthran alleged that the police were present when the incident took place, but they failed to intervene.

Man killed in suspected leopard attack near Hasanur

A 35-year-old man was killed, reportedly by a carnivore suspected to be a leopard, near Hasanur in the Sathyamangalam Tiger Reserve in the early hours of Sunday. The deceased was identified as Periasamy of Bungalowthotti village. Forest Department officials said the incident occurred around 1 a.m. near a restaurant on NH 948. After Periasamy was reported missing, villagers searched for him and found the body near the forest fringe close to where the incident had occurred. After protesting for nearly two hours demanding the deployment of more Forest Department personnel in the area, the villagers allowed the body to be taken for a post-mortem.

Campaigning for bypoll ends in Madurantakam, Dharapuram

Polling will take place on October 6. The byelection will be a five-cornered contest, with the TVK-led Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance, the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance, the AIADMK-led NDA, the Left parties, and the NTK in the fray

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The high-decibel byelection campaign in the Assembly segments of Madurantakam (SC) in Chengalpattu district and Dharapuram (SC) in Tiruppur district ended on Sunday evening, when leaders and cadres of various political parties made a final push to canvass votes.

The stage is now set for polling on October 6. Both the Assembly segments were declared vacant following the resignation of Maragatham Kumaravel and P. Sathyabama on May 25.

They were elected on AIADMK tickets from Madurantakam and Dharapuram, respectively, and resigned within three weeks of being elected to the House.

They switched sides to the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) and are in the race on behalf of the party.

Unlike recent Assembly byelections in Tamil Nadu, the polls in these two constituencies feature a five-cornered contest. The TVK-led Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance, the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance and the AIADMK-led National Democratic Alliance are in the fray.

The Left front is contesting separately, while the Naam Tamilar Katchi is going it alone.

TVK campaign

On the last day of the campaign, TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay went on a roadshow in Dharapuram, canvassing votes for Ms. Sathyabama. Meanwhile, Minister Aadhav Arjuna and other TVK leaders campaigned for Ms. Kumaravel in Madurantakam. DMK president M.K. Stalin and AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami released video messages, canvassing votes for their respective candidates. Leaders of the Left parties and Naam Tamilar Katchi also concluded their campaigns.

The ruling TVK had deployed almost all Ministers as election in-charges in these two constituencies to oversee election work. Mr. Vijay, who had conducted a relatively limited campaign during the Assembly election, had campaigned extensively in these two segments. He addressed a public meeting in each and held roadshows for several kilometres.

Changes in alliances

The alliance arithmetic has also changed when compared to the previous election.

The Congress, the Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, the Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi, and the Indian Union Muslim League, which were part of the DMK-led alliance, are now with the TVK-led alliance.

The Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar), which was part of the NDA, is now extending support to the TVK. The AIADMK accused the TVK of engineering the defection of its MLAs. Mr Palaniswami and AMMK general secretary T.T.V. Dhinakaran had campaigned extensively in both constituencies.

PMK's stance

The Pattali Makkal Katchi, a key constituent of the NDA that has considerable influence in northern and western Tamil Nadu, had decided not to extend support to any alliance.

The DMK also undertook an extensive campaign in both Assembly segments, with former Ministers camping and overseeing the poll work. Mr. Stalin and Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin too have campaigned in both constituencies.

Counting on October 9

A total of 27 candidates are in the fray in Madurantakam, while 22 are in the contest in Dharapuram. Polling will begin at 7 a.m. on October 6 and continue until 6 p.m. Counting of votes will take place on October 9, and the results will be declared.



Both the Assembly segments were declared vacant following the resignation of Maragatham Kumaravel and P. Sathyabama on May 25

Results recap

An overview of how political parties fared in Madurantakam and Dharapuram constituencies in the 2026 Assembly elections

	Madurantakam (SC)	Dharapuram (SC)
Electorate	2,12,666	2,22,434
Votes polled	1,98,251	1,99,944
Voter turnout (in %)	93.22	89.89
AIADMK+	69,284 (34.95%)	81,100 (40.56%)
DMK+	59,838 (30.18%)	64,373 (32.2%)
TVK	62,090 (31.32%)	46,438 (23.23%)
NTK	4,950 (2.5%)	6,026 (3.01%)



Edappadi K. Palaniswami

Voters will teach TVK candidates a befitting lesson: EPS

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Sunday said the voters in the Dharapuram (SC) and Madurantakam (SC) Assembly Constituencies, where byelections are scheduled to be held on Tuesday, will teach the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) candidates a befitting lesson.

'People are aware'

"People are aware that the TVK cadre are trying to deceive them and get votes. It is certain that voters in these two constituencies would teach a befitting lesson to these two TVK candidates, who had betrayed the AIADMK," Mr. Palaniswami said in a statement.

It is nobody's business when or how many times I meet my people: Vijay

R. Krishnamoorthy
DHARAPURAM

The scorching afternoon heat did not deter the supporters of TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at the roadshow in Dharapuram (SC) on Sunday, the final day of campaigning for the byelection.

Sporting bandanas and scarves, scores of school and college-going boys and girls, a number of them waiting with their parents, besides youths and the elderly, were seen rooting for Mr. Vijay as his convoy passed through. And, an equally-enthusiastic Mr. Vijay could also be seen waving to the crowd. The supporters had come hours ahead from across Dharapuram (SC) constituency and from places, including Vellakovil and Pollachi, to catch a glimpse of the Chief Minister. Mr. Vijay reached Dharapuram from the Coimbatore airport in a helicopter.

Addressing his supporters, Mr. Vijay hit back at his detractors over their reported criticism of his frequent visits to Madurantakam and Dharapuram constituencies as they are about to go to polls. "I am not the one visiting constituencies only during elections. It is nobody's business when or how many times I meet my people," he said.



Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay during a roadshow in Dharapuram on Sunday. M. PERIASAMY

Mr. Vijay questioned the "impudence" of DMK president M.K. Stalin in body-shaming P. Sathyabama, his party's candidate for Dharapuram (SC) constituency. "I can put up with such comments, but I will never tolerate disrespect to women," he said, observing that insulting women had been the DMK's wont right from the days when M.G. Ramachandran was the Chief Minister.

Voters will teach a fitting lesson to the father-son duo (Mr. Stalin and Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin) for their "obscene" comments, Mr. Vijay asserted, and claimed that the DMK had already conceded defeat.

Throughout the roadshow, Mr. Vijay hopped down from his campaign van at several places amid heavy security cover. At one point, he took a short ride on a bullock cart, and at another, the Chief Minister stopped to receive a petition from an aggrieved supporter.

He also interacted with drumstick farmers in Mulanur and took cognisance of their long-time demand for a cold storage plant for value-addition and listened to the grievances of livestock farmers.

Mr. Vijay offered prayers at the Mulanur Vanjiamman Temple before resuming his campaign on his way back to the helipad.

TVK is obsessed with purchasing MLAs to protect its govt., says Stalin

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin on Sunday appealed to the voters of the Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies to vote for the DMK candidates, alleging that the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) was only interested in "purchasing" MLAs to protect its government.

In a speech posted on his social media page, he said Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay was not worried about pressing issues but was interested in constructing a new Secretariat on the advice of an astrologer. "He is least bothered about the protests by fishermen and farmers. Instead, he will visit London to watch a car race. When murders have become the order of the day, he will be busy releasing reels about the 'Singappen Special Force'," he said.

He appealed to voters who had "chased away" the ruling party candidates while campaigning to defeat them in the byelections. "You should disappoint the TVK, which seeks to cheat the people by releasing reels and projecting false claims as achievements. There will be no betrayal of voters in the future only if you teach a lesson to the ruling party and its candidates who defected to it," he said.



> He is least bothered about the protests by fishermen and farmers. Instead, he will visit London to watch a car race. When murders have become the order of the day, he will be busy releasing reels about the 'Singappen Special Force'
>
> **M.K. STALIN**
> DMK president

Mr. Stalin asked the voters to consider why the byelections had become necessary in their constituencies barely four months after the Assembly election. "While the other MLAs are studying the requirements of their constituencies, the MLAs whom you thought would be loyal to you have come back to seek votes. Is there any justification for their act? Do they have even an iota of concern for your welfare," he asked. He alleged that the MLAs of the two constituencies had "sold the self-respect" of the voters by "selling themselves" in the "horse race" of the ruling party. "Are you ready to believe their lies and false stories," he asked.

Mr. Stalin alleged that the MLAs, after receiving "boxes" from the ruling party, were claiming that they could serve the people only by becoming members of the ruling party. "Is it true? If the ruling party alone can do good for the people, all MLAs belonging to the other parties should have joined the ruling party. A government cannot afford to ignore a constituency merely because it is represented by an Opposition party MLA," he said.

Mr. Stalin also rejected as "untrue" the claim that the DMK and the AIADMK had planned to come together to form a government. He said the byelections had been necessitated by the "betrayal" of a political party by its own MLAs.

Later in the day, Mr. Stalin urged Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to respond to allegations that money was being distributed in tiffin carriers during his street-to-street campaign in the Madurantakam and Dharapuram constituencies.

In a social media message, he said there was also an allegation that a rate had been fixed for votes for every street. "Political parties (CPI(M)) supporting you to form the government are also making the allegation. What is your response?" he asked.

Mr. Stalin also wanted to know whether there would be an end to horse-trading or whether a new season of horse-trading would begin. "You blew your own trumpet as a clean force. But in four months, your reels have snapped," he added.

Private bus operator urges High Court to declare 'Vettri Payanam' unconstitutional

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

A writ petition has been filed in the Madras High Court challenging the constitutional validity of the Tamil Nadu government's 'Vettri Payanam' (victorious travel) scheme, which offers no-fare travel for women and transwomen passengers in 12,695 government buses across the State.

A private bus operator, N. Kalamani of Bhavani taluk in Erode district, has approached the court complaining that the scheme would cause private transporters heavy losses, and they might have to wind up their business. The petitioner said private bus operators would not only stand to lose women passengers but also the men because families would prefer travelling together in government buses in which the women need not pay any fare.

The writ petition, urging the court to declare 'Vettri Payanam' unconstitutional, has been listed for hearing before the First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan on Monday.

Explaining her case in detail, the petitioner said she was a widow who had two daughters to take care of. She held permits to operate buses on the 47-km route from Erode to Vellithiruppur and another on the 88-km route from Kakapalayam to Anthiyur.

The petitioner had employed about 15 people and their families, too, were dependant on her business. She feared that hardly any passenger would step into her buses on the two routes since a significant number of government buses were operated on those routes.



The writ petition has been listed for hearing before the First Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan on Monday.

She said the government had come forward to spend a whopping ₹6,000 crore a year on compensating the State Transport Corporations towards 'Vettri Payanam' aimed at benefitting 84.32 lakh women daily. However, a request made by the Federation of Bus Operators Associations of Tamil Nadu to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on July 22, 2026, for extending the scheme to private bus operators did not yield the desired result, she claimed.

Ms. Kalamani said not collecting any fare from women passengers in government buses alone would go against the principle of ensuring a level playing field in the bus transport sector and thereby violate Article 14 (right to equality) of the Constitution. Though 'Vettri Payanam' was an expansion of the 'Vidiyal Payanam' scheme introduced by the previous DMK government, the petitioner said the previous scheme was limited in its scope and did not affect the private operators to a great extent.

'Fares mandatory'

The petitioner also relied upon various provisions of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, as well as the Tamil Nadu Motor Vehicle Rules, 1989, to contend that collection of fare from the passengers was mandatory and the government could not announce no-fare travel. Further, claiming that the scheme had been implemented on the basis of an announcement made by the Chief Minister under Rule 110 in the Assembly and without any Government Order, the petitioner said such an act offends Article 161 of the Constitution.

She urged the court to declare the Chief Minister's announcement, published by the Information and Public Relations Department (DIPR) on August 24, 2026, as unconstitutional and also grant an interim stay on it until the disposal of her writ petition.

BJP agent tried to get 7,561 electors deleted in Ballari

Karnataka Police file FIR against booth-level agent who repeatedly tried to submit Form 7 in bulk to remove voters' names; complainant says most of the voters belonged to a minority community

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU



Cracking the whip: Of the previous five FIRs filed in Karnataka for misuse of Form 7 applications, three names BJP members as accused. FILE PHOTO

Claiming that more than 7,500 electors were either "absent or had shifted", a BJP-affiliated booth-level agent (BLA) in Karnataka tried to first submit Form 7 applications (seeking deletion of names) and, after his claims were not accepted by the election authorities, again sought "revision" of their names by submitting objections, even though these voters figured in the draft electoral roll of the Ballari City Assembly constituency.

In this regard, a first information report (FIR) was registered at the Brucepet police station on October 1 against the agent, T. Srinivas Mothkur, who is also the Opposition leader of the Ballari City Corporation.

The FIR books the accused under Section 353 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, for "statements conducing to public mischief". Mr. Mothkur, BJP's BLA-1, had sought deletion of names of 7,561 electors.

Sixth in State

The FIR, filed on a complaint from a Congress BLA, is the sixth one registered in Karnataka regarding misuse of Form 7.

Of the previous five FIRs, two filed in Belagavi and one in Mysuru names BJP members as accused.

The FIR followed a series of attempts by Mr. Mothkur to submit the objections. On September 21, he wrote to the Ballari City Corporation saying that while he was trying to submit Form 7 applications through the booth-level officers (BLOs) concerned, many of them had refused to accept them. Since only a few BLOs considered his applications, he took the remaining ones directly to the electoral registration officer (ERO).

In their response the same day, election authorities from the Ballari City Corporation said Mr. Mothkur's claims that the voters were already registered elsewhere, absent or had permanently shifted "were not supported" by documents or other information. The ERO said that while the BLAs were allowed to submit applications in bulk, they could not submit more than 10 applications to a BLO at a time or in a day. If a BLA submitted more than 30 applications during the claims and objections period, the ERO or AERO had to personally cross-verify them. The BLA was also required to submit a list of the applications along with a declaration that he had personally verified the particulars and was satisfied that they were correct, the ERO's letter said.

Following this response, Mr. Mothkur made another attempt the following day.

On September 22, he wrote to the election authorities saying that he was ready to submit objections against 7,561 voters in the draft electoral roll of the Ballari City Assembly constituency. He enclosed the list of names and sought necessary action "at the earliest".

The election authorities again rejected his claim, arguing that it was not possible to verify the voters' registration merely on the basis of the complaint.

'Names re-verified'

Following Mr. Mothkur's repeated attempts to seek deletion of the names, Congress BLA Goutham S. filed a complaint with the police. He said that at some polling stations, election officials had re-verified the names based on Mr. Mothkur's objections. He also alleged that the majority of the voters belonged to a minority community.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Mothkur said that he had not sought deletion of the names but had only provided the details to the ERO to verify.

Fake death records used for deletion; inquiry ordered

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI

Attempts were made to remove about 1,046 Muslim voters in Bijapur, alleges Congress leader

K. Anand, Deputy Commissioner and District Election Officer (DEO), Vijayapura, Karnataka, has ordered an inquiry into allegations that some objectors in the city had created false death certificates to seek the deletion of names of some voters under the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

This follows a memorandum submitted by at least eight people who presented themselves before the district electoral office in Vijayapura on Saturday.

They said they had been declared dead in Form 7 applications by some objectors in the city, who had used fudged documents.

Allama Bagwan, a government school teacher, was shocked to find that someone had submitted a third-party objection under Form 7, saying she had died. The booth-level officer (BLO) informed her that an application had been submitted stating she was no more. "The BLO visited my house and collected details from me. He assured me my name would not be deleted. I was shocked to find out that someone had managed to procure a death certificate saying I was dead," she told officials.

'Yatnal targeting voters'

Similarly, Abdul Razak Bagwan, Malanbi Jamadar, Mumtaj Mulla and four others were shocked when they learned that documents showing them as dead had been submitted to delete their names.

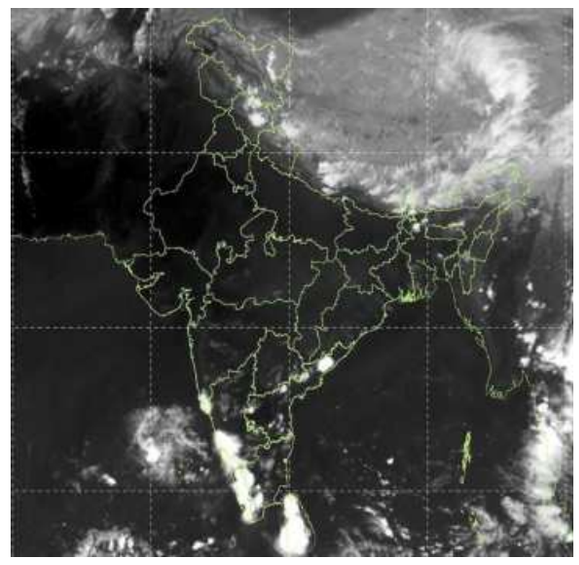
This was flagged by Congress leaders who went from door to door to find out if there were mismatches between the existing rolls and the current SIR exercise. They found some followers of Basangouda Patil Yatnal, an expelled BJP MLA, had filed objections to inclusion of these names, after affixing fake death certificates of at least eight people along with Form 7 applications seeking their deletion.

"They also found that the certificates were issued by competent authorities, but lacked details. In several cases, the names of parents or spouses did not match with those of the victims. This is a clear case of Mr. Yatnal and other Hindutva leaders trying to target Muslim voters. We demand a comprehensive investigation and legal action against those responsible for this," Abdul Hamid Mushrif, a Congress leader, told reporters on Sunday.

He claimed that attempts were made to remove about 1,046 voters belonging to the minority community, across 198 polling stations of the Bijapur city constituency, by falsely claiming that they were dead.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 17.00 HRS)

Forecast for Monday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over coastal Karnataka, Kerala, Mahe, south interior Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal. Thunderstorm with lightning and gusty winds likely at isolated places over Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Uttarakhand.

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	34.4	26.6	Kurnool	—	37.3	26.2
Ahmedabad	—	37.4	23.8	Lucknow	—	34.7	24.0
Aizawl	37.3	30.0	21.6	Madurai	—	36.6	25.6
Bengaluru	—	31.4	21.6	Mangaluru	36.6	32.5	24.5
Bhopal	—	35.4	18.2	Mumbai	—	34.4	25.6
Bhubaneswar	—	34.4	23.0	Mysuru	—	32.6	19.0
Chandigarh	—	35.0	22.8	New Delhi	—	36.3	23.2
Chennai	—	34.4	26.3	Patna	—	33.6	—
Coimbatore	—	34.4	24.4	Port Blair	—	32.1	25.7
Dehradun	—	32.1	21.4	Prayagraj	—	35.6	23.2
Gangtok	1.0	20.8	17.2	Puducherry	—	35.8	24.7
Goa	—	33.5	25.4	Pune	—	33.3	17.4
Guwahati	—	31.9	25.0	Raipur	—	34.4	23.9
Hubballi	—	32.0	22.0	Ranchi	—	30.6	19.0
Hyderabad	—	34.0	23.7	Shillong	—	—	—
Imphal	2.0	29.1	18.7	Shimla	—	26.6	16.5
Jaipur	—	37.5	26.0	Srinagar	—	31.2	11.7
Kochi	—	31.0	26.4	Thiruvananthapuram	—	32.4	24.6
Kohima	3.0	18.0	13.2	Tiruchirappalli	—	36.5	26.6
Kolkata	3.5	33.7	27.3	Vijayawada	—	—	—
Kozhikode	—	36.2	27.2	Visakhapatnam	—	33.4	33.4

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.74	..88	10	... 122	...180	
Bengaluru	.24	..23	50	 88	...139	
Chennai	...7	..11	15	 63	93	
Delhi	..—	112	36	... 166	...273	
Hyderabad	...6	..17	12	 96	...132	
Kolkata	.10	..17	50	... 204	...101	
Lucknow	..—	..10	41	... 164	...118	
Mumbai	...4	..46	55	... 131	...136	
Pune	..—	..21	.—	 67	...132	
Visakhapatnam	..—	..—	..7	..... —	.....—	

Air Quality Code: Poor, Moderate, Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Noida, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 281 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Kaithal, Haryana recorded a healthy AQI score of 31.

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Six lakh more houses to be built in A.P., says Union Minister

G.V.R. Subba Rao
VIJAYAWADA

Union Rural Development Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Sunday said the Centre would sanction another six lakh houses for Andhra Pradesh, in addition to the three lakh houses currently being taken up under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G) 2.0.

Addressing a public meeting at Burripalem in Tenali mandal after laying the foundation for the construction of three lakh houses in the State, Mr. Chouhan said another three lakh houses would be sanctioned by the time the ongoing construction was completed and an additional three lakh houses would also be allocated to the State.

Praise for State govt.

Praising Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu, Mr. Chouhan said Andhra Pradesh was emerging as a leading State in the country under his leadership.

He said the Centre was providing ₹6,000 a year to farmers and the State government was adding another ₹14,000 under the Annadata Sukhibhava scheme, taking the total annual assistance to ₹20,000.

Addressing the gathering at Tenali, Mr. Naidu said the Centre had initially sanctioned 75,000 houses under the regular quota, but three lakh houses were sanctioned following a special request made by the State. He said the State government aims to achieve 100% coverage under the housing initiative by 2029.

Rooting for rice



Wobbly weather: Workers plant paddy saplings in a field at Puzhakkal in Thrissur on Sunday, as moderate rainfall over the past three days brings some relief to farmers. The southwest monsoon has officially ended, with Keralam recording a 28% rainfall deficit, receiving 1,446.5 mm against the normal 2,018.6 mm. Large parts of the State are facing drought-like conditions. K.K. MUSTAFAH

Gyanesh may face suicide abetment case in Keralam

K.S. Sudhi
KOCHI

A two-decade-old suicide case of a Malaysian engineer has come back to haunt Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, with the Keralam government receiving a legal opinion to proceed against him for abetment to suicide.

The incident pertains to the period when Mr. Kumar was serving as the secretary in the State Public Works Department.

Lee See Been, the Malaysian engineer and former chief officer of a World Bank-aided road reconstruction project, had allegedly committed suicide, citing delay in payments



Gyanesh Kumar

and harassment by government officials and the PWD Ministry.

The World Bank-funded project was implemented by PATI-Bel, a joint venture between PATI of Malaysia and Bhageeratha Constructions, Kochi. The joint venture firm was supposed to construct the 127-km M.C. Road stretch at ₹215 crore. The delay in release of funds and payments of bills reportedly pushed the company into crisis and eventually forced Been to take the extreme step. He had reportedly left behind two suicide notes.

T. Asaf Ali, Director-General of Prosecution, has given legal advice to the State government that there is no legal bar in proceeding against Mr. Kumar.

Been reportedly "committed suicide due to extreme mental stress caused following the harassment perpetrated on him by Mr. Gyanesh Kumar, which is evident from the suicide note of the deceased", according to the legal note.

(Those in distress can reach Tele Manas at 14416)

R. Sreelekha drops resignation plan, to continue as councillor

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

A day after R. Sreelekha, Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) councillor of the Thiruvananthapuram Corporation in Keralam expressed her desire to quit as Sasthamangalam ward councillor, she appears to have done a U-turn with BJP leaders, including State general secretary S. Suresh and Mayor V.V. Rajesh, saying she would continue in her position.

Ms. Sreelekha reportedly mentioned in her ward's WhatsApp group on Saturday that she had informed the Mayor through a letter on September 30 about resigning as a councillor for personal reasons.



R. Sreelekha

The Mayor had tried to downplay the development, saying Ms. Sreelekha had only handed over a letter expressing personal inconveniences. He did not confirm if the letter communicated her resignation.

On Sunday, Mr. Suresh posted a photograph of him visiting her in a hospital. He said Ms. Sreelekha had merely expressed her concern to close associates about whether she would be able to effectively discharge her duties as a people's representative, which later became fodder for media speculation. Her post in the WhatsApp group was also reportedly deleted on Sunday.

CPI(M) leader V. Sivankutty told presspersons on Sunday the "resignation drama" needed to be seen only as a threat from Ms. Sreelekha to the BJP to gain new positions.

Ms. Sreelekha, a former Director-General of Police, had earlier made clear her displeasure at being overlooked for the Thiruvananthapuram Mayor post.

Activists worry coal mine near Ramappa Temple may harm heritage site and lake

P. Laxma Reddy
HYDERABAD

Heritage activists, including the Kakatiya Heritage Trust (KHT), are demanding the withdrawal of the proposed PVNR opencast coal mine at Venkatapur in Mulugu district of Telangana, contending that the project could pose a long-term threat to the UNESCO-inscribed Kakatiya Rudreshwara Temple, popularly known as Ramappa Temple, and the adjacent Ramappa Lake.

To mount pressure on the State government, they are planning to mobilise people from 15 villages and organise mass protests after the Dasara festival, against the proposed mine.



Old glory: UNESCO-inscribed Rudreshwara Temple, aka Ramappa Temple, was built by the Kakatiyas in the 13th century. NAGARA GOPAL

As part of the campaign, a delegation met Union Coal and Mines Minister G. Kishan Reddy in Hyderabad on Saturday and urged him to intervene and stop the proposed project. They said the Singareni Collieries Company Ltd. (SCCL) was reportedly gearing up to take up the project despite concerns raised by conservationists.

Quoting technical observations, former Professor of NIT-Warangal M. Pandu Ranga Rao said the proposed mine would be located about 5 km downstream of the lake and temple and involve excavation to a depth of about 300 metres. He said that a Geological Survey of India report contended that the water level in the lake could influence groundwater movement through geological lineaments and faults towards the proposed mine.

Mr. Rao further pointed to the sand-box foundation of the nearly 800-year-old Ramappa Temple and said interconnected lineaments passing through the lake and temple area could potentially affect the foundation through piping. "The temple is already showing signs of distress, " the KHT representative added.

Two or three?

Students must be free to choose a third language not tested in a Board exam

The Supreme Court, through its frequent interventions, is pointing to the various aspects of the three-language policy that the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) does not seem to have thought through. Regardless of its eventual judgment, the Court's intent at this stage seems to be to point to the pitfalls of the policy and at least soften the rough edges. In its latest ruling, the Court has said that current Class 6 students should be given the same relief as students in Classes 7, 8 and 9, whose final Class 10 examination will only be an internal assessment, not a Board examination. The Court is seeking to lessen the load on the students, at least until schools are fully prepared. It had earlier asked if the policy could start from 2027, not 2026. The CBSE has stubbornly resisted compromise at various stages in the hearing. Earlier, the Court had intervened to point out that suddenly learning a new language in Class 9 would be too disruptive if the students had not studied a second "Indian" language until Class 8. The Court had also mooted careful consideration of treating English as indigenous, putting its categorisation as a foreign language under question.

English is a de facto Indian language. It has been in use in India for at least 300 years and is the leading language of education, courts, and professions widely practised by Indians; it also serves as the preferred link language for many. English knowledge has consistently given Indians an edge in employment in global industries such as the IT sector. Indians will want English to remain one of their unique selling points as the government looks to jobs in global industries as a pathway to prosperity. The National Education Policy 2020, though advocating for two Indian languages, also mentions the importance of learning foreign languages to facilitate the global mobility of Indians seeking employment. *The Hindu*'s reportage has shown that since English is the language of instruction in other subjects, it will become the only so-called foreign language students will take in CBSE schools. Many schools will stick to Sanskrit as the second Indian language all the way up to Class 10 while Hindi would be the first. Some schools, especially in the southern States, will continue with the regional language such as Tamil or Kannada as the other Indian language. The practical consequence of the current policy is removing Spanish, French and other foreign languages from schools. But any purported intent of promoting cross-regional language learning may just not be served though the Court has found merit in learning more Indian languages as a way of strengthening the federal structure. A strenuous learning of an additional Indian language serves little practical purpose though it may cater to the atavistic impulses of some. The two-language policy – English and mother tongue – would be best for India. Students can be tested on a third language of their choice through internal assessment, not through a Board examination.

Outbound force

The United States is leaving Iraq in weariness, if not defeat

The United States invaded Iraq in March 2003, saying that Saddam Hussein's regime possessed weapons of mass destruction (WMD) and harboured terrorist groups. In 2011, then U.S. President Barack Obama announced America's withdrawal, but its troops returned when the Islamic State captured huge swathes of territory in Iraq and Syria. On September 30, 2026, more than 23 years after the invasion, U.S. troops finally left Iraq, in the midst of another American war in the region. The war on Iraq has been one of the gravest strategic and humanitarian disasters of the 21st century. The WMD claim turned out to be false, if not an outright lie, while al-Qaeda built one of its most violent branches in post-war Iraq. The destruction of Saddam's Ba'athist state and the abrupt rise of Shia parties widened social cleavages, triggering a deadly civil war, killing hundreds of thousands of Iraqis. The disastrous consequences of George W. Bush's war did not end there. Al-Qaeda in Iraq transformed into the Islamic State by 2014 and spread terror across the region and beyond. The Popular Mobilisation Forces (PMFs, or Hashad al-Shabi), an umbrella of Iran-backed Shia militias, have since emerged as a state within the state.

Saddam's Iraq, despite its hostile relations with Gulf monarchies, was a buffer between the Arab Gulf countries and Iran. When Saddam's regime was toppled, Iran extended its influence across Iraq through Shia parties and militias. It is an irony that the U.S. is leaving Iraq at a time when it is trying to defeat Iran in a major regional war. But beneath the irony lies everything that went wrong with America's regime-change wars, which destabilised parts of West Asia, gave rise to militias and jihadists and exposed the limits of American power in the region. When the U.S. and Israel began bombing Iran on February 28, Hashad joined the war. Since then, Iran and its allies have carried out at least 600 attacks on U.S. military and diplomatic facilities in Iraq, a stark reminder to Washington that maintaining troops there had become unsustainable. If in Afghanistan the U.S. exited after 20 years of war leaving the country in the hands of the same Taliban that it had toppled in 2001, in Iraq, America is leaving behind a war-ravaged country in the hands of a weak government and powerful militias backed by a resurgent Iran. Iran and its allies have vowed to push the U.S. out of West Asia. They may not have the wherewithal to achieve that goal, but they have managed to drive the U.S. out of Iraq.

The ECI's constitutional mandate is under strain



P.D.T. Achary

Former Secretary General, Lok Sabha

Never before has the Election Commission of India (ECI) been subjected to such public opprobrium as it is witnessing today. This constitutional body has always enjoyed the admiration of people both within and outside the country. Indeed, the reputation of India's ECI has been global, because of its competence, impartiality and unwavering commitment to democratic norms. But today, its reputation is in the mud because of its actions in recent times, which smack of illegality, partisanship and worse. The manner in which it has carried out the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in various States shows an utter disregard for the law and a disdain for procedural correctness and constitutional propriety.

Electoral fears

The debate in the Constituent Assembly on the Election Commission (Draft Article 289) throws light on the thinking of its members about the functioning of this constitutional body. There was, in fact, unanimity among the members, including the Chairman of the Drafting Committee, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, that the ECI should be outside the control of the executive. Dr. Ambedkar was quite emphatic on this point. He said, "So far as the fundamental question is concerned that the election machinery should be outside the control of the executive government there has been no dispute."

The members were conscious of the danger of an election commission being under the control of the government, which would undermine the integrity of the election. In fact, the proposal in the Draft Constitution was for a decentralised election machinery under which each province would have a chief election commissioner who would oversee the preparation of electoral rolls and the conduct of elections to the State legislatures. Elections to Parliament, as well as to the offices of the President and the Vice-President of India, would be conducted by a chief election commissioner at the Centre.

This proposal was rejected by Dr. Ambedkar himself, who moved an entirely different Article proposing to centralise the election machinery. The reason for rejecting the proposal and deciding to centralise the election machinery was that there had been instances in the provinces of large-scale deletion of voters regarded as opponents of the ruling party by the Chief Election Commissioners (CEC) of the States. These Commissioners were mostly political nominees of the Chief Ministers.

A new Article was therefore introduced, providing for a central Election Commission consisting of the CEC and other Election Commissioners (EC), with the responsibility of preparing electoral rolls and conducting elections to Parliament, State legislatures and the offices of the President and the Vice-President. It is an irony that, almost 80 years later, the same complaints against the CEC – of large-scale deletion of voters from electoral rolls without strict adherence to the law – have come up. The greater irony is that the ECs themselves have voiced complaints about the "illegal and unconstitutional" acts of the CEC.

The Election Commission of India's conduct raises serious questions about legality, accountability and constitutional propriety

It is interesting to note that senior members of the Constituent Assembly, such as Shibban Lal Saxena, had expressed the fear that a party in power in the future might appoint a staunch party loyalist as the CEC, who could manipulate the election machinery in favour of the ruling party. To avoid this, his suggestion was that any person appointed by the President should have to be approved by Parliament by a two-thirds majority, along the lines of the United States Senate's confirmation of senior-level appointments.

The point is that the Constitution-makers could foresee the danger of a CEC acting in the interests of the ruling party and thereby subverting the entire constitutional scheme governing elections. It now appears that their fears were not unfounded.

An uncertain legal foundation

The SIR that has stirred up the present controversy is, in fact, not backed by any clear legal provision. Section 21 of the Representation of the People (RP) Act, 1950, provides for the preparation and revision of electoral rolls. It states: "The electoral roll for each constituency shall be prepared in the prescribed manner by reference to the qualifying date and shall come into force immediately upon its final publication in accordance with the rules made under this Act" [Section 21(1)].

"The said electoral roll shall ... be revised in the prescribed manner by reference to the qualifying date – (a) before each general election to the House of the People or to the Legislative Assembly of a State; (b) before each by election; and (c) shall be revised in any year in the prescribed manner by reference to the qualifying date if such revision has been directed by the Election Commission" [Section 21(2)]. Under Rule 25 of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, a revision under Section 21(2) may be either intensive or summary, or partly intensive and partly summary.

There is yet another category of revision in Section 21(3), which says: "Notwithstanding anything contained in sub-section (2), the Election Commission may at any time, for reasons to be recorded, direct a special revision of the electoral roll for any constituency or part of a constituency in such manner as it may think fit." The words "any constituency or a part of a constituency" make it abundantly clear that this special revision is meant to be done only in a limited number of constituencies where special circumstances exist. Thus, intensive revision and special revision are two different types of revision under different circumstances. The above provisions make it clear that there is no mention in the law of a special intensive revision. How, then, could the ECI conduct a revision that is not provided for in law? Article 324 does not empower the ECI to do things against the law.

Under this Article, the ECI can exercise powers in respect of matters that are not covered by statute. Otherwise it is bound to act in accordance with the law

The cost of unilateralism

According to media reports, 13 crore Indian voters have already been removed from the electoral rolls across the country as a result of the SIR operations. Perhaps this is the biggest disenfranchisement exercise ever undertaken in any democratic country in the world. This exercise, needless to say, violates Article 326, which provides for universal adult suffrage and the right of eligible citizens to be registered as voters, subject to disqualification under law. The scheme of Article 326 is to include eligible voters, not to exclude them. But the objective of the SIR seems to be to exclude the maximum possible number of voters from the electoral rolls.

This huge mess has been created by the now obvious unilateralism that prevails in decision-making within the ECI. The appalling state of affairs in the domain of decision-making has been brought to light by the two ECs; according to them, they were not kept in the loop when crucial decisions were taken by the CEC.

The ECI is a constitutional body, and the procedure for decision-making is well laid in the law. A decision taken unilaterally by the CEC is not a valid decision, and all actions that follow from it have no legal validity. This creates a real constitutional crisis.

Opposition parties are preparing to move an impeachment motion against the CEC for serious misconduct. The CEC can be impeached in the same manner and on the same grounds as a judge of the Supreme Court of India. For the CEC to be removed, however, misbehaviour must be proved. The law also empowers the presiding officers of the two Houses of Parliament to disallow an impeachment motion at the threshold.

This provision could frustrate any attempt by Opposition Members of Parliament to initiate proceedings against either a judge or the CEC. Further, Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, further fortifies the CEC and other ECs by providing lifelong immunity from any civil or criminal liability. It may be noted that even the President of India does not enjoy such lifelong immunity. Such is the level of protection provided to the CEC and the other ECs. It is no wonder, therefore, that the Constitution, the law and citizens appear to have become helpless before an omnipotent ECI.

Colby's mid-term report card, what it means for India



Anil Raman

Retired Brigadier and a research fellow at the Takshashila Institution

Elbridge A. Colby, the United States Under Secretary of War for Policy, has delivered a mid-term assessment of the Donald Trump administration's defence strategy a month before the mid-term elections in the United States. His recent update on the 2026 National Defense Strategy shows how Washington is converting the administration's priorities into policy.

The strategy focuses on four main goals: defending the U.S. homeland, deterring China, gaining more support from allies and partners, and rebuilding the U.S. defence industry. These priorities indicate clearly how Washington plans to manage its relationships. The U.S. wants its partners to be stronger, contribute more, and assume greater shares of the costs for regional security. India should consider this background when looking at the new American approach.

A different bargain with partners

For many years, the U.S. supplied much of the military strength behind its alliances and partnerships. Colby's approach now demands that partners take more responsibility for security in their own regions. Europe is being urged to lead on its own defence. South Korea is expected to do more on the Korean Peninsula. Japan and Australia are also being asked to play a bigger role in the Indo-Pacific.

This new model combines American strategic leadership with stronger regional partners. The U.S. keeps its advanced capabilities, strategic coordination, and extended deterrence, while partners are expected to provide more troops, infrastructure, funding, and industrial support.

China is still the main strategic concern. The National Defense Strategy aims to stop China from dominating the Indo-Pacific by focusing on deterrence, especially along the First Island Chain. Meanwhile, the Trump administration is also negotiating with Beijing on trade and other matters. So, military competition and economic talks are happening simultaneously.

The evolving defence strategy of the United States offers India an opportunity to build leverage

This has important implications for India. India's value to Washington is substantially based on China and the Indo-Pacific, but the U.S.-China relationship can shift between competition and cooperation. So, Indian and American interests will often overlap but will not always align.

Russia is another factor into this new approach. The U.S. wants to lower its costs in the Ukraine War and expects Europe to take more responsibility for its own security. At the same time, the U.S. still wants to limit Russian military power and influence. For India, this connects directly to its defence ties with Russia, its energy needs, and its desire for strategic autonomy.

Europe shows this trend most clearly. Washington is urging European countries to build up their own defence capabilities. For India, the lesson is that strong regional partners are becoming more important in U.S. strategy.

What this means for India

India has a unique place in this new system. Its location, military potential, position in the Indian Ocean, technology goals, and role in the Indo-Pacific make it important to Washington. These interests have stayed mostly the same across different U.S. administrations.

The main change is in the contributions to the relationship. Washington now expects India to help keep the regional balance, work more closely on defence, join technology and supply-chain projects, and build up its military strength.

India also has good reasons to aim for these goals. It is building partnerships with France, Europe, Japan, Australia, the Gulf, and others, while keeping important ties with Russia and other countries. These connections give India more capabilities and strategic choices.

This leads to a key question for the next stage of India-U.S. relations. The U.S. wants India to be stronger and do more for the Indo-Pacific balance. India wants to build its strength, partly to have more freedom to act on its own. Gaining leverage will therefore become increasingly important. A country's importance to Washington does not automatically determine the terms on which Washington negotiates with it. Leverage does. Economic scale, military capability, technology, market access and the ability to offer or withhold strategically important capabilities all contribute to bargaining power.

The China example

China is a useful example. Its economic and technological strength gives Beijing the tools to influence the U.S.'s decisions. As India's capabilities and economy grow, it will also have more influence in its relationship with Washington, but gaining that leverage will take time.

Colby's mid-term report shows that the U..S is putting more value on capable partners, regional responsibility, and shared contributions. For India, this is a big opportunity. A stronger India is more valuable to the U.S. and better able to look after its own interests.

New Delhi's strategic task is to build that capability while keeping the freedom to use it. This means India needs to work more closely with Washington, but also keep building its own defence industry, technology sector, and partnerships. The next phase of India-U.S. relations will be shaped less by whether the two countries are strategic partners and more by the terms on which two increasingly capable powers cooperate.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Stronger sporting system

India's campaign at the Aichi-Nagoya 2026 Asian Games has concluded with 21 gold, 27 silver and 37 bronze medals. Despite finishing below its 2023 tally, the country witnessed the emergence of several new champions. India also performed exceptionally well in team events. India, however, needs a comprehensive sporting system that identifies talent at an early age, nurtures athletes through scientific training, provides quality coaching and gives them adequate international exposure.

John Deepak,
Avinissery, Thrissur, Keralam

India has proved its supremacy in both the men's and women's sections in popular sports such as hockey, cricket and kabaddi at the Asian Games. The nation has also excelled in athletics, archery, boxing, wrestling, shooting, sailing and golf. In hockey, Captain Harmanpreet Singh once again led from the front. The penalty-corner conversion rate remains a matter of concern.

S. Viswanathan,
Srirangam, Tamil Nadu

Singeetham Srinivasa Rao

The passing of film-maker Singeetham Srinivasa Rao leaves Indian cinema poorer (Inside pages, October 4). His dialogue-free *Pushpaka Vimanam*, the time-travel science-fiction film *Aditya 369*, the enchanting fantasy *Bhairava Dweepam* and the biographical drama *Mayuri* were genre-defying masterpieces. It is no wonder that he was lovingly called the "celluloid scientist". His classics will continue to inspire future generations.

Kshirasagara Balaji Rao,
Hyderabad

Corrections & Clarifications

In a report, "Boiler blast at Sri City pharma unit kills five" (Page 1, October 4), the accident happened at the TIL Healthcare facility in Sri City, and not at *"a unit of Tablets India Limited"*. Tablets India Limited and TIL Healthcare Private Limited are two separate and independent entities. An official statement from the district administration had mentioned the name Tablets India Limited.

The Readers' Editor's office can be contacted by Telephone: +91-44-28576300; E-mail: readerseditor@thehindu.co.in

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the full postal address and the full name.

How regulation stifles HEIs



Amruth G. Kumar

Professor, School of Education, Central University of Kerala

The Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBSA) Bill, 2025, which is currently under legislative review, is an attempt to overhaul the regulatory system of higher education. The reformist instinct that induced this move is familiar and based around the same general pillars – to ensure quality, accountability, minimum standards, and to prevent malpractice. Before the floor passes the Bill leading to yet another overarching regulatory apparatus, one question deserves serious scrutiny. Will regulation be a threat to the very quality it claims to protect?

The structural issue is not regulation in itself but the nature of 'governmentality' through the dominant logic of institutional life. When external supervision substitutes internal integrity, Higher Educational Institutions (HEIs) stop asking what is morally and intrinsically right and start asking only what are the minimum requirements to be maintained on paper. Alan Greenspan, economist and the former Federal Reserve Chair of the U.S., once observed that regulation built on force and fear ignores the moral base of society. Greenspan's insight is a familiar one in our higher education system: HEIs that meet every prescribed norm and criterion of the regulator, maintain impeccable files, and score high on the accreditation ladder, have classrooms where intellectual engagement lies dormant.

The fear produced by the regulator often undermines the integrity of HEIs and produces a serious pathology: HEIs optimise its academic engagements for the regulator rather than for the process of teaching and construction of knowledge. Under such a regulatory regime, teachers stop asking what makes a class worthwhile or engaging. Instead, they start documenting evidence to satisfy the inspection that awaits them during the annual self-assessment reports. University authorities are not interested in knowing how a faculty member cultivates the intellectual engagement of the students and future scholarship; instead, they are interested in knowing how their institutional scores with respect to ranking and accreditation can be maximised. The result is an ecosystem that nurtures a 'paper blizzard' or an evidence blizzard through digital documents.

Evidence over learning

Important players of this regulatory architecture include the University Grants Commission (UGC), the All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE), the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC), the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE) etc. The various regulations, orders, circulars, and guidelines produced by these regulators often have incongruences in them which lead to clarifications, producing yet more irregularities. For example, the UGC's Regulation (2018) says that teachers are expected to account for a 40-hour working week while being required to be physically available on campus for only five hours a day. Beyond the internal inconsistency, formulations of this nature risk converting the substance of intellectual engagement into an arithmetic exercise. An assembly line model of work and the panoptic surveillance conducted through the regulatory architecture creates a trust deficit that threatens quality teaching. This results in HEIs and teachers resorting to a mode of 'risk aversion', where innovation is stifled, and conventional mediocrity becomes the safest available option.

The strongest counter-evidence to the purported efficiency of the regulatory architecture already exists within our education system. The IISc, IITs, IIMs, NITs, and IISERs operate outside the regulatory architecture of India that governs all other HEIs. These institutions are not bound to follow the standardised formulas of regulatory agencies. They design and update curricula at their own pace, have a different process of recruitment, and enjoy more freedom in directing resources based on their own institutional strategy. If intensive regulatory mechanisms were the real engine of quality, our most tightly regulated universities and HEIs would have been outperforming the IISc, IITs, IIMs NITs and other similar institutions. This shows us that regulatory logic fundamentally misguided our national perspective of 'quality higher education'. If these institutions are also brought in to the ambit of the regulatory framework through the VBSA, another casualty is awaiting us.

The real test of the VBSA is to avoid reducing quality improvement to the updating of inspection portals, and to ask whether the new architecture can make our HEIs bolder hubs of teaching and inquiry.

If intensive regulatory mechanisms were the real engine of quality, our most tightly regulated universities and HEIs would have been outperforming the IISc, IITs, IIMs NITs and other similar institutions

The sore lack of hostels in DU



Abhai Maurya

Founder Vice-Chancellor of the English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad

The collapse of a five-storey building in Satya Niketan on September 6 in New Delhi, in which several young students who were staying there as paying guests were killed, was a tragedy waiting to happen. Its genesis, however, lies in the inadequate hostel accommodation at the University of Delhi.

This author has been associated with the management of three postgraduate hostels at Delhi University – as Provost of Jubilee Hall and the P.G. Men's Hostel, and as Resident Tutor of Gwyer Hall – which gave one the opportunity to understand the enormity of the issue.

While the University of Delhi has more than 80 constituent colleges, only approximately 10 of them have hostel accommodation. Most of these colleges are located in the main campus of the university such as Miranda House, St. Stephen's, Hindu, Hansraj, Ramjas, Kirori Mal, the Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC), Daulat Ram, and the Indraprastha College for Women.

Outside the main campus, only Lady Shri Ram College has a hostel.

The postgrad dilemma

Across all the postgraduate departments of Delhi University, there are only 7-8 hostels: Jubilee Hall, Gwyer Hall, PG Men's and Women's hostels, two International Hostels, and one hostel for students from the North East. The south campus of the university has only one women's hostel.

The total accommodation provided by all the undergraduate and postgraduate hostels taken together is approximately 2,500, if not less, whereas the requirement runs into tens of thousands.

Moreover, only the old colleges, as mentioned above, have hostel accommodation. While 30 to 40 colleges were established under different political dispensations in Delhi, none of them have attempted to provide hostel accommodation for new colleges created with its funds, nor does it require that hostels be built alongside other infrastructure in colleges.

Who is to be blamed?

The University administration should share much of the blame for failing to provide adequate hostel infrastructure for its departments and colleges. The administration abhors creating hostels within the University, viewing them as managerial headaches and major trouble spots. Some of the top brass within the University administration brazenly oppose more hostels stating that it would lead to trouble.

The central government also has an equal share in the blame. Budgetary allocations have been substantially slashed for higher education. Even the education cess that you and I pay on our food bills and similar purchases has been largely diverted to other heads.

In the name of privatisation, there is no consideration for human suffering. Hence, tragedies galore.

Another problem bedevilling the hostel administration has been the problem of hostellers overstaying their stipulated tenure, particularly in postgraduate hostels. As Provost of Jubilee Hall, this author once had to seek police assistance to evict some overstayers; some had been there for 10-15 years. In one case, the next generation had come to stay in the same hostel.

Preying on students

Due to such a shortage of hostels, the Paying Guest (PG) accommodations that proliferated around Delhi University and its colleges had a gala time, minting huge amounts of money from helpless students. Mukherjee Nagar, Hudson Lane, Vijay Nagar in the north campus, and Satya Niketan and others near the south campus are offshoots of DU's shortage of hostel accommodation.

These PG accommodations are hellholes where helpless outstation students have to literally languish. The Satya Niketan tragedy is only the culmination of a life that should be called death in disguise. These modern-day Shylocks brazenly extract the pound of flesh from hapless students.

The way out is to create large-scale hostel accommodation on a war footing. Given the will and desire, this can be done. For example, the English and Foreign Languages University (EFLU), a central university in Hyderabad, created hostel accommodation for approximately three thousand students, both Indian and foreign, in less than three years.

While 30 to 40 colleges were established under different political dispensations in Delhi, none of them have attempted to provide hostel accommodation on their campuses

Vithya Ramraj's record: how far has India come in 400m hurdles?

Vithya broke P.T. Usha's 42-year-old record to win bronze, while anchoring India to gold in the women's 4×400m relay and silver in the mixed 4×400m relay

DATA POINT

Devyanshi Bihani

As Vithya Ramraj entered the final stretch of the 400m hurdles in Aichi-Nagoya, the race for gold was still open for India at the 2026 Asian Games. Vithya and the UAE's Mariam Kareem were neck-and-neck over the final two hurdles, with Kazakhstan's Adelina Zems just behind them. But at the last hurdle, Vithya lost some ground as Mariam surged ahead to take gold in a Games-record 54.31 seconds, while Adelina moved past Vithya to claim silver in 54.58. The Indian crossed the line third in 54.75.

But by then, the colour of the medal had become almost secondary. Vithya had done what she had been trying to do since 2023, when she equalled P.T. Usha's 55.42-second national record that had stood for more than 40 years. She was 0.67 seconds faster than Usha and became the first Indian woman to break the 55-second barrier in the 400m hurdles. "I met Usha ma'am a year ago, and she said, 'Go for 54 seconds.' She encouraged me. So doing this today makes me so happy," she said.

She is now the fastest Indian woman in the event **(Table 1)**, but her record places her 187th on the all-time world list. That list is led by Sydney McLaughlin-Levrone, followed by Femke Bol and Dalilah Muhammad, whose bests are 50.37, 50.95 and 51.58 seconds, respectively (**Chart 3**). She remains more than four seconds behind the world's fastest mark, but has moved from 56th before the Asiad to 35th in the current world rankings, putting her among the leading athletes in the event today.

Moreover, the record places her among a relatively small group of the fastest performances in Asia, ranking 12th on the continent. Bahrain's Kemi Adekoya leads the regional list, while athletes from China, Kazakhstan and the UAE also feature prominently. The regional landscape was very different when Usha set her record in 1984. Until then, the 55-second barrier had been breached only by European athletes, with just one African athlete having gone under the mark. In fact, Usha remained the only Asian performance on the list until 1990 because World Athletics' historical list captures performances faster than 57.3 seconds only. Since then, the depth of competition in Asia has grown considerably, with 12 performances now under 55 seconds (**Chart 2**).

These broader improvements in performance have coincided with a steady progression in Vithya's own performances. Her best in the 400m hurdles was 59.7 seconds in 2018, which improved to 56.57 in 2022. In 2023, she matched Usha's record. Her best then stood at 56.04 in 2025, before she made her biggest improvement yet in 2026. Her coach, Nepal Singh Rathore, believes the progression in the hurdles cannot be separated from her improvement in the flat 400m. When Vithya began training under him, her coach said other coaches questioned why she was being prepared for both events. "Only when she runs well in the flat, she can run hurdles well. Because speed plays a major role in all events," he told *The Hindu*. And the progression in the two events, he added, has followed the same pattern: "Whenever she has improved in the flats, she has improved in the hurdles." Vithya's best time improved from 54.48 seconds in 2018 to 51.96 seconds in 2026. Over the same period, her hurdles best fell by nearly five seconds, from 59.70 to 54.75. (**Chart 4**)

The versatility her coach had sought to build through that training approach was on full display in her Asian Games campaign. She won a medal of each colour, anchoring India to gold in the women's 4×400m relay and silver in the mixed 4×400m relay, alongside her record-breaking bronze.

Record break

The data were sourced from World Athletics, the international governing body for the sport of athletics, covering track and field, cross country running, road running, race walking, mountain running, and ultra running

TABLE 1: Vithya's performance has moved up her current ranking to 35th. However, her 54.75 secs is still four secs behind the current record of 50.37 secs in 400m hurdle

India Rank	All-time world ranking	Current world ranking	Athlete status	Name	Time (in seconds)	Date
1	187	35	Active	Vithya Ramraj	54.75	28 Sep 2026
2	323	—	Retired	Pilavulakandi T. Usha	55.42	08 Aug 1984
3	456	61	Active	Anu Raghavan	55.84	27 Sep 2026
4	580	—	Retired	Akkunji C. Ashwini	56.15	25 Nov 2010
5	863	227	Active	Sinchal Kaveramma	56.76	19 Jun 2023



Winning smile: Vithya Ramraj with her three medals from the 2026 Asian Games at Aichi-Nagoya, Japan on September 29, 2026. R.V. MOORTHY

CHART 2: Seven Indian women find a place among the top Asian performers who have crossed the 57.3 secs mark. P.T. Usha was the only Asian to have crossed the 57.3 mark until 1990

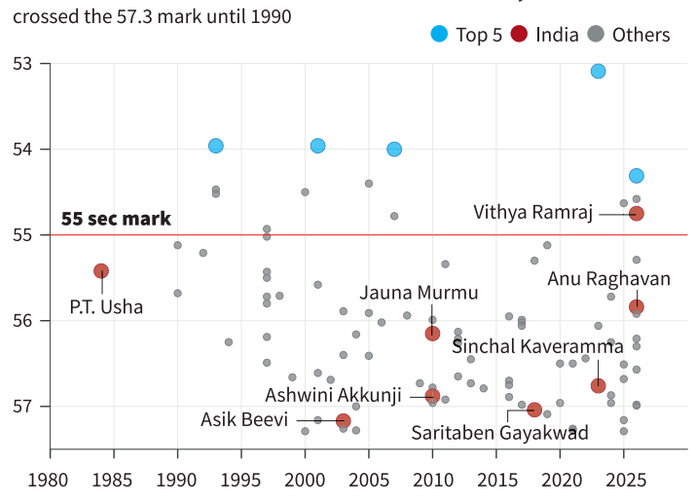
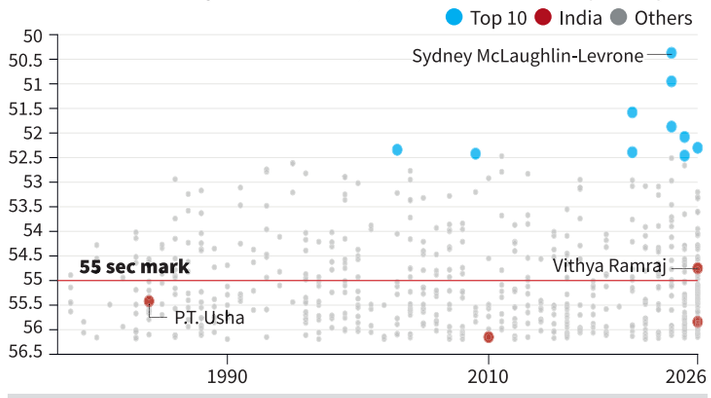
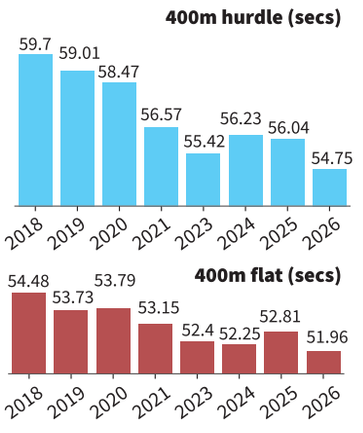


CHART 3: Only four Indians are among the top 600. Vithya, the only Indian to have broken the 55 seconds barrier, is in the 187th rank. P.T. Usha, Anu Raghavan and Ashwini Akkunji are in the 323rd, 456th and 580th ranks respectively



"Whenever she has improved in the flats, she has improved in the hurdles", Vithya's coach, Nepal Singh Rathore, told *The Hindu*

CHART 4: Vithya's gains in the 400m hurdles since 2018 happened simultaneously with her improvement in the 400m flat in the same period



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 5, 1976

Sri Lanka offers supply base facility to ONGC

New Delhi, October 4: The Ceylon (Sri Lanka) Petroleum Corporation is understood to have offered to provide facilities to the Oil and Natural Gas Commission (ONGC) for a supply base at the Trincomalee port in Sri Lanka for the latter's off-shore exploration in the Cauvery basin. The ONGC, which has greatly appreciated the offer will be deputing a team to Sri Lanka to examine and discuss the proposal further.

The Trincomalee port has got a good draft of about 70 feet and will be very suited for the berthing of supply boats that will be required for the transportation of heavy equipment once the off-shore exploration in the Cauvery basin gathers momentum. The Canadian company, Asamera of Calgherry, has completed its seismic surveys in the Cauvery basin and the selection of suitable drilling sites will be decided upon shortly.

Sri Lanka, which has been engaged in off-shore exploration on its side of the meridian line has already shown considerable interest in the exchange of data with the ONGC. The Ceylon Petroleum Corporation had earlier signed contracts with two U.S. companies, Ceyoil Corporation, a subsidiary of Pexamin pacific Inc, and Marathon Petroleum Corporation Ltd which have already drilled a few exploratory wells. The data being exchanged between the Ceylon Petroleum Corporation and the ONGC are expected to provide a complete picture of the encouraging oil prospects in the area. The facilities that will be available at the Trincomalee port for the ONGC in addition to the base in Madras will ensure greater cooperation between India and Sri Lanka in off-shore exploration.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 5, 1926

Newcastle Armstrong college

London, October 4: Two valuable gifts of oriental interest to the College Library are announced by Dr. Cochrane, Chairman of the Governors of the Armstrong College, Newcastle. The first is a present by Lady Richmond of the Oriental Library by her sister Miss Gertrude Bell, and the second is a gift from the Nizam of Hyderabad of a thousand sterling for the purchase of books on India.

From Page One

Over 500 detained amid stir against CEC in Delhi

Several videos of confrontations between protesters and the police in New Delhi were circulated on social media, one of which showed protesters purportedly breaking the rear window of a bus, in which they were being driven away, and jumping out.

The All India Students' Association (AISA) alleged that its national president, Neha Bora, was picked up by police personnel in a private car from Ashoka Road around 5 p.m. and that her whereabouts were not immediately known. The group alleged that the personnel who picked her up were not wearing name tags. She was later released from the Narela Industrial Area police station. Upon her release, Ms. Bora said, "They think we are dogs, cockroaches or insects that they can pick us up, throw us into vehicles, take us 50 kilometres away, beat us, and push us around. But today, we showed that we are citizens of this country."

Among those who joined the protest in the capital was 83-year-old screenwriter and director Saeed Akhtar Mirza. "These children have faced so much. History is being created, and I want to be a part of it," he said from a wheelchair.

In Mumbai, MNS chief Raj Thackeray sought the CEC's removal and called for electronic voting machines (EVMs) to be replaced with ballot papers.

Leaders from the Congress and the Nationalist Congress Party-Sharadchandra Pawar (NCP-SP) also participated in the 'Virat Garjana Morcha' from Metro Cinema to the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation headquarters, which drew nearly 6,000 participants.

Keralam orders graft inquiry against CEC

Officials said the Home Department has also sought the Crime Branch's findings from its 2006 probe into the accusations, for legal opinion, adding that Mr. Chennithala ordered the inquiry after Congress leader Malayankeezhu Venugopal filed a complaint. Notably, the Indo-Malaysian firm was contracted by an earlier United Democratic Front government led by the Congress.

Officials said Mr. Chennithala had also directed the VACB to re-examine the findings of an earlier vigilance inquiry ordered by former Chief Minister V. S. Achuthanandan after the Lee See Been controversy, which prompted the removal of Mr. Gyanesh Kumar as the State's PWD Secretary.

Mr. Venugopal, in his petition to Mr. Chennithala, had argued that the 2006 inquiries against Mr. Kumar circumvented due process and ignored the "incriminatory accusations" in Been's purported suicide note. He also accused the then Left Democratic Front dispensation of quietly scuttling the probe against Mr. Kumar and opening the door for the IAS officer to seek Central deputation.

Officials said the Keralam Home Department had also factored in the "damning findings" of the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG), who evaluated the initial phase of the road augmentation works by the firm when ordering the VACB inquiry. They said the CAG had faulted the PWD for releasing significant interest-free advances to the PATI-BEL "without proper field audit of the road work's progress".

Home department officials said the CAG had pegged the loss to the State treasury at an estimated ₹92 crore, laying the legal groundwork for a renewed anti-corruption inquiry.

(Those in distress can reach Tele Manas at 14416)

Talking to both Kyiv, Moscow: Jaishankar

The External Affairs Minister's comments came at a session of the Munich Leaders Meeting, held by Munich Security Conference, titled 'From New Delhi to New Momentum: Opportunities for Emerging and Middle Power Cooperation'. "We have conversations with both Russia and Ukraine [on the need for dialogue and diplomacy]," Mr. Jaishankar said. "We are trying to be helpful, starting with the Black Sea safety of shipping issue, but going beyond that to cover some immediate concerns which both of them have on grain exports, on energy exports, on non-attack possibilities. So those are ongoing conversations right now," he added.

Mr. Jaishankar's strong defence of India-Russia ties suggests that New Delhi will not reduce its Russian oil purchases, which currently account for over 50% of India's oil imports, even in the face of possible U.S. sanctions under a new law enacted on September 18. The comments came a day after Ukraine Foreign Minister Andre Sybiha told journalists in Kyiv that India had the "broadest" proposal amongst four countries that had offered to help resolve the conflict that began with Russia's invasion in February 2022.

In his speech, Mr. Jaishankar referred to the "changing global landscape" as a cause for concern. "The landscape today is primarily marked by a radical repositioning of the U.S., a repositioning which is a posture of choice, and where in a way it has deliberately become a lonelier power," he said, adding that another feature of the 'landscape' is the "rise of China, which sees itself as a unique country that it is in a way...and we are looking at very sharp competition...that has led to a weaponisation of any leverage that any country has."

Campaign wraps up for bypolls in 3 States, 1 U.T.

Polling, which takes place tomorrow, will be held in five Assembly constituencies in Bengal, T.N., and Puducherry, as well as to one Lok Sabha seat in Assam; the votes will be counted on Friday

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The campaign for the byelections in five Assembly constituencies in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, and Puducherry, and in one Lok Sabha constituency in Assam, ended at 5 p.m. on Sunday. Polling will take place on Tuesday, and the counting of votes is scheduled for Friday.

In Assam's Nagaon, where the Lok Sabha byelection will be held, the fight is expected to be among the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party, the Congress and the All India United Democratic Front (AIUDF).

The top three contenders are former bureaucrat Devasish Sharma of the BJP, former MLA Sibamoni Bora of the Congress, and Mohammed Badruddin Ajmal, an MLA and the chief of the AIUDF. The bypoll became necessary after Pradyut Bordoloi, who won the Nagaon Lok Sabha seat for the second successive time in 2024, quit the Congress and joined the BJP before the April 2026 Assembly election. He won the Dispur Assembly seat.

In West Bengal, bypolls will be held in the Nandigram and Rejinagar Assembly constituencies.


Puducherry CM N. Rangasamy during a campaign for the upcoming by-polls in Thattanchavady constituency on Sunday. PTI

In the high-profile Nandigram constituency, the election was necessitated after Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari won two seats in the State elections earlier this year and decided to vacate this one. He had defeated former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee in the Bhabanipur constituency and decided to retain that seat. The Rejinagar seat was vacated by Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) leader Humayun Kabir, who had also won Nowda.

Campaign controversies

The campaign in Nandigram was full of controversies, with Mamata Trinamool Congress candidate Sanchita Pradhan Dey withdrawing from the contest after meeting Mr. Adhikari, Ms. Banerjee subsequently deciding to support Congress nominee Milan Pradhan, and the latter then being arrested in connection with a 2007 anti-land acquisition agitation. Mr. Pradhan was granted bail by the Calcutta High Court on September 28, 10 days after his arrest. The BJP candidate for the seat is Hasirai Rath.

In Rejinagar, the BJP, Congress, the AJUP, as well as the two factions of the Trinamool Congress, are contesting.

In Tamil Nadu, the Assembly constituencies going to the polls are Madurantakam (SC) in Chengalpattu district and Dharapuram (SC) in Tiruppur.

The two Assembly segments were declared vacant following the resignation of Maragatham Kumaravel and P. Sathyabama on May 25, 2026. They were elected on All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) ticket, but resigned within three weeks to join the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK).

Multi-cornered fight

The byelections feature a five-cornered contest, with the TVK-led Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance, the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam-led Secular Progressive Alliance and the AIADMK-led National Democratic Alliance in the fray. The Left front is also contesting separately, while the Naam Tamilar Katchi is going it alone.

The Thattanchavady Assembly constituency in the Union Territory of Puducherry will also go to the polls on Tuesday. The seat fell vacant after Chief Minister and AINRC founder N. Rangasamy chose to vacate it and retain the Mangalam constituency.

3 Services propose improvements to Agnipath scheme

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI


The first batch of Agniveers are scheduled to complete their contractual tenure this year.

With the first batch of Agniveers set to complete their four-year tenure later this year, the Army, Navy, and Air Force have submitted recommendations to the Department of Military Affairs on ways to improve the implementation of the Agnipath scheme.

A senior Ministry of Defence official confirmed that the three Services had shared their suggestions based on their experience of implementing the scheme over the past four years. A report incorporating the recommendations has been sent to the competent authority for consideration.

This comes amid a renewed focus on the Agnipath scheme as the first batch of Agniveers, who enrolled in 2023, are scheduled to complete their contractual tenure this year.

Under the existing policy, up to 25% of each batch of Agniveers can be retained in the regular cadre based on organisational requirements and performance. Those retained go on to serve as regular armed services personnel, while the remaining 75% exit after four years.

The reassessment of the scheme comes as the armed forces seek to balance the objective of maintaining a younger force with the need for operational experience and continuity.

Introduced in June 2022, the Agnipath scheme marked a major change in the armed forces' recruitment policy. Under the scheme, young men and women between 17.5 and 21 years of age are recruited as Agniveers for a four-year period, including six months of training.

At the end of the engagement, up to 25% can be selected for permanent enrolment, while the remaining personnel exit the services with a tax-free Seva Nidhi package, which is built through monthly contributions from the Agniveer and matched by the government. Those exiting after four years do not receive any pension or gratuity benefits.

Two lynched in Siliguri over suspicion of cattle theft

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

Two men were killed and three others injured in West Bengal's Siliguri after a mob attacked them over suspicion of cattle theft on Sunday.

According to the police, around 3 a.m., a group of locals in Siliguri's Tarabari area intercepted a pick-up van and dragged the five passengers out. When they ran, the locals started chasing them, and caught four of them. They brutally assaulted them, leading to one of them dying on the spot. The rest were severely injured, and were later rushed to a hospital, where another person died.

Kuki man found dead in Manipur a day after abduction

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

A 71-year-old Kuki man was found dead on Sunday, a day after armed men allegedly abducted him at gunpoint in Kangpokpi district of Manipur.

Residents of Khunkho Kuki village, located near an Army base, said gunmen took Hemjang Haokip away after torching his house on Saturday. His body was found in a jungle about 24 hours later.

The Khunkho Kuki Village Authority condemned Haokip's abduction and killing. It urged the Manipur government to punish those responsible.

Locals suspected the assailants were members of a Naga extremist group.

The ethnic conflict in Manipur drew the State to a shutdown after violence broke out between the Kuki-Zo and Meitei communities. Later, tensions escalated between Kukis and Nagas, with most recent case of armed shooting reported on September 26, which claimed the lives of three Naga civilians.

The conflict has claimed more than 300 lives since May 2023. The State's Home Minister, Konthoujam Govindas, told the Assembly that 49 people remain missing since the conflict began.

BJP names ex-Trinamool MP Rukmini Mallick to RS

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Sunday nominated former All India Trinamool Congress MP Rukmini Mallick, aka Koel Mallick, to the Rajya Sabha.

Ms. Mallick was elected to the Upper House by the Trinamool Congress in April.

On July 16, the actor-turned-politician submitted her resignation to Vice-President and Chairman of the Upper House C.P. Radhakrishnan.

She is the fourth Trinamool Congress MP to be nominated to the Rajya Sabha by the BJP after resigning from the Upper House.


Rukmini Mallick is the fourth Trinamool MP to be nominated to the RS by the BJP.

Elections to 12 Rajya Sabha seats are scheduled for October 16.

On July 9, the BJP nominated three former Trinamool Rajya Sabha members – Sushmita Dev, Sukhendu Sekhar Ray and Prakash Chik Baraik – to the Upper House, hours after the three former MPs joined the BJP in Kolkata.

While the three MPs had officially joined the BJP, Ms. Mallick had met BJP leaders, including Union Home Minister Amit Shah, after she had resigned from Rajya Sabha.

'Trinamoolisation'

The nomination of former Trinamool MPs to the Rajya Sabha has sparked a debate about "Trinamoolisation of the BJP", with a section of party leaders saying that the party was accommodating those who fought against the BJP before the party came to power in West Bengal.

Govt. likely to release sixth Positive Indigenisation List in a few months

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

The Defence Ministry has reviewed the much-awaited sixth Positive Indigenisation List (PIL), which is now in the final stages of consideration and is likely to be promulgated within the next few months, a senior official said.

The review meeting was recently held by the Department of Military Affairs (DMA), during which a presentation on the proposed list was made to officials associated with the indigenisation exercise. "A review of the sixth list has been done and finally, after three years, the sixth list is under consideration and is in the final stage for approval. The list primarily contains items for the Navy and the Army. It will be out within a couple of months," the official said.


Such lists are aimed at restricting imports and mandating procurement of military equipment from domestic industry. PTI

The sixth list is expected to add another set of strategically important major Line Replaceable Units (LRUs), sub-systems, assemblies and other equipment that will have to be sourced from Indian industry after successful indigenisation.

The lists are aimed at providing a decisive impetus to the government's *Atmanirbhar Bharat* initiative in defence by progressively restricting the import of specified military equipment and mandating procurement from domestic industry.

Five lists

The DMA has so far promulgated five PILs comprising 509 items between August 2020 and October 2023. More than half of these items have since been indigenised, according to the government.

Of the 509, 191 items worth ₹3.40 lakh crore have been contracted, while Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) has been accorded for another 114 items worth ₹4.75 lakh crore. The remaining 204 items, valued at ₹5.41 lakh crore, are at various stages of development, according to official data.

The sixth PIL was expected to be released earlier but has remained under consideration as the Services and the Ministry examined the requirements and indigenisation potential of additional equipment.

The lists notified by the DMA are separate from those issued by the Department of Defence Production (DDP). While the DMA's five lists cover 509 major items, the DDP has promulgated six PILs covering 5,417 items.

Navy sailor held for leaking information to Pakistan operative

The Hindu Bureau
VISAKHAPATNAM

He met the woman operative on social media a few months ago, and developed a relationship with her

The Counter Intelligence Cell of the Andhra Pradesh Police has arrested a 31-year-old Navy sailor, Pradeep Mukherjee, for allegedly leaking classified maritime information to a Pakistani intelligence operative through a social media honey trap, sources said on Sunday.

Mr. Mukherjee, who joined the Indian Navy in 2014, is now posted in the Eastern Naval Command in Visakhapatnam. He was undergoing a training programme at Coimbatore when he was arrested on October 3.

Mr. Mukherjee met a woman Pakistani intelligence operative on social media a few months ago, according to preliminary information from the Counter Intelligence Cell.

Gradually, the operative developed a relationship with the sailor and allegedly obtained sensitive information from him about the Navy.

It was learnt that after detecting suspicious digital activity linked to Mr. Mukherjee, the Counter Intelligence Cell placed him under surveillance, before arresting him. Sources said that Mr. Mukherjee is being brought from Coimbatore in Tamil Nadu to Andhra Pradesh, using a prisoner transfer warrant.

He will be produced before the court at Vijayawada on October 5, sources said.

BJP questions Rahul's silence on valour of Captain Smit

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Sunday questioned the Congress over what it termed the Opposition party's "silence" on Indian pilot Smit Machchhar, who thwarted his co-pilot's alleged attempt to crash a Tel Aviv-bound flydubai flight.

Rajya Sabha MP and BJP spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi termed the lack of a statement from the Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi on the incident as, "the Gandhi family's silent support to terrorism".

"Rahul Gandhi, the wayward prince of the Gandhi family, who was once so distressed over Gaza, seems to be so terrified of the vote bank that he is not able to utter a single word to hail the valour of Captain Smit Machchhar," Mr. Trivedi said, demanding a response from the Congress' top leadership.

"Sonia Gandhi, the *rajmata* (queen mother) of the first family, whose eyes once welled up with tears for the accused (killed) in the Batla House encounter, has shown no trace of compassion for Captain Smit. The princess (an apparent reference to Priyanka Gandhi Vadra), who used to carry a bag bearing the Palestinian cause, has failed to produce even a handkerchief of sympathy from it," he added.

'En masse exclusion of voters unconstitutional'

Any process that disenfranchises millions, making them second class citizens, is arbitrary, says Justice Bhuyan; name of voter cannot be deleted from the roll without notice or hearing, he says

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Sunday said any process disenfranchising millions, making them second class citizens without the right to vote, was intrinsically arbitrary, and violative of universal adult suffrage and right to equality.

Speaking at NALSAR, Hyderabad, Justice Bhuyan said no amount of whataboutery could justify the exclusion of voters *en masse* from the electoral rolls as such an action was fatal to the Constitution.

The Election Commission's special intensive revision (SIR) has so far led to the deletion of approximately 13.3 crore voters from the electoral rolls.

Recently, former Supreme Court judge, Justice Rohinton F. Nariman, had drawn attention to the "astounding figure" of 90 lakh disenfranchised voters in West Bengal itself, questioning why the figure did not prompt the Supreme Court to stay the special intensive revision process. He had termed the exclusion of voters and delay in deciding their appeals "a completely illegal knocking out of the common man, the citizen of India, in order that a government obtains what it wants".

> One may be a billionaire, and one may be a rickshaw puller; yet both will have their votes, and the value of their votes would be equal. This is the transformational vision of the Indian Constitution
>
> **JUSTICE UJJAL BHUYAN**
> Supreme Court judge



Justice Bhuyan said the Constitution did not provide for two classes of citizens – those with voting rights and citizens without voting rights.

"Any process which leads to wholesale disenfranchisement of Indian citizens making them citizens without voting rights would be violative of Articles 326 (adult suffrage) and 14 (right to equality) of the Constitution, if any process results in disenfranchising millions and millions of Indian citizens making them second class citizens in their own country in the sense of being citizens without voting rights, such a process is intrinsically arbitrary. No amount of whataboutery can justify it. It strikes at the very heart of the Constitution" he said.

Justice Bhuyan said no one could tinker with universal adult suffrage. "No authority can do it; no court can condone it. No one is above the Constitution. Indian citizens' right to vote is intertwined with India's long years of struggle for freedom," he said.

Constitutional right

The judge said the right to be a voter was not merely a statutory right, but a constitutional right which came within the framework of the Basic Structure of the Constitution.

He said citizenship and franchise were intertwined, and one could not be divorced from the other. The right of franchise was the very essence of citizenship. It was the only way an ordinary citizen of India could participate in the governance of the country.

"Universal adult franchise is the right of every adult citizen to vote, free of qualifications of sex, race, religion, wealth, education or social status, subject only to narrow, reasoned exceptions... Except in the case of a dead voter, the name of a voter once enlisted in the electoral roll cannot be deleted without notice and hearing," he said.

He referred to how the Government of India Act of 1935 had dictated "partial franchise" to the Indian subjects of the British crown. People of 'Part A' States were allowed to vote on the basis of their qualifications, which included residence, taxation, property, literacy, community, marital status (for women), etc. They had only accounted for about 14% of the entire population.

The Constituent Assembly had, while embracing full and universal adult suffrage, found these restrictions arbitrary and retrograde.

"One may be a billionaire, and one may be a rickshaw puller; yet both will have their votes, and the value of their votes would be equal. Likewise a socially high placed temple priest on the one hand and a person belonging to the lowest strata of the society compelled to work as a manual scavenger have an equal vote with equal value. This is the transformational vision of the Indian Constitution," Justice Bhuyan noted.

EC releases video for EROs on SIR notice disposal; no written instructions so far

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Days after adding new options to its ERONET portal that allow Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) to dispose of notice cases without hearings or documents, the Election Commission (EC) is now explaining the changes to officials through a demonstration video prepared by the Election Commission's Information Technology (IT) Department, with no written documents circulated so far, sources told *The Hindu*.

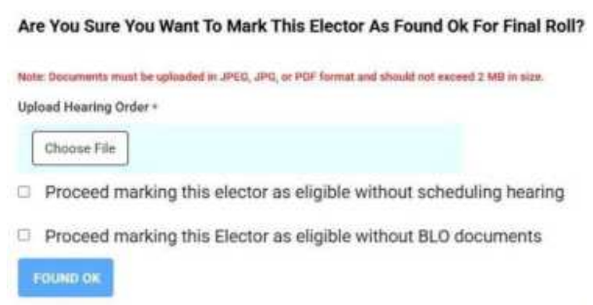
The three new options are available to the EROs in the 10 States and Union Territories where the third phase of the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is still under way, according to the video accessed by *The Hindu*.

The EROs across States, who have the final authority over the preparation of electoral rolls in their constituencies, had been asking for these options since the beginning of the notice phase. The changes come amid allegations of centralisation of ERONET under the ECINET software that "curtailed" the powers of the field officers.

The options have been introduced even as final rolls have already been published in nine of the 16 States and three U.T.s where SIR is under way, and 13 States and U.T.s where the exercise was completed in the first two phases.

In these States, including West Bengal where 27 lakh of the 60 lakh electors served notices were left out of the final roll, officials could not clear cases without hearings or documents. Over nine crore notices have been served in the second and the third phases so far.

The EROs in Delhi could access the options from September 30, while the eight-minute video explaining the changes was shown to them at a meeting on Saturday. Sources said the same video is being shown to the EROs in other States. It explains new options for generating notices without scheduling hearings and provides flexibility in disposing of cases where documents have not been submitted.



An option on the ERONET portal. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The EC has prescribed a list of 12 documents for electors served notices over "logical discrepancies" and "no mapping".

New options

According to the demonstration video recorded on October 1, as seen by *The Hindu*, in cases where a notice has been generated and the booth-level officer (BLO) has uploaded documents, the ERO can mark the elector "found OK" for inclusion in the final roll without uploading a hearing order.

Where no documents have been collected by the BLO, the ERO can still mark the elector eligible after uploading a hearing order and selecting the option "Proceed marking this elector as eligible without BLO documents".

Earlier, a hearing order was required only to mark an elector as "found not eligible", along with the reason for ineligibility.

For States where notices are yet to be generated, another option has been added at the notice-generating stage for electors in the draft roll categorised under "no mapping" and "logical discrepancies": The EROs can choose between "without hearing" and "with hearing".

The EC had said, in its September 26 release, that people receiving notices need not visit centres for hearings and that the BLOs would collect documents door-to-door.

Hearings, it said, would be held online only in exceptional cases. This option is of little use in States where all the notices have been generated.

For instance, in Delhi, all 33.1 lakh notices issued carry the hearing venue and time.

The notice phase there runs till November 30.

Where a hearing has already been scheduled, the new options allow an ERO to move an elector to the final roll without a hearing, provided either documents have been uploaded by the BLO or a hearing order by ERO.

While the new options let EROs clear notice cases faster, including those where documents are unavailable, based on their satisfaction, they still cannot reverse a case once an elector has been marked ineligible, officials said.

More than 350 electors in Delhi were marked "found ineligible", prompting the Delhi CEO to caution EROs against choosing the option without proper verification, *The Hindu* reported on September 27.

Notice phase in 9 States

The notice phase is under way in only nine States, with the final rolls in five of them set to be published later this month. The publication of Delhi's final roll has been pushed to December 4, while those of Haryana, Maharashtra and Telangana are scheduled for November and Tripura's for February 2027.

"Since SIR was announced, we have received a lot of instructions, some written and some oral. Many have since been taken back. For instance, we were told to identify 'suspected foreigners' along with Absent, Shifted, Dead and Duplicate, and then, in the middle of the enumeration phase in Delhi, we were told not to identify or report such cases. Though, as per the RP Act, I am authorised to take decisions, SIR guidelines have been very different. I will wait for a written communication regarding the use of the new options," an ERO, who did not wish to be named, told *The Hindu*.

3 women journalists allege sexual harassment by ACP

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

After a woman journalist alleged sexual harassment and being shoved by Assistant Commissioner of Police Vivek Bhagat while covering the protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar on Saturday, the Delhi Police said three such complaints have been received and transferred to the Crime Branch for inquiry on Sunday.

Earlier on Sunday morning, a New Delhi police official told *The Hindu* that no case had been registered so far, as there was no evidence to substantiate the allegation. The Crime Branch has still not filed FIRs in the cases.



Mediapersons protest against the assault on women journalists, outside a police station in New Delhi on Sunday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

"There were so many camerapersons. There should be some proof of the incident if it happened," the official said, alleging that the complaint was being made to target the police.

A woman journalist alleged that the incident took place when she was recording the detention of All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha Bora. In a video posted online, she said she had gone to the Parliament Street police station to register an FIR against ACP Vivek Bhagat. "When I questioned him, he ran away," she said.

Speaking to *The Hindu* on the fresh development, legal affairs head of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) Ratna Singh said the journalists and CJP representatives would still visit the Parliament Street police station on Sunday to demand registration of an FIR.

"The police can very well register an FIR and then transfer it to the Crime Branch for investigation. But FIR is a must, as the allegations are of molestation," Ms. Singh said.

2 more come forward

Two other women journalists have also come forward with complaints of sexual harassment against the same ACP, Ms. Singh said. The two journalists had made allegations against the officer in the past as well, but no FIR was registered. They have now lodged fresh complaints in connection with their earlier allegations, she said.

In an X post, Ms. Singh alleged that the police had refused to register an FIR and instead wanted to conduct a preliminary inquiry and examine CCTV footage before registering a case.

Next-Gen GST and India's next phase of growth



Nirmala Sitharaman

Union Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs

India's ambition to become a Viksit Bharat requires an economy in which enterprises of every size can grow, wherever they begin.

Over the past 12 years, our government has worked to create those conditions. The introduction of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) in 2017 established a common national framework for indirect taxation.

Next-Gen GST carries that effort forward, drawing on nine years of implementation and the experience of taxpayers and States.

Under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision, Next-Gen GST was conceived with two connected purposes: to reduce and rationalise rates, and to make compliance easier. The rate changes took effect on September 22, 2025. The next phase of process reforms will come before the GST Council shortly.

Together, these efforts seek to give households relief, businesses greater certainty and taxpayers a system in which they can fulfil their obligations without avoidable difficulty.

The States have been partners throughout. They brought their priorities and experience to the Council, helped shape the decisions and undertook their implementation. I thank them for that commitment. GST's progress rests on this willingness to pursue a shared national purpose while respecting each government's responsibilities.

The results provide grounds for confidence. Between October 2025 and July 2026, the value of reported taxable supplies grew by 25.8% over the corresponding period a year earlier.

A lighter rate structure has been accompanied by a substantial expansion in reported economic activity. This is an encouraging foundation for a reform intended to support both enterprise and public finances.

That resilience is visible in the latest revenue figures. Gross GST collections reached ₹12.46 lakh crore during the April-September 2026 period, up 11.6% over the corresponding period last year. Every month from June through September recorded double-digit annual growth; together, collections for these four months accelerated by nearly 15%. Net collections, after refunds, also grew by 10.4% over the half-year.

Taxpayer relief has coexisted with growth in the resources available for development.

The breadth of the expansion matters as much as its scale. Reported taxable supplies grew across all 11 sector groups and all major States.

In an economy as diverse as India's, this spread is significant. Growth across sectors and regions creates opportunities for more businesses to participate in expanding markets, and for more communities to benefit from the demand, investment and employment that follow.

Reported sales to consumers (B2C) also rose by 26.7% in the post-reform comparison. When tax relief is reflected in prices, families have more room to meet other needs or save. Consumer relief and enterprise growth are closely connected: the purchasing power of households sustains demand for the goods and services that businesses provide. The benefits can extend from the household to the retailer, the supplier and the producer.

For small and medium enterprises, a national market is valuable when it opens a practical route to customers beyond their immediate surroundings. Businesses in Tier-2 and Tier-3 towns should be able to build those relationships while continuing to invest and employ people locally. Enterprises expanding into these towns, in turn, can create opportunities for local suppliers and distributors. GST's common framework supports these connections; simpler administration must make them easier to sustain.

Participation in that framework is substantial. GST registrations across Central and State jurisdictions stood at approximately 1.71 crore at the end of August, up nearly 15% from a year ago. For the April-July 2026 tax periods, GSTR-3B returns filed by their due dates were 12.6% higher than for the same periods last year. These improvements place a corresponding responsibility on the administration: regular compliance must be supported by reliable service, clear guidance and timely resolution of difficulties.

The functioning of input tax credit is another important part of this experience. The post-reform figures show that the share of tax liability discharged through credits rose, while accumulated credit declined relative to taxable supplies. This is encouraging for businesses that depend on the effective use of eligible credit. For a smaller firm, working capital determines how readily it can purchase inputs, fulfil an order and take on the next one.

Refunds are equally relevant. Approximately ₹1.80 lakh crore was refunded during April-September. Returning amounts due to businesses is part of a well-functioning tax system. Greater predictability in this process would help enterprises plan purchases and production with more confidence. The taxpayer's experience of receiving an eligible refund is an important measure of administrative performance.

The States also have a stronger revenue position. Their aggregate SGST receipts, including their share of IGST settlements, grew by about 16% during April-September this year. These resources support investment in infrastructure and public services, which improve the conditions in which families and enterprises pursue their aspirations. The gains can therefore reinforce one another: household relief supports demand, enterprise strengthens economic activity, and public revenues help sustain development.

The experience also points to the work ahead. A growing system must remain attentive to the costs it imposes on smaller participants. Their time and resources are limited. Each improvement in filing, credit or refunds should allow more of those resources to be devoted to running and expanding a business.

The proposals before the Council on October 7 have been developed through sustained work with the States. They address registration, returns, refunds, disputes and improved flow of input tax credit, with the aim of reducing the time and cost of compliance. Taxpayer experience must continue to guide implementation.

GST's growing maturity gives us a stronger foundation for the next stage of reform. The same commitment to clarity, certainty and respect for the taxpayer guides our work on direct taxes. A dependable tax system enables enterprises to plan beyond their immediate obligations and invest in opportunities that take time to mature. Giving them that confidence, wherever they operate, helps build the economic strength of a Viksit Bharat as envisioned by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The taxpayer's experience of receiving an eligible refund is an important measure of administrative performance

INBRIEF



SC to hear *suo motu* case on Central Secretariat Library

The Supreme Court has taken *suo motu* cognisance of the proposed relocation of the 135-year-old Central Secretariat Library, which reportedly has not been allocated space in the Central Vista redevelopment plan in New Delhi despite being one of the country's oldest government libraries. The court's intervention comes amid reports that the library, which houses more than 8.5 lakh books, was directed on September 17 to vacate the premises by September 30 as part of the redevelopment. The matter will be heard on Monday by a Bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva.

Man held for molesting two women in Kolkata hotel

A woman and her companion from Nagaland's Dimapur were molested at Kolkata's JW Marriott hotel on the intervening night of Saturday and Sunday when the Brazilian football team was departing after a friendly match in the city. According to the police, the incident took place between 12.30 a.m. and 1 a.m. when the two were cheering for the Brazil team in the lobby of the prominent hotel. "The victims have lodged an FIR alleging that unknown miscreants touched them inappropriately," said Additional Commissioner of Police (Crime), Kunal Aggarwal. Later, the police arrested an accused, identified as Palash Ray, 56, a resident of Noida.

Mismatch in data on rabies deaths poses major challenge

Health Ministry's surveillance programme reported 50 deaths in 2023, while Registrar-General recorded 271 fatalities the same year; however, ICMR study says 5,726 people die of rabies annually

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

In 2025, India recorded 55 deaths by malaria, 131 deaths by dengue, and 27 deaths by kala-azar (black fever), according to data from the Union Health Ministry.

However, there is no single comparable and comprehensive national measure of its annual human rabies mortality, even as the country looks to eliminate dog-mediated human rabies by the year 2030.

A community-based study led by researchers from the Indian Council of Medical Research-National Institute of Epidemiology (ICMR-NIE) and published in *The Lancet Infectious Diseases* recently estimated that 5,726 people die of rabies in India every year.

The Health Ministry's Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme-Integrated Health Information Platform (IDSP-IHIP) system reported 21 deaths by rabies in 2022, 50 in 2023, and 54 in 2024.

The Registrar-General of India's Medical Certification of Cause of Death (MCCD) system recorded 66 medically certified rabies deaths in 2022, and 271 in 2023. The MCCD system, however, covers only medically certified deaths and does not capture all registered deaths.



On a mission: India plans to eliminate dog-mediated human rabies by the year 2030. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

These figures are not directly comparable – the IDSP-IHIP is a disease surveillance system, while the MCCD captures medically certified causes through civil registration.

At the national level, the MCCD covered 22.3% of registered deaths in 2022, and 22.0% in 2023. Neither system provides a complete national count.

For its study, the ICMR surveyed 337,808 people in 78,807 households across 60 districts in 15 States and estimated that India sees about 9.1 million animal bites every year, including about 5.6 million dog bites.

The researchers used the community survey, laboratory data, and a probability decision-tree model to estimate the number of people who progress from an animal bite to rabies and die. The 5,726 figure is therefore a modelled estimate of annual deaths, and not a count of deaths recorded in hospitals or by government surveillance.

The difference between the two datasets is substantial. The 54 deaths reported through government surveillance in 2024 is less than 1% of the study's estimated annual toll of 5,726.

"The two figures, however, are generated through different methods and should not be treated as directly equivalent," a senior Health Ministry official said.

Hurdle in eradication

"Lack of consolidated data is a challenge in rabies eradication. Very often cases and deaths occur in areas of the country where they are not measurable." Nirmal Kumar Ganguly, medical scientist, and former ICMR chief, told *The Hindu*.

The Health Ministry has also acknowledged the challenges in surveillance and data collection, especially when deaths occur outside the formal health system

Globally, rabies causes an estimated 59,000 human deaths every year. The World Health Organization (WHO) estimates that India accounts for 35% of rabies deaths globally, underlining the country's significant contribution to the global burden.

Bengal to bring laws to prevent love and land jihad: Adhikari

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Sunday said his government would bring stringent laws against "love jihad", "land jihad", and religious conversion after the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) is implemented in the State.

"The UCC will be implemented in West Bengal soon, I am giving my word. Give me only six months. After that, we will bring stringent laws against 'love jihad', and 'land jihad', and religious conversion," Mr. Adhikari said while addressing an event in Kolkata to mark the birth centenary of Vishwa Hindu Parishad's former president, the late Ashok Singhal.

The people of West Bengal had elected a nationalist government with a lot of hopes after 50 years, and his government would fulfil the aspirations of the people, the Chief Minister said.

The previous Trinamool Congress government had divided people on grounds of caste and community, the BJP leader said. "This government will not allow any anti-national activity here," he said, urging people to remain united and vigilant against "divisive forces".



Suvendu Adhikari ANI

Mr. Adhikari listed a series of upcoming events, including a recital of the *Hanuman Chalisa* by 20,000 people at the Netaji Indoor Stadium in November, and a mass recital of the *Bhagavad Gita* by 10 lakh people on December 29.

His government had started preparations for the Gangasagar Mela early next year, which would have facilities comparable with international standards, he added.

The BJP leadership had promised the implementation of the UCC in the State during its campaign for the 2026 West Bengal Assembly election.

Jaishankar meets chief of U.S. Indo-Pacific Command, discusses maritime security

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar on Sunday held talks with Commander of the U.S. Indo-Pacific Command, Admiral Samuel J. Paparo, on advancing the India-U.S. security partnership and strengthening maritime cooperation in the Indo-Pacific. U.S. Ambassador to India Sergio Gor was also present at the meeting.



Stronger ties: External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar with U.S. Commander Samuel J. Paparo in New Delhi. ANI

Admiral Paparo is on a five-day visit to India from October 3 to 8 as Washington seeks to deepen military-to-military cooperation with New Delhi and advance the Major Defence Partnership between the two countries. During his visit, Admiral Paparo is expected to hold talks with Indian military and government officials on a range of shared security priorities.

Maritime cooperation

The visit assumes significance amid expanding India-U.S. cooperation across the Indo-Pacific, particularly in maritime security, domain awareness, emerging technologies and military interoperability. It also comes as India and the U.S., along with Australia and Japan, continue to strengthen cooperation through the Quad, with free and open Indo-Pacific forming a key area of the agenda.

The U.S. described the broader defence partnership with India as one aimed at preparing both countries for emerging security challenges.

Two pregnant women die in Bihar hospital; kin allege negligence

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Two pregnant women died on Sunday in Bihar's Jamui Sadar Hospital allegedly due to a lack of care as doctors were unavailable. The family members accused the doctors of negligence and staged a protest by placing the bodies at the hospital's main gate.

Tension rose after Bihar Minister and Jamui MLA Shreyasi Singh visited the hospital and slammed the hospital management, with a video of the incident going viral.

In both cases, the family members alleged that the woman doctor on duty was absent and timely medical treatment was not provided. One woman died before delivery, while the other died after an operation.

One of the deceased, Anita Kumari, 28, was initially taken to the Primary Health Centre on Saturday night after experiencing labour pain, from where she was referred to the Sadar Hospital, family members said.

'No doctor'

Anita was brought to the Sadar Hospital around 11 p.m., where no doctor was allegedly present in the labour room. Health workers told the family members that the doctor would arrive only after an initial assessment, but the woman's condition continued to deteriorate throughout the night. She passed away around 5 a.m. on Sunday.

Aastha Kumari, 26, from Chauhandih village died after giving birth to a baby boy. Her condition was stable after surgery, but deteriorated around midnight. The family alleged that the woman doctor was not present in the duty room.

Child dies in mother's arm during three-hour trek to hospital in Meghalaya

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The villagers urged the govt. to ensure better road access to Domkyrkoh

The authorities in West Khasi Hills district of Meghalaya have sought a detailed report on the death of an ailing child during his parents' three-hour trek to reach the nearest hospital.

According to B. Syiem, the headman of Domkyrkoh village, the three-year-old boy died in his mother's arms before she could cover about 10 km on a hilly stretch from her home to Mawdet, where she could get a vehicle to take her to a healthcare centre.

"The boy's parents tried to arrange a vehicle after his health deteriorated at night on October 1. No driver wanted to come to the village because of the poor road conditions," Mr. Syiem said.

Members of the child's family set out the next morning to walk as fast as they could to reach Mawdet. Blaming the child's death on poor surface connectivity, the villagers urged the State government to save lives by ensuring a better road to Domkyrkoh. Taking note of the incident, the West Khasi Hills district administration sought a detailed report from the officials concerned.

Videos on social media platforms, purportedly showing the family carrying the child, triggered debates on access to emergency healthcare in remote areas of Meghalaya. Local people said the 10-km road to Domkyrkoh, through three other villages, was sanctioned months ago at a cost of ₹25 crore. The project was intended to improve the villagers' access to essential services.

Nurse recruitment

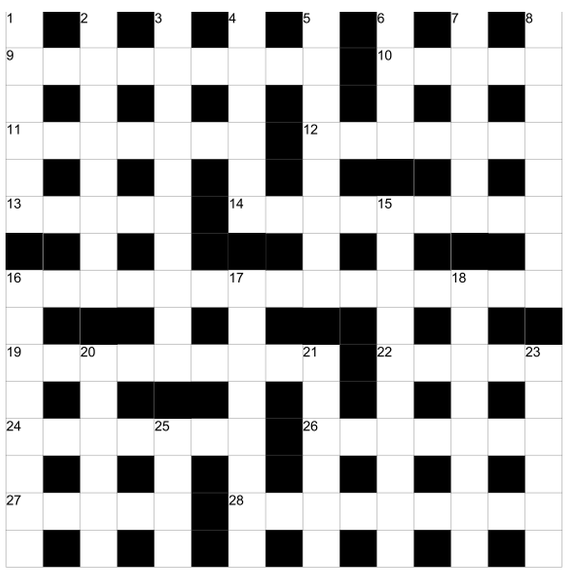
Meanwhile, West Khasi Hills district authorities have asked candidates shortlisted for staff nurse recruitment at the Mother and Child Health Hospital in Nongstoin to approach an inquiry committee with complaints about any irregularities in the selection process. The district administration constituted the two-member probe panel following allegations of gratification, bribery, extortion, coercion, and other irregularities linked to the recruitment process.

TH CROSSWORD + 14915

(set by Gussalufz)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

9 One gets complaints so dumb! Am flustered and close to exhaustion (9)
10 Wicked bouncer, jaffa? Look, concentrate, finally duck (5)
11 Take it quietly, go on (7)
12 Breathe fire (7)
13 Turn vessel collecting drip (5)
14 A question about relationships (9)
16 Sec. censored porn scattered in letters (15)
19 Maybe insert a comma in wordplay; cut roughly at end of phrase? (9)
22 Frenchman and German captured by spies backing trickery (5)
24 Tried miserably sad eyes (7)
26 First among desserts is cake trimmed with fudge (7)
27 Fierce dinosaur repelled after conclusion of dire struggle (5)
28 Secret of strep, one merciless bacterium (9)

Down

1 Enliven very plump-at-the-core small dog (4,2)
2 Witness some deliveries bearing "Bombay Stock Exchange" sticker at the bottom (8)
3 Student jam triggered change (10)
4 Victim: pedestrian hanging outside bar (6)
5 Tailless lizard — it can be black or red on top — from a Caribbean island (8)
6 Podcaster's sales pitches for supplements (4)
7 Some countered: London is actually a better place? (6)
8 Oracle up, reinforced by tax breaks (8)
15 The real aim, ultimately, is to start to reverse-engineer a semiconductor device (10)
16 Encrypted redesign of chip before sending, essentially (8)
17 Congratulations, extremely professional investigations! (8)
18 Minor employee can at last sign name (8)
20 More demanding about one's working post-retirement (6)
21 Editor passes on some current events (6)
23 Catholic feels sorry for priest getting ignored in urban areas (6)
25 Hairy creature regularly seen lifting in the gym (4)

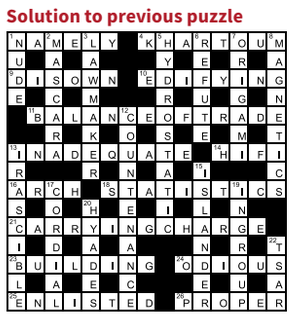
SUDOKU

				5		8		
		5		2	6	3	7	
						9	2	
		7				5	3	
	8		1		3		4	
	6	3				7		
	7	1						
	9	6	5	3		1		
		2		9				

No.SS7022 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

8	3	2	6	5	7	1	9	4
4	7	5	9	1	2	6	3	8
9	6	1	8	3	4	2	5	7
7	5	9	4	2	8	3	1	6
1	2	4	3	6	9	7	8	5
6	8	3	5	7	1	4	2	9
5	4	7	2	8	3	9	6	1
3	9	8	1	4	6	5	7	2
2	1	6	7	9	5	8	4	3

FAITH

Friendship in Mahabharata

Lord Vishnu manifested as twin sages Nara and Narayana at Badrinath to defeat the demon Sahasrakavacha (Dambhodbhavan), who possessed a thousand pieces of invincible armour due to intense penance and a boon from Lord Shiva, Tirukkudanthai Dr. Venkatesh said in a discourse. Later, Sahasrakavacha lost the war to Nara and Narayana, and with only one armour remaining, he fled to Surya Bhagavan and was reborn as King Karna with his final armour. Since he sought refuge with Surya Bhagavan, Karna possessed both good (devas) and bad (asura) qualities. Sages Nara and Narayana were born as Arjuna and Lord Krishna. Lord Krishna and Arjuna's alliance is based on devotion and righteousness. Good friendship elevates the soul, guides jivatma on the path of dharma, provides clarity during confusion, and leads to liberation.

In contrast, Karna and Duryodhana's friendship is flawed: it fuels ego, validates unethical behaviour, and ultimately causes the spiritual and physical ruin of both individuals. In Lord Krishna and Arjuna's friendship, Krishna bestowed the Bhagavad Gita, dispelled Arjuna's grief, and ensured spiritual victory. But Karna and Duryodhana's bond was unrighteous, driven by jealousy, ego, personal gain, unjust deeds, and humiliation of the Pandavas and Kunti. The battleground of the Mahabharata represents the constant moral struggles inside the human mind; the central message is that true friendship (*sat-sanga*) elevates the individual soul (jivatma) towards God (paramatma). A genuine friend guides you towards righteousness (dharma), offers wisdom in times of delusion, and aids in ultimate liberation (mukti).

Finances for raising a child

Rushabh Desai

Over two decades, India's parenting economics have shifted dramatically. Raising a child was once a low-cost endeavour; today, in a semi-urban and urban India, navigating a child's life from the delivery room to a postgraduate convocation demands meticulous, data-backed wealth management.

Data and inflation models suggest raising a child to age 25 costs a middle-class semi-urban or urban household ₹75 lakh -₹2 crore and an upper-middle-class family ₹2-4 crore, depending on lifestyle and city.

The figures are a baseline for proactive planning not a cause for panic. Understanding the data and harnessing long-term compounding lets parents secure a child's future without compromising on their own financial independence.

Expenses in three phases

Phase 1: Foundation Years (age 0-5). Maternity care, delivery and post-natal healthcare at private hospitals usually cost ₹1-₹5 lakh. Vaccinations, paediatric visits, diapers and nutrition add up while preschools and daycare in cities cost ₹1-2 lakh a year. Likely phase cost: ₹10-20 lakh.

Phase 2: Schooling Marathon (age 6-17). Sustained cash flow gets tested here. Annual fee at a private or international board school cost ₹1.5-4 lakh; extracurriculars, ed-tech subscriptions and lifestyle costs: yearly outflow reaches ₹3.5-6.5 lakh. Estimated phase cost: ₹40-80 lakh.

Phase 3: Higher Education Climax (age 18-25). The most capital-intensive hurdle. While inflation averages 5-6%, education inflation runs at 10-12% a year. A professional degree in commerce, engineering, medicine or arts can cost ₹25 lakh-₹1.5 crore, rising to ₹3 crore with a master's and PhD. If a shortfall remains, education loan interest stays fully deductible under Section 129 (formerly section 80E) for up to eight years. Estimated phase cost: ₹25 lakh to ₹3 crore.

The math seems daunting, but the solution is straightforward: start early, choose vehicles that systematically outpace education inflation.

Harness early equity

Time is your greatest asset. Starting a systematic investment plan (SIP) in diversified equity funds the month your child is born gives an 18-year compounding runway. Equity is the only asset class that beats 10-12% education inflation over the long term. An SIP of ₹20,000-30,000 a month, stepped up 10% annually, can build a pre-tax corpus of ₹2.88-₹4.32 crore at an assumed 12% CAGR and ₹3.89-5.83 crore at 15% over 18 years.

Tax-efficient govt. schemes.

For the debt portion, the public provident fund (PPF) offers tax-free compounding and for a daughter, the Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY) offers tax-free returns. Both qualify for the ₹1.5 lakh deduction under section 123 (formerly section 80C). NPS Vatsalya, a minor's NPS account that converts into a regular NPS account at 18, carries an additional ₹50,000 deduction under section 124 (formerly 80CCD(1B)), over and above the section 123 limit.

Risk-management wall

Wealth creation is futile without protection. Primary breadwinners should secure term life insurance worth 15-20 times annual income so a child's education stays funded even after an untimely demise. A comprehensive family health insurance policy is equally non-negotiable, protecting the corpus from being liquidated during medical emergencies. Raising a child to 25 is a multi-decade commitment comparable with funding a small enterprise though the returns are immeasurable. Acknowledging the data, factoring in education inflation and automating investments from day one turns financial anxiety into financial empowerment, building a launchpad for your child's future.

(The writer is founder - Rupee With Rushabh Investment Services)

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.



ILLUSTRATION-SAAI

Real estate exposure without buying a flat

Currently, home rentals yield little but commercial property pays decent yields and Real Estate Investment Trusts (REITs) are the vehicles to tap them and enjoy the returns

REALTY PLAY

Joydeep Sen

Buying a flat eats a big chunk of savings, ties you to one location, and takes months to sell when you need the money. Lack of liquidity is the biggest drawback of owning property directly.

There is another way. Let professionals pool money from investors, buy real estate, and hand you a slice. You pay a fee for this. These routes are open to Indian investors: REIT and fractional real estate. They look alike but are different.

A REIT

A Real Estate Investment Trust (REIT) collects money from investors and buys rent-earning property viz. office parks, shopping malls and warehouses. You do not have to identify a property, negotiate with sellers, get a large loan, deal with tenants/manage the property. REIT takes care of these activities. Your money buys REIT units which are listed on stock exchanges. You buy and sell them like a share. People often call a REIT a real estate version of ETF. That is loose talk. An ETF tracks an index. A REIT is a manager's choice of buildings and you live with what he picks. A closer comparison is a listed fund holding property instead of shares. In India, a REIT has to be set up as a trust. It normally holds its

> For someone who wants real estate exposure without high capital need, REITs provide an alternative. REITs are cheaper to enter and can be sold when needed.

buildings via separate firms viz. special purpose vehicles. The idea is to keep the legal ownership and debt of one asset from spilling onto another.

Thin rental yield

Homes give a thin rental yield..too thin for a vehicle built around rent, so Indian REITs are mostly commercial. The rules push the same way. At least 80% of REIT's assets must be completed and earning rent.. no half-built projects. The rule makes a REIT attractive. SEBI requires REIT to distribute at least 90% of net distributable cash flow. The same 90% applies at the SPV level, so rent travels up to you instead of sitting inside the structure.

Read the fine print on what you receive, though. The cheque is not one thing. It is a mix of interest, dividend, rent and sometimes repayment of loans, and each taxed differently. Check the split a REIT declares before you work out what you keep after tax. The return has two parts: payouts you collect and the gap between the price you paid and the price you sell. Rising building values do not reach you as income.

> Rent is not guaranteed, tenants leave, leases end, and payouts can fall. Do not treat REIT as a bond with a fatter coupon. Size it as a part of your portfolio, not whole of it.

They show up, if at all, in the unit price, and you cash in only when you sell. That price moves with the stock market and interest rates and can sit below what the buildings are worth. Since January, mutual funds treat REIT units as equity. However, it does not remove price swings.

You can start with one unit which gives a stake in top-grade offices and malls and sell on any trading day.

Fractional real estate

It works on a smaller canvas. A platform/realty firm finds a property, gathers investors and pools money. Each investor owns a share of the property, rent comes and you get a cut.

The trade-offs are plain. On the plus side, you know exactly what you own: the building, the tenant, the lease terms. A REIT gives you a portfolio. This gives you an address. On the minus side, it is one property, so one vacancy or one tenant default hits hard. And in the older, unlisted setups there is no exchange to sell on. To exit, you need another investor willing to take your share and that buyer may never turn up.

This space is no longer a free-for-all. In 2024, SEBI created a regulated version called the Small and Medium REIT, or SM REIT. It covers properties valued between ₹50 crore-₹500 crore, needs a minimum investment of ₹10 lakh and needs at least 95% assets to be earning rent. Units are listed, but with a ticket that large, expect thin trading.

Which one fits

The investor's goal should be to build a diversified portfolio. For someone who wants real estate exposure without high capital need, REITs provide an alternative. For most investors, REIT is spread across many buildings, cheap to enter and can be sold when needed. An SM REIT suits one with a larger cheque wanting concentrated bet and can live with a slow exit. A REIT is as good as those managing it.

Bottom line

Why real estate at all? Real estate does not always move in step with others. Both structures are a play on rental yield with some capital gain on top. Currently, home rentals yield little but commercial property pays decent yields, and these vehicles are how you tap them. One warning. Rent is not guaranteed, tenants leave, leases end, and payouts can fall. Do not treat REIT as a bond with a fatter coupon. Size it as a part of your portfolio not the whole of it.

(Joydeep Sen is a corporate trainer (financial markets) and author)

Gold, silver lose lustre in Sept.

PRECIOUSMETALS

B.Krishnakumar

Precious metals lost their sheen in September with both gold and silver clocking negative returns last month. The strengthening of the U.S. Dollar and the expectations of interest rate hike in the U.S. dented the sentiment towards precious metals.

The firming up of the crude oil prices did not help the cause either.

As a result, Comex gold closed 6.8% lower to settle at $4,189.1 per ounce by the end of September. Comex silver suffered a relatively steeper cut of 9.6% to settle at $60.75/ounce.

Mirroring the global trend, precious metal prices settled at lower levels in the domestic markets too. The fall in the domestic market was, however, smothered by the weakening of the Indian Rupee against the U.S. Dollar.

MCX gold fell 4.1% in September to settle at ₹1,149,092/10 grams. MCX silver closed at ₹2,23,740/kilogram, representing a 6.8% fall last month.

Gold weaker

Contrary to expectations, Comex gold price remained weak last month and also breached the support zone of $4,200-$4,220 mentioned last month. As a result, the short-term outlook has been invalidated, and the price is likely to remain range bound and witness volatile price action in the $3,900-$4,550 range.

A definitive trend in Comex gold will emerge only if the price manages to breakout either above $4,560 or below $3,900. Expect lacklustre and range-bound price action to persist until either of the levels are taken out.

Similar to gold, Comex silver price, too, remained weak last month and also dropped below the support level of $62.5. The short-term uptrend has now been invalidated and price is likely to remain stuck in the broad range of $54 to $69 on the higher side. The price action is likely to be volatile and devoid of any meaningful trend until either of these levels are broken.

MCX gold price too drifted lower last month and breached the support level of ₹1,48,000. This has negated the positive outlook, and the price is now expected to oscillate in the ₹1,41,000-₹1,59,000 zone. Expect a yo-yo kind of price action within this zone to persist in the near future.

Similar to gold, the positive outlook for MCX silver price, too, has now been invalidated as the price dropped below the erstwhile support level of ₹2,25,000. Expect domestic silver price to remain range bound in the ₹2,15,000-₹2,48,000 range in the near term.

Conclusion

To summarise, the erstwhile positive short-term outlook for both gold and silver have been invalidated. Precious metal prices are likely to remain range bound until the levels mentioned above are not breached.

(The author is a Chennai based analyst / trader. The views and opinion featured in this column is based on the analysis of short-term price movement in gold and silver futures at COMEX & Multi Commodity Exchange of India. This is not meant to be a trading or investment advice.)

Bank Fixed Deposit Rates

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%) Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Small Finance Banks				
AU Small Finance Bank	7.40	6.35	7.40	6.75
Equitas Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.10	7.10	7.00
ESAF Small Finance Bank	8.00	6.00	6.00	5.75
Jana Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.00	8.00	7.77
Shivalik Small Finance Bank	8.00	6.00	7.50	6.25
slice Small Finance Bank	7.75	6.25	7.50	7.00
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	8.25	7.25	7.25	8.25
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	7.80	7.25	7.25	7.20
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	8.10	6.00	7.50	7.00
Private Sector Banks				
Axis Bank	6.50	6.25	6.50	6.50
Bandhan Bank	7.45	7.00	7.25	5.85
City Union Bank	7.25	6.65	6.50	6.55
CSB Bank	7.10	5.00	5.75	5.75
DBS Bank	6.85	6.30	6.40	6.25
DCB Bank	7.50	6.90	7.00	7.50
Federal Bank	6.70	6.25	6.50	6.40
HDFC Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.40
ICICI Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.50
IDFC FIRST Bank	7.10	6.50	7.10	6.75
IndusInd Bank	7.00	6.75	7.00	6.65
Jammu & Kashmir Bank	7.05	6.55	6.70	6.75
IDBI Bank	6.55	6.20	6.35	6.25
Karnataka Bank	7.00	6.50	6.15	6.15
Kotak Mahindra Bank	6.65	6.35	6.40	6.25
RBL Bank	7.20	7.00	7.20	6.70
SBM Bank India	7.65	7.10	7.10	7.00
South Indian Bank	6.80	6.25	6.20	5.70
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.25	6.80	6.70	6.70
YES Bank	7.25	6.65	7.00	6.75
Public Sector Banks				
Bank of Baroda	6.75	6.25	6.25	6.30
Bank of India	6.85	6.50	6.70	6.00
Bank of Maharashtra	6.65	6.40	5.25	5.00
Canara Bank	6.60	6.25	6.25	6.25
Central Bank of India	6.75	6.10	6.00	6.00
Indian Bank	6.65	6.10	6.05	6.00
Indian Overseas Bank	6.60	6.50	6.10	6.10
Punjab National Bank	6.60	6.25	6.30	6.35
Punjab & Sind Bank	6.85	5.85	5.85	5.95
State Bank of India	6.45	6.25	6.30	6.05
Union Bank of India	6.55	6.20	6.10	6.00

Home Loan Interest Rates

(In %)

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.) Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
Public Sector Banks			
Bank of Baroda	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.25
Bank of India	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.25
Bank of Maharashtra	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90
Central Bank of India	7.00-9.15	7.00-9.15	7.00-9.15
Indian Bank	7.15-9.15	7.15-9.15	7.15-9.15
Indian Overseas Bank	7.20 #	7.20 #	7.20 #
Punjab and Sind Bank	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75
Punjab National Bank	7.30-9.30	7.25-9.20	7.25-9.20
State Bank of India	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55
UCO Bank*	7.15-9.25	7.15-9.25	7.15-9.25
Union Bank of India**	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60
Private Sector Banks			
Axis Bank	8.00-11.90	8.00-11.90	8.00 - 9.10
Bandhan Bank	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52
City Union Bank	8.25-9.50	8.50-10.00	8.75-10.50
CSB Bank	8.30 #	8.30 #	8.30 #
Federal Bank	8.35 - 10.50	7.35 - 10.50	7.35 - 9.50
HDFC Bank	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
HSBC Bank	7.45 #	7.45 #	7.45 #
ICICI Bank	7.55 #	7.55 #	7.55 #
Karnataka Bank	7.48- 11.80	7.48- 11.80	7.48- 11.80
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	7.60 #	7.60 #	7.60 #
RBL Bank	9.00 #	9.00 #	9.00 #
South Indian Bank	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30	7.90 - 9.30
Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)			
Aditya Birla Capital	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
Bajaj Housing Finance	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
GIC Housing Finance	8.20 #	8.20 #	8.20 #
Godrej Housing Finance	7.65 #	7.65 #	7.65 #
ICICI Home Finance	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
LIC Housing Finance	7.15 #	7.15 #	7.15 #
PNB Housing Finance	7.75-10.05%	7.60-10.05%	7.50-9.95
SMFG India Home Finance	9.25 #	9.25 #	9.25 #
Tata Capital	8.00 #	8.00 #	8.00 #

**Additional concession of 0.05% & 0.10% for women borrowers & takeover loans, respectively.
**Extra interest rate concession of 0.05% to borrowers opting for insurance policy.
Rates as on September 30 #Onwards Source:Paisabazaar.com

TEL AVIV

UAE had shared details of pilots, ahead of flydubai flight, with Israel



REUTERS

Authorities in the United Arab Emirates shared with Israel a list of passengers and crew ahead of the flydubai flight on which a pilot attempted to seize control of the Israel-bound aircraft and crash it, regional officials said on Sunday, raising new questions over how the attacker evaded detection. AP

YANGON

Nearly 1,500 Myanmar nationals return despite security concerns



AP

Nearly 1,500 Myanmar nationals who were sent back from Malaysia arrived in the country's largest city on Sunday. The returnees, including 86 women, have been convicted of staying illegally and other immigration violations in Malaysia. The UN has criticised the repatriation, saying the security remains volatile. AP

KAMPALA

Ethiopia's govt. retakes Mekelle after opposition fighters withdraw



AFP

Government-allied fighters entered Mekelle, the capital of Ethiopia's northern Tigray region, a witness said on Sunday, after the rebel Tigray People's Liberation Front (TPLF) announced its withdrawal following renewed fighting. The TPLF also pulled out of the Mekelle airport, which they had seized last month. AP

BEIJING

China says 'divergent opinions' led to lack of consensus at G20



ANI

China said on Sunday that "divergent opinions" fuelled by U.S. tariffs contributed to the lack of agreement on overcapacity and forced labour at the G20. The United States holds the rotating presidency of the Group of 20 major economies this year, which also includes China, India, France, Germany and Japan. AFP

No military solution to West Asia conflict, Iran's Araghchi tells U.S.

The Foreign Minister insists that only 'negotiations based on justice and fairness' can end war; he adds that if U.S. or its allies resume military confrontation, Iran's response 'will be stronger than before' and it will defend itself 'with even more force'

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran's top diplomat insisted on Sunday that there would be no military solution to the United States' war against the Islamic republic, with talks on ending the conflict apparently at an impasse.

A campaign of heavy bombardment failed to bring a decisive close to the war launched by the U.S. and Israel in late February, and Washington in recent weeks has dialled back military operations in favour of economic pressure.

The main point of contention remains Iran's attempt to blockade the Strait of Hormuz, a vital conduit for Gulf oil and gas where a U.K. maritime agency reported on Sunday another tanker struck by an unknown projectile.



Resolute stance: Abbas Araghchi speaks during a briefing with foreign ambassadors and diplomats in Tehran, Iran on Sunday. AFP

"If our enemies again choose the path of military confrontation, our response will be stronger than before, and we will defend ourselves with even more force," Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said at a gathering of foreign ambassadors.

"There is no military solution, nor any solution based on new sanctions," he continued, adding "only negotiations based on justice and fairness" could end the conflict.

The two sides agreed a memorandum of understanding in June that spelled out a framework for a permanent resolution, but Iranian attacks on vessels in the Hormuz prompted a return to U.S. military operations.

Meanwhile, Iran's Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf said that the Strait of Hormuz will not reopen until seven Iranian conditions set out in a June interim agreement with the U.S. are met.

He said Washington "must understand that the period of dragging out the [diplomatic] process and dictating one-sided demands is over".

Separately, Iran's Oil Minister Mohsen Paknejad has resigned and Hamid Bovard, chief executive of the government-owned National Iranian Oil Company, will be in charge of the Ministry as Acting Minister, state media said on Sunday, without providing a reason for the resignation.

Brazil's election pits Trump ally against incumbent Lula

Associated Press
SAO PAULO



Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva and Flavio Bolsonaro on the day of the general election in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, on Sunday. AFP

Brazilians began voting on Sunday in a high-stakes presidential election pitting incumbent Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva against Senator Flavio Bolsonaro, ideological opposites who are each seen as having a shot at an outright victory.

If no candidate gets more than 50% of the vote, the top two vote-getters will head to a runoff on October 25 in Latin America's economic powerhouse. Ten other candidates are expected to garner much smaller numbers of votes on Sunday.

Mr. Bolsonaro, 45, is the son of far-right former President Jair Bolsonaro and an ally of U.S. President Donald Trump. Lula, who at 80 is one of the world's oldest heads of state, is running in his seventh presidential election and has strengthened Brazil's ties with Beijing.

Trump allies have found support in recent years in some Latin American countries, including Argentina, Colombia and Peru.

Almost 159 million Brazilians are eligible to vote in this tense political showdown.

Where Mr. Bolsonaro has leaned into his ideological alliance with Mr. Trump, Lula has criticised Washington.

"Brazil needs change. Brazil can't stand so much suffering," Mr. Bolsonaro presspersons.

Short break



Life at sea: A ferry carries Marines from the *USS George H.W. Bush* to a pier near Phuket Deep Sea Port during a rest stop following a long deployment in the West Asia, in Phuket, Thailand, on Sunday. REUTERS

Yemen announces new drive to retake all Houthi territory

Agence France-Presse
TAIZ

The statement came just hours after the Houthis cut a vital supply route linking Taiz with Aden

The head of Yemen's presidential council, Rashad al-Alimi, announced on Sunday the start of a new military operation to retake all territory held by the Houthis (Ansar Allah), even as the group made fresh gains on the ground, effectively encircling a government-held city.

The announcement sets an ambitious goal for the embattled government, which recently lost large swathes of the country's Red Sea coastline and areas around the Bab el-Mandeb Strait after a lightning offensive by the Houthis.

Mr. Alimi called on all the armed forces "to begin carrying out their assigned missions, in accordance with the approved plans, until the country is liberated from the grip of the Houthi terrorist militia".

The statement came just hours after the Houthis cut a vital supply route linking the besieged city of Taiz with the government's interim capital Aden, according to four security sources.

Strike in Sudan kills one

Agence France-Presse
KHARTOUM

A strike on two United Nations food aid trucks in Sudan's South Kordofan state killed one of their drivers, the World Food Programme (WFP) said on Sunday, without specifying who was behind the attack.

SANJAY GANDHI INSTITUTE OF TRAUMA AND ORTHOPAEDICS
(Government of Karnataka Autonomous Institute)
Byrasandra, Jayanagar East, Bengaluru - 560 011
Ph: 080-26564516, 26944377, E-mail: sitodirector@gmail.com
No. SGITO/ACD/Fellow/15/2026-27 **Date:03-10-2026**

NOTIFICATION

Application are invited for Fellowship programmes for the academic year 2026-27 in Sanjay Gandhi Institute of Trauma and Orthopaedics, Bengaluru as per the guidelines and calendar of events issued by Rajiv Gandhi University of Health Sciences, Bengaluru vide Notification No: RGUHS/FELLOW/COE/69316/2026-27, Date:22.09.2026. The details are as here under:-

Sl. No.		Sl. No.	Subject	Durations in months	Number of admissions
1	Details, Duration and intake for the course	1	Sports Injury & Arthroscopy	18	04
		2	Arthroplasty	18	04
		3	Spine Surgery	18	04
		4	Advanced Orthopaedic Trauma	18	04
		5	Maxillofacial Trauma	18	02
		6	Ultrasound & Image Guided Advanced Nerve Blocks	12	04
		7	Advanced Trauma Anaesthesia	12	02
2	Eligibility	Candidate with NMC/MCI Recognized Post Graduate Degree in concerned specialty. **Or** Candidates with NMC/MCI Recognized Post Graduate Diploma in concerned specialty with three years experience (Copies to be enclosed) **Or** DM/MCH/DNB in concerned specialty 1. For Maxillofacial Trauma qualification – required MDS DMFS/Oral Maxillofacial Surgery 2. For Ultrasound & Image Guided Advanced Nerve Blocks & Advanced Trauma Anaesthesia– qualification required is MD /DNB Anaesthesia			
3	Stipend	According to Government Notification.			
4	Institutional / In-service candidates should send their applications through proper channel.				
5	For application format visit website www.sgito.org apply with Bio-data and relevant certificates. The duly filled in application should reach through by Registered post or In-person to this institute in sealed cover within **12-10-2026.** The candidate should super scribe on the envelope as **"Application for fellowship programme in the subject of _____ for the year 2026-27"**				
6	Application fee of Rs.4,000/- (for each subject) made by online payment to the following Account Name: **Principal, Sanjay Gandhi College of Nursing, Bengaluru-560011,** Account No: **64022675950,** IFSC Code: **SBIN0040675, State Bank of India, NIMHANS, Bengaluru** and online payment Receipt should enclose along with Application form.				
7	**Date and Place of examination**	Date and Time of examination will be notified on the official institute website.			
8	The selected In-service candidates shall execute a bond in Form No.19 appended to KCSR and other private candidates shall deposit their original marks cards, Degree certificates, (UG & PG), Experience Certificate etc. In case the candidate fails to complete or withdraw from the fellowship programme during the course duration he/she shall pay a fine of Rs.10,000-00 and the entire stipend amount, if any, drawn in respect of any fellowship programme will have to be repaid.				
9	Course Fees Rs. 1,00,000/- (Non refundable)				

DIPR/SI/3060/2026-27 **sd/- DIRECTOR**

Philippines accuses Chinese coast guard of harassing patrols

Agence France-Presse
MANILA

The Philippines accused China's military and coast guard on Sunday of harassing Filipino government aircraft and boats in two areas of the disputed South China Sea.

A J-16 fighter interfered with a Filipino Cessna 208 turboprop that was conducting a "routine military patrol" near Scarborough Shoal on Saturday, a Philippine armed forces statement said.

"The J-16 repeatedly approached and manoeuvred in close proximity to the Philippine aircraft, including manoeuvring ahead of and around it and positioning itself within the Philippine aircraft's wake," it said.

While the Filipino aircraft completed its mission safely, the Filipino military called the incident "part of a recurring pattern of unsafe and coercive behaviour against Philippine government vessels and aircraft conducting lawful operations".

There was no immediate reaction from the Chinese government on the air incident. The Philippine government said a second confrontation occurred on Sunday in the Spratly Islands, further south in South China Sea.

Merz announces new aid for Ukraine in Kyiv visit as Russia steps up attacks

Associated Press
KYIV

German Chancellor Friedrich Merz announced a new aid package for Ukraine worth more than $1.5 billion during a visit to Kyiv on Sunday, as Russia escalated its attacks on Ukrainian cities.

The aerial war has intensified, with Moscow menacing cities across Ukraine with hard-to-intercept ballistic missiles and jet-powered drones, while Kyiv has been striking Russia's oil industry and businesses.

About $1.1 billion of the package is military aid, including long-range strike weapons, combat drones and satellite technology, "so that Ukraine can also target Russian launch pads," Mr. Merz said at a news conference. Germany is also providing some $395 million in energy aid ahead of winter for generators, substations and repair work, he said.



Friedrich Merz and Volodymyr Zelenskyy hold a press conference in Mariinsky Palace following talks in Kyiv on Sunday. AFP

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said the two countries also signed 15 agreements worth more than $9.6 billion, mostly covering security cooperation, weapons production and procurement, as well as a deal to expand their joint counter-drone efforts.

"This is weaponry that will help right now," Mr. Zelenskyy wrote on X, adding they also discussed the need for air defence, which he called "key" at this time.

He also accused Moscow of avoiding meaningful peace talks, while saying Ukraine and Germany were working to advance diplomacy with European participation.

Russia's Ministry of Defence said it would intensify its strikes against military-industrial facilities in Ukraine, in response to Mr. Zelenskyy's comments that Ukraine would escalate its attacks on Russian oil refineries.

WELL EARNED

We didn't get the Asian Games gold on a platter, says Samson



REUTERS

We did not get the gold on a platter. We had to really work hard for it. That makes it all the more satisfying, and we are all happy. Bringing the best team really helped, and that's what happened against Pakistan in the final — India wicketkeeper Sanju Samson on the Asian Games triumph.

POSITIVE OUTLOOK

We had full confidence that we would win gold: Salima



R.V. MOORTHY

Indian women's hockey team captain Salima Tete said the team was confident of clinching gold at the Asian Games. "We deserve this victory. We had full confidence in our team and players that we would win gold although China is a very good team. Defending that one goal and winning gold for our country make us proud".

HAPPY HOMECOMING

India's Asiad medal-winning boxers receive a warm welcome



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

India's Asian Games medal-winning boxers returned to a warm welcome in New Delhi in the wee hours of Sunday. They were greeted by an Indo-Tibetan Border Police band, garlands, sweets and family members. The Indian pugilists won three gold and as many bronze medals to return their best-ever haul.

SOAKING IT IN

Uruguay team lands in Kolkata, tries its hand at cricket



X@URUGUAY

The Uruguay national football team added a touch of cricket ahead of its friendly against India as the players visited the iconic Eden Gardens in Kolkata on Sunday. The two-time World Cup champion will face the Blue Tigers at the Salt Lake Stadium on Tuesday. The match will kick off at 7.30 p.m.

Aichi-Nagoya should act as the springboard for Indian athletes

Teen archer Kumkum, the women's hockey team, markswoman Neeru and grapplers Aman and Sujeet stood out; the biggest areas of concern would be the performance of the shuttlers and shooters, the two most heavily funded sports



Long wait ends: The women's hockey team regained the title after 44 years. R.V. MOORTHY

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

The Asian Games are over. The quadrennial spectacle that determines continental sporting excellence and bragging rights, ended the way most expected it to – China at the top, a million miles ahead of anyone else. Host Japan and South Korea completing the top-three. India, with a massive push in the last stretch, managed 85 medals, including 21 gold, to finish fourth.

This edition threw up several winners but few stood out as much for the magnitude of their achievements as the manner of it, none more than the Indian women recurve archers, led by the intrepid 17-year-old Kumkum Mohod. As much as her gold in team and individual events are historic, the fact that she also booked a direct quota for LA Olympics matters equally. The next two years will see whether the fearlessness of youth is burnished further or gets tempered in the fire of international competition.

The women's hockey team won the gold for the first time since 1982 and it was a maiden triumph with an Olympic spot at stake. Bettering China needed something special – Sjoerd Marijne brought it into the mix to turn a fractured bunch raked with groupism into a happy, united team, and called it 'discipline'. This team has it to go all the way to a medal in LA 2028, provided it stays the course, both in planning and personnel.

The men's team as expected booked its ticket to the Olympics. The recent World Cup, however, exposed the growing gap with Europe.

Track and field was a mixed bag for India – the number of medals were close to what it won last time around (24 to 29) but it's the close misses and lost golds that should be the focus of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI).

There needs to be greater accountability of the various stakeholders, including athletes themselves, and a re-look at the selections.

Wrestling, on the other hand, proved it had a system, as criticised as it is, that works. Aman Sehrawat and Sujeet Kalkal are precious; the Wrestling Federation of India would do well to protect them, along with Antim Panghal, and perhaps bring greater focus on the Greco-Roman category as well. Similarly, the boxers had their best-ever outing with three gold and as many bronze.

The biggest areas of concern would be shooting and badminton, the two most heavily funded sports that had disappointing outings this time around. A single bronze in men's badminton team event should set alarm bells ringing for the lack of back-ups. The shooters had their moments but it took Neeru Dhanda's imperious gold for the contingent to finish marginally better.

If India does hope to substantially increase its tally and improve its position in Olympics, however, it really needs to amp up focus on the medal-intensive water sports, both pool and open.

The Aichi-Nagoya Games can, and should, be the springboard to leap higher and further, two years into the future.

Torch and flag pass to the 2030 host Doha

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

The flag and the torch were passed, the athletes celebrated and Aichi-Nagoya bid adieu to the Asian Games here on Sunday the way it had started – highlighting Japan's culture and history and with hopes of sports unifying the continent going forward.

After more than two weeks of intense competition that saw more than 15,000 athletes from 45 countries creating almost 50 world records, the celebratory atmosphere at the Paloma Mizuho Athletic Stadium relegated all the logistical nightmares to the background.

Olympic Council of Asia President Sheikh Joaan Bin Hamad Al Thani declared the Games officially closed after the 90-minute programme witnessed by Japan's crown prince and princess.

The OCA torch and flag were handed over to Qatar Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed bin Abdulrahman Al-Thani, who passed it to Olympic, World and Asian high jump champion Mutaz Essa Barshim as a mark of formal handover. Qatari rider Jassim Al Kuwari entered on a horse, took the flag from Barshim and rode out. The next edition is set to be held in Doha in 2030.

"Tonight, as we lower the flag on Aichi-Nagoya 2026, we close these Games but we raise the bar for Asian sport. The flame may be extinguished but the hopes it has ignited will continue to burn brightly across our continent," Hamad Al Thani said. The empty space at the centre of the rainbow heart logo from the opening ceremony was replaced with 'One Asia' for the closing, to highlight the sense of unity.

A laser show, with performances from artists of the Nagoya school of music and dance, was followed by the athletes parade. The Indian contingent was led by shooter Neeru Dhanda as the flag-bearer.

A hexagonal stage placed at the centre of the stadium, adorned with lanterns, saw a *bon-odori* performance, a traditional Japanese dance transcending age and genders with local singers joining in for a rendition of Matsuken Samba II that finally brought the curtains down on the event.



Sayonara: The Indian contingent at the closing parade. R.V. MOORTHY

Kumkum Mohod — India's golden girl at 17

Jonathan Selvaraj
NAGOYA



Midas touch: A calm and assured Kumkum hit the bullseye in the shoot-off. REUTERS

Moments after becoming the first Indian woman to win an individual recurve gold medal at the Asian Games, 17-year-old Kumkum Mohod stood with her bow lowered, looking sheepish, as if she didn't know what to do anymore.

In the final, the scores were level. With one arrow to decide the gold, South Korea's Oh Yejin, a former World Youth champion, shot an 8. Kumkum needed a nine. She drew, held for a couple of seconds and released. The arrow landed in the centre.

10. Gold.

Giant-slayer

Her path to the final had been remarkable. She beat reigning World Champion Kang Chaeyoung of Korea in the quarterfinal and China's Gwangju 2025 World Championship silver medallist Zhu Jingyi in the semifinal. Against Kang, with the Korean poised to level the match, Kumkum produced a clutch final arrow, landing just 3.5cm from the centre to seal the win.

"She is a very aggressive archer. Very confident," said Indian recurve coach Sonam Rana.

That confidence is not new. "No one in my family ever told me how much they had spent on me. They always encouraged me," she said.

Kumkum first picked up a bow at nine, at a range near her home in Amravati, Maharashtra. Once she outgrew it, her father, who makes and sells packaging for sweets, dipped into his decade-old savings to fund a recurve.

In Nagoya, she helped India also win the women's team gold by stunning seven-time champion South Korea, before adding a mixed-team silver into the mix.

"She has no fear," said Dhiraj.

"I see the confidence with which she shoots, and I get confidence as well."

That confidence was tested the most in the individual final. After dropping the first set, Kumkum reset herself. "My focus was drifting toward the arrow, so I reminded myself to focus on my shooting form instead of the result," she said.

She hit the centre three straight times. Then once more in the shoot-off.

Her gold also secured a quota place for India at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, where she will aim for a gold too.

It worked out according to my game plan, says Pranavi

C.K. Muralidharan
MYSURU

Pranavi Urs made history by becoming the first Indian woman golfer to win the individual gold at the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya on Saturday.

Pranavai, who hails from Mysuru, returned with a par 70 score in the fourth round and clinched the gold with a four-day aggregate score of 15-under 265.

Pranavi, Aditi Ashok and Diksha Dagar also secured the silver medal in the team event.

China bagged the gold while Taiwan took home bronze.



Pranavi. REUTERS

Speaking to *The Hindu* from Nagoya, Pranavi said: "It's amazing to win the gold medal and I am happy to be the first one to do it. I didn't get the start I wanted, but I focused on what to do and took it shot by shot and it worked out according to my game plan."

The 23-year-old has been competing on the Ladies European Tour for the last three years. She has logged eight top-10 finishes on the Tour.

Pranavi had the distinction of being the first Indian woman to win a professional mixed-gender tournament at the IGPL in Mumbai last November. The IGPL has announced a cash award of ₹1 crore for Pranavi.

Brazil defeat offers a lesson in handling world-class teams: Jamil

FOOTBALL

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

The match against five-time World Cup winner Brazil appeared to have left the Indian camp with a sense of perspective, as head coach Khalid Jamil emphasised the importance of regular exposure to top-class opponents.

His comments suggested that games against teams such as Brazil can be valuable irrespective of the result – a 0-4 defeat at the Salt Lake Stadium in this case – because they exposed the Indian players to higher levels of speed, decision-making, concentration and pressure that are difficult to replicate in training.

The loss also highlighted the learning curve. India was competitive for periods, but against a team of Brazil's quality, small lapses were immediately punished. "If you play with a good team, you make one mistake, and they will finish. For that, your concentration should be good, and you have to be alert all through the action," Jamil said on Saturday.

The experience offered India a glimpse of the demands of international football at the highest level. Jamil also acknowledged the psychological challenge of facing Brazil.

"Before the match, there was pressure on the players. Definitely, 100%, because you are going to play against Brazil."

For Jamil, consistent game-time against such opposition can help players build self-belief. "They must have that belief. We need to play more matches like this," he added, pointing towards a broader developmental philosophy.

Known for his nonchalant repartee, Jamil offered a wry response when asked to rate India's performance on a scale of 10: "We have got zero points."

The remark underlined the immediate reality of the result, even as he found positives in India's performance. Jamil praised Lalengmawia Apuia and Anirudh Thapa in midfield while also highlighting the performances of attackers Ryan Williams, Sahal Abdul Samad, and Manvir Singh. "Overall, it was very good," he said, before acknowledging the area for improvement: "So defensively, we should be a little stronger."

Brazil coach Carlo Ancelotti also recognised India's organisation and noted that his side had difficulty in breaking the Indian resolve initially. "India played their part well. They tried to play their game; they defended... were organised, and tried to play counter-attack. I think that they played a good game. We had difficulty opening the score, but the moment we opened the score with Estevao, we had more opportunity to control the game," the renowned Italian manager emphasised.



Tough challenge: India forward Manvir fighting for possession with Brazil defender Gabriel. K.R. DEEPAK

Batters continue to sparkle, bowling remains a concern

Apart from Kuldeep in the first ODI, none of the bowlers looked threatening; India skipper Gill will expect more from his pace arsenal, sans Bumrah, which failed to take up responsibility and leaked runs in all the three matches

WI IN INDIA

S. Dipak Ragav
NEW CHANDIGARH



Job done: India's quality was enough to pull off a 2-1 victory. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

With just about a year to go for the 2027 ODI World Cup, India's preparation for the quadrennial event got off on the right note as it posted a 2-1 series win over the West Indies.

There were, however, some warning signs that the team will want to address soon.

The big positive was the batting. The top-order set up the series victory, led by skipper Shubman Gill, who scored two centuries, including a double hundred.

More importantly, Rohit Sharma (225 runs) and Virat Kohli (168) were on song. Since this is the only format they play, it is imperative the senior players maximise every opportunity.

K.L. Rahul got only one chance and proved why he is so vital to the team, scoring an unbeaten 129, even if it went in vain.

However, bowling remains a concern. Granted, the pitches at all three venues had very little for the bowlers. Still, the attack is hardly settled.



Difficult times: Siraj could not shine in the lone opportunity he got. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Apart from Kuldeep Yadav in the first match, none of the others looked like they could keep the batters honest or provide timely breakthroughs.

The other fast bowlers not being able to take up responsibility showed how the Men in Blue are over-reliant on Jasprit Bumrah, who was away on Asian Games duty.

The management handed out debuts to Auqib Nabi and Anshul Kamboj, both of whom proved expensive while Mohammed Siraj's recent struggle continued in the only match he played.

Captain Gill admitted as much, saying he would have wanted to see more out of his speedsters.

"Bowling in the Power-Play and in the death has been hurting us. If you don't get off to a good start in the PowerPlay, it's not easy to take wickets in the middle overs as we have seen," said Gill.

"It's not easy to create chances with only four fielders outside. The intensity of the game, and how it goes, becomes completely different if you don't keep taking wickets in either the PowerPlay or the middle overs," he added.

Going forward, the think-tank needs to quickly identify the right combination for the World Cup and give them enough games to get into a groove, something Gill stressed he wants to do from the next series.

Our fielding has not been up to the mark, admits Gill

S. Dipak Ragav
NEW CHANDIGARH



Vital aspect: Gill says it is paramount to back up the bowlers with good catching and effective ground fielding. AFP

Even as India celebrated yet another home ODI series triumph, skipper Shubman Gill did not hold back on the things the team needs to improve.

Foremost among them was the fielding standard, which the captain felt was poor in the three outings against the West Indies.

"I think we dropped around three or four catches today (Saturday). Dropping catches breaks the momentum," said Gill following his side's five-wicket loss to West Indies in the third and final ODI here.

"Our fielding in the series, I would say, has not been up to the mark. I think we dropped around seven catches in the whole series, if I'm not wrong."

Affects the bowlers

Gill also highlighted that ground fielding needs to get better and spoke about how it affects the bowlers.

"Even in the field today, we gave away many runs. We were quite sloppy. I think leading up to the World Cup, these are the areas where we definitely need to get better. We need to be at our best, especially on the field. If the wicket isn't helping the bowlers and our fielding is substandard, it becomes difficult for them," he pointed out.

On experimenting with players for the all-rounder's slots, Gill said, "Anshul (Kamboj) and Auqib (Nabi) are the kind of players who are going to be in the mix a lot. We want someone who can bowl and can bat a bit at No. 8. That number is very crucial for us.

"But I honestly don't think there is that much time to experiment. Hopefully we get all the players that are available from the next series, and we want to start playing with the combination that we want for the World Cup".

India-West Indies ODI series in numbers

Batting	Inns	Runs	HS	Avg	SR	100s/50s
Gill	3	334	223*	167.00	135.22	2/0
Hope	3	278	162*	139.00	112.09	2/0
Jangoo	3	239	114	119.50	135.79	1/2
Rohit	3	225	101	75.00	115.38	1/1
Bowling	**Inns**	**Wkts**	**BB**	**Avg**	**Econ**	**4W**
Kuldeep	3	7	4/40	23.85	5.56	1
Seales	3	4	3/62	43.00	6.88	0
Prasidh	2	3	2/60	35.00	7.00	0
Gurnoor	3	3	2/96	73.33	7.54	0

> The skipper stepping up is not anything new to him, but to keep for 50 overs and then go and play an innings like that was special
>
> **SAMMY**
> WI coach on Hope

Mukesh and Akash blow away J&K as RoI triumphs



No clue: Jammu & Kashmir captain Dogra falls to Mukesh for a golden duck. IMRAN NISSAR

IRANI CUP

Vivek Krishnan
SRINAGAR

Mukesh Kumar and Akash Deep have multiple threads tying them together. Both pacers hail from mofussil towns in Bihar. Both relocated to West Bengal to pursue cricket. Both have donned the whites for India.

Their bonhomie with the ball in hand has given Bengal many victories in the Ranji Trophy. At the picturesque Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium on Sunday, the two quicks again combined to devastating effect to help Rest of India clinch a 167-run victory over Jammu & Kashmir on day four and win the Irani Cup. While the 32-year-old Mukesh took six for 33, Akash, 29, finished with figures of three for 25. J&K's run chase of 279 was derailed altogether as the 2025-26 Ranji champion folded up for 111.

RoI, which resumed on 306 for eight, was bowled out for 319. Centurion R. Smaran added nine runs to his overnight tally of 126 before he was castled by Sunil Kumar.

In pursuit, J&K raced to 54 for none in 10 overs. Qamran Iqbal enjoyed the upper hand in a duel against left-arm pacer Mukesh Choudhary. Apart from a short-arm pull over fine-leg for six, the opener, buoyed by a few chirps, carted Choudhary for three successive fours in the eighth over and punched the air.



Mukesh. IMRAN NISSAR

Breakthrough

Just as the momentum appeared to tilt towards the host, Akash trapped Qamran in front at the start of the 11th over.

Sarfaraz Khan, standing in as skipper with birthday boy Rishabh Pant indisposed, entrusted the pair of Akash and Mukesh to take charge and swiftly reaped the rewards.

In the 14th over, Mukesh brought the ball back into left-hander Shubham Pundir's pads for another leg-before decision, and cleaned up Paras Dogra for a first-ball duck with a ripper that tailed away late.

The contest was sealed an hour after lunch, with the two friends savouring the win side by side.

The scores:
Rest of India —1st innings: 237.
Jammu & Kashmir — 1st innings: 278.
RoI — 2nd innings: Shikhar Mohan c Wadhawan b Sunil 2, Sanat Sangwan c Wadhawan b Umar 55, Sudip Gharami b Nasir 33, Saransh Jain b Umar 25, Sarfaraz Khan c Pundir b Umar 0, R. Smaran b Sunil 135, Manav Suthar lbw b Lotra 16, Rishabh Pant lbw b Lotra 8, Akash Deep c Khajuria b Lotra 1, Mukesh Choudhary b Sunil 11, Mukesh Kumar (not out) 2; Extras (b-2, lb-5, w-3, nb-21): 31; Total (in 99.5 overs): 319.
Fall of wickets: 1-8, 2-58, 3-128, 4-130, 5-131, 6-183, 7-195, 8-197, 9-310.
J&K bowling: Umar 25-2-92-3, Sunil 28.5-5-56-3, Nasir 11-0-55-1, Abid 8-0-32-0, Lotra 26-5-71-3, Pundir 1-0-6-0.
J&K — 2nd innings: Qamran Iqbal lbw b Akash 32, Shubham Khajuria c sub (Juyal) b Akash 36, Shubham Pundir lbw b Mukesh 9, Paras Dogra b Mukesh 0, Abdul Samad c Shikhar b Choudhary 20, Kanhaiya Wadhawan c sub (Juyal) b Mukesh 2, Sahil Lotra c sub (Juyal) b Akash 0, Lone Nasir (not out) 1, Abid Mushtaq b Mukesh 5, Umar Nazir c Sarfaraz b Mukesh 0, Sunil Kumar c Shikhar b Mukesh 0; Extras (b-5, nb-1): 6; Total (in 28.4 overs): 111.
Fall of wickets: 1-54, 2-65, 3-65, 4-89, 5-98, 6-103, 7-106, 8-111, 9-111.
RoI bowling: Mukesh 10.4-1-33-6, Choudhary 8-1-48-1, Akash 9-1-25-3, Manav 1-1-0-0.
PoM: Smaran.

Tamil Nadu bags u-23 crown with an outright victory

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu u-23 team began its season on the best possible note, comprehensively beating Rest of India u-23 by six wickets on the final day at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium here.

Fixed a target of 149 in 46 overs for an outright victory, the home team did more than enough in the last two sessions on Sunday. Having conceded the first-innings lead, RoI had no option but to make TN bat again to stand any chance of bagging the trophy.

The away side did so after declaring its second essay at 431 for seven, built on a splendid double century from opener Angkrish Raghuvanshi (203, 281b, 16x4, 4x6) and a ton off the bat of No. 4 Digvijay Patil (106, 138b, 8x4). While both batters enjoyed slices of luck during their 249-run third-wicket stand, Raghuvanshi was rewarded for his immaculate strokeplay on a surface where the ball turned throughout and kept low at times.

Left-arm spinner P. Vignesh (five for 144) was the chief contributor for TN, with his victims including Raghuvanshi. A few minutes after reaching his double hundred with a single over sweeper cover, the right-hander holed out to the deep midwicket fielder. RoI lost five wickets for just 32 runs before declaring its second innings.

The scores: Rest of India u-23 179 & 431/7 decl. in 90 overs (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 203, Ayush Jethwa 58, Digvijay Patil 106, P. Vignesh 5/144) lost to Tamil Nadu u-23 462 & 150/4 in 34.5 overs (K.T.A. Madhava Prasad 42). **PoM:** Madhava Prasad.



Dominant show: Tamil Nadu was in control of the match from start to finish. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Andre backs team to extend its dominance

S. Shrivathsan
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu u-23 team just cannot stop clinching titles. Having achieved a double in the previous season, it added a trophy to its cabinet after defeating Rest of India u-23 in a match that mirrored the Irani Cup.

C. Andre Siddarth, who led the State to its latest triumph on Sunday, believes the current crop is capable of extending its dominance. "They have experience... the way they won the tournaments last year speaks for itself. They are good enough to win the tournaments again," said Andre, proudly sporting a victor's medal around his neck.

The u-23 unit will begin its Col. C.K. Nayudu Trophy defence in a home game against Saurashtra in Dindigul later this month. With Andre becoming a mainstay in the senior red-ball set-up, the age-group side will be led by all-rounder S. Mohamed Ali. "These guys are too good to be honest. I have been playing with them since my u-12 days. They know what they need to do... these aren't guys who need to be told what is expected of them," Andre added.

For RoI opener Angkrish Raghuvanshi, it was about getting back in the groove.

The Mumbai lad had been out of action for three months with a finger injury, but he is now finding his feet again. The double century against TN u-23 was a massive confidence booster. "I am playing [competitive cricket] after a long time and my knock gave me clarity. The middle of the pitch is my happy place," said Raghuvanshi.

"I tried to bat as long as I could. It was a satisfying experience because every batter dreams of hitting big hundreds. It was a good day for me, but it would have been better had we won the match," he added.

Verstappen claims first win of the year

FORMULA ONE

Agence France-Presse
SEPANG (MALAYSIA)

Max Verstappen secured his and Red Bull's first win this year with an imperious drive in chaotic conditions in a storm-delayed Bahrain GP in Malaysia on Sunday.

Nine years after winning the last F1 race at the Sepang Circuit, the Dutchman came through a wild afternoon of accidents and incidents for his 72nd victory and first since Abu Dhabi last year. In a race of shifting tyre strategies, Verstappen came home 2.307s ahead of championship leader Kimi Antonelli of Mercedes and Ferrari's Lewis Hamilton.

The results (provisional, 55 laps): 1. Verstappen (Red Bull) 1h:47m:14.808s; 2. Antonelli (Mercedes) + 2.307s; 3. Hamilton (Ferrari) 4.919; 4. Leclerc (Ferrari) 7.258; 5. Hadjar (Red Bull) 8.571; 6. Piastri (McLaren) 9.454; 7. Lawson (Racing Bulls) 12.753; 8. Alonso (Aston Martin) 13.372; 9. Norris (McLaren) 13.993; 10. Lindblad (Racing Bulls) 15.928; 11. Hulkenberg (Audi) 17.404; 12. Stroll (Aston Martin) 18.052; 13. Colapinto (Alpine) 18.997; 14. Bearman (Haas) 22.305; 15. Ocon (Haas) 22.532; 16. Gasly (Alpine) 23.315; 17. Sainz (Williams) 25.431; 18. Bortoleto (Audi) 28.233; 19. Perez (Cadillac) 29.310; **DNF:** Russell (Mercedes); Albon (Williams); Bottas (Cadillac).
The standings: Drivers: 1. Antonelli 320; 2. Russell 236; 3. Hamilton 214; 4. Leclerc 191; 5. Norris 188. **Constructors:** 1. Mercedes 556; 2. Ferrari 405; 3. McLaren 316; 4. Red Bull 298; 5. Racing Bulls 90.

Lights to flag

The journey in numbers after the 55-lap race at Sepang

1 Red Bull-Ford recorded its first win as a power unit manufacturer

1 The first time a country has hosted another country's F1 race since Italy hosted the 2006 San Marino GP

1 The Sepang International Circuit made its first appearance on the F1 calendar since 2017

3 Verstappen became only the third driver (after Schumacher and Hamilton) to win a race in as many as 11 consecutive seasons

5 Red Bull is the fifth team to win a race in 11 successive seasons, after Lotus, McLaren, Ferrari and Mercedes

8 Verstappen's podium finishes this season, only behind Antonelli (13)

38 Verstappen registered his 38th fastest lap, level with Vettel for fifth on the list of most fastest laps

72 Verstappen went level with Schumacher (Ferrari) for the second-most victories with a single constructor. Only Hamilton (84 with Mercedes) is ahead



100 Verstappen is the only driver with a 100% points-scoring rate at this track

829 Alonso goes past Button (812) for the most laps raced at Sepang



COMPILED BY ANIRUDH VELAMURI

Rajiv, Rohit drive to glory in JK Tyre Rally of Himalayas

Dhritimaan reigns supreme on two wheels; nothing to separate the pairs of Soham & Nirav and Santosh & Prakash in the Time, Speed, Distance category; the event also features a 72-km stage that was subsequently run in the reverse direction

MOTORSPORTS

Sankar Narayanan E.H.

An unforgiving terrain. An unforgettable race.

The breathtaking mountain frontier played host to a brutal Cross Country Rally: the JK Tyre Rally of Himalayas 2026.

The sixth edition of one of India's most challenging rally raids pushed 50 cars and 80 riders racing across rugged routes, starting from Manali, through Lahaul-Spiti, before culminating in Zanskar.

And at the end of four days of action, Dhritimaan Singh reigned supreme on two wheels while Rajiv Yadav and Rohit Gowda pushed their limits to win the Extreme category.

There was nothing to separate the pairs of Soham Hazra & Nirav Mehta and Santosh H.M. & Prakash Muthusamy as they mastered the clock and machine in the Time, Speed, Distance category.

The competition also had a unique 72-km stage that was subsequently run in the reverse direction.

One of the turning points of the rally came when Lakhpa Tsering – the 2015 Raid de Himalaya victor – was forced to withdraw following a technical issue on the second day of racing.

Rajiv and Rohit setting the pace early proved crucial as they faced stiff competition later, mainly from Daksh Gill and Virender Kashyap, who reached speeds of up to 200 km/h during the treacherous Zanskar stretch.

"It's very tricky [on a bike] because you have to navigate on your own. It's also a very demanding sport... we have to take good care of the body as well as the machine," Dhritimaan had said midway through his fifth Rally of Himalayas.

Leaving no room for half-measures in the second half, the Dehradun rider conquered the Himalayas in full.

The results: Extreme (driver & co-driver): 1. Rajiv Yadav & Rohit Gowda; 2. Aaryak Rana & Aditya Sharma; 3. Daksh Gill & Virender Kashyap.

Time Speed Distance/Adventure: 1. Soham Hazra & Nirav Mehta and Santosh H.M. & Prakash Muthusamy; 2. Chandra Mouli & N. Sri Sakthi Kumar; 3. Sachin Mandhwani & Adhitya Anthony.

Moto (two-wheeler): 1. Dhritimaan Singh; 2. Happy Verma; 3. Nitish Bharadwaj.

(The writer was in Manali at the invitation of JK Tyre).



Fast and furious: Dhritimaan, taking part in his fifth Rally of Himalayas, clinched the Moto crown. SANKAR NARAYANAN E.H.



Pushing their limits: Rajiv & Rohit won the Extreme category. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



All smiles: Soham & Nirav and Santosh & Prakash receiving their prizes for claiming the TSD category title. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

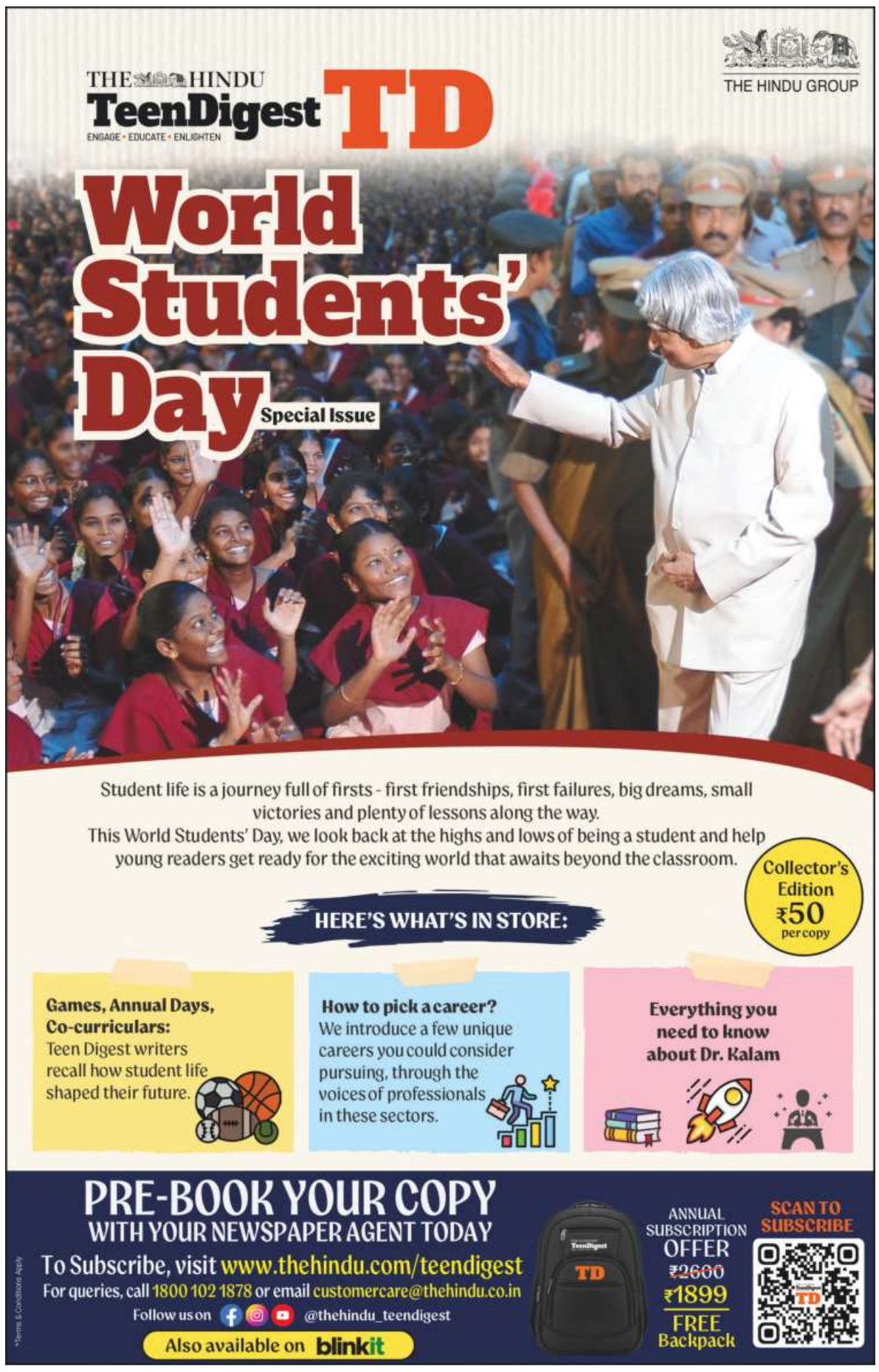
Marquez wins Japanese MotoGP

Agence France-Presse
MOTEGI

Defending World champion Marc Marquez won the Japanese MotoGP on Sunday to slice Jorge Martin's overall championship lead to two points.

Marquez pushed Martin to second place here. Italian Marco Bezzecchi finished third and slipped further behind in the title race.





Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878
Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU | thehindu businessline | FRONTLINE | SPORTSTAR | THE HINDU Young world | THE HINDU

CANTONMENT BOARD
ST. THOMAS MOUNT CUM PALLAVARAM
Ministry of Defence, Government of India
Chennai - 600 016.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for information to the General Public that the Director General, Defence Estates, Government of India, Ministry of Defence, Delhi vide Letter No.12/1/Building Bye-laws/Gen/C/DE/2022 Vol-VII, dated 25.09.2026 and Principal Director Defence Estates, Government of India, Ministry of Defence, Pune, vide Letter No.962/XVII/C/DE/2026, dated 30.09.2026, has issued directions to Cantonments in the Country to publish the Gazette Notification of Draft of the St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram Cantonment Building Bye-laws, 2026 and the copy of MoD ID No.F.No.STM/Works/1/Bye-Laws/2025-2026.

In this connection, any objections or suggestions are invited from the General Public within 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice.

The Draft of the St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram Cantonment Building Bye-laws, 2026 along with a copy of DGDE, Delhi, Letter and PDDE, SC, Pune, Letter cited above are available in the website **www.stm.cantt.gov.in/public-notice/** and Notice Board in Office of the Cantonment Board, St.Thomas Mount, Chennai-600 016.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
Office of the Cantonment Board
St.Thomas Mount cum Pallavaram
Chennai-600 016.

No.STM/Works/1/2107
Dated 02.10.2026

கன்டோன்மெண்ட் கழகம்
செயின்ட் தாமஸ் மவுண்ட் மற்றும் பல்லாவரம் கன்டோன்மெண்ட்
இந்திய அரசு, பாதுகாப்பு அமைச்சகம்
சென்னை – 600 016.

பொது அறிவிப்பு

பொதுமக்களின் தகவலுக்காக தெரிவிக்கப்படுவது என்னவெனில், இந்திய அரசு, பாதுகாப்பு அமைச்சகம், பாதுகாப்பு எஸ்டேட்ஸ் இயக்குநர் ஜெனரல், புதுதில்லி அவர்கள், கடித எண்.12/1/Building Bye-laws/Gen/C/DE/2022 Vol-VII, நாள் 25.09.2026 மற்றும் இந்திய அரசு, பாதுகாப்பு அமைச்சகம், பாதுகாப்பு எஸ்டேட்ஸ் முதன்மை இயக்குநர், புனே அவர்கள், கடித எண்.962/XVII/C/DE/2026, நாள் 30.09.2026 ஆகியவற்றின் மூலம், நாட்டிலுள்ள கன்டோன்மெண்ட்களுக்கு செயின்ட் தாமஸ் மவுண்ட் மற்றும் பல்லாவரம் கன்டோன்மெண்ட் கட்டிட விதிமுறைகள், 2026-க்கான வரைவு அரசிதழ் அறிவிப்பை வெளியிடுமாறு அறிவுறுத்தல்கள் வழங்கியுள்ளனர். மேலும், MoD ID No.F.No.STM/Works/1/Bye-Laws/2025-2026-ன் நகலும் இதனுடன் வெளியிடப்படுகிறது.

இது தொடர்பாக, பொதுமக்களிடமிருந்து ஏதேனும் ஆட்சேபனைகள் அல்லது பரிந்துரைகள் இருப்பின், இப்பொது அறிவிப்பு வெளியிடப்பட்ட தேதியிலிருந்து 30 நாட்களுக்குள் சமர்ப்பிக்குமாறு கேட்டுக்கொள்ளப்படுகிறது.

செயின்ட் தாமஸ் மவுண்ட் மற்றும் பல்லாவரம் கன்டோன்மெண்ட் கட்டிட விதிமுறைகள், 2026-க்கான வரைவு, மேற்கண்ட இந்திய அரசு, பாதுகாப்பு அமைச்சகம், பாதுகாப்பு எஸ்டேட்ஸ் இயக்குநர் ஜெனரல், புதுதில்லி மற்றும் இந்திய அரசு, பாதுகாப்பு அமைச்சகம், பாதுகாப்பு எஸ்டேட்ஸ் முதன்மை இயக்குநர், புனே அவர்களின் கடிதங்களின் நகல்களுடன், **www.stm.cantt.gov.in/public-notice/** என்ற இணையதளத்திலும், செயின்ட் தாமஸ் மவுண்ட், சென்னை-600 016, அமைந்துள்ள கன்டோன்மெண்ட் வாரிய அலுவலகத்தின் அறிவிப்புப் பலகையிலும் பார்வைக்காக வைக்கப்பட்டுள்ளது.

Sd/-
தலைமை நிர்வாக அதிகாரி
கன்டோன்மெண்ட் கழகம் அலுவலகம்
செயின்ட் தாமஸ் மவுண்ட் மற்றும் பல்லாவரம்
சென்னை – 600 016.

No.STM/Works/1/2107
Dated 02.10.2026

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI-38

Tender Notice No. ICF/PCMM/EOT/40/2026 Dated: 01.10.2026

The following e-tenders are published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to **www.ireps.gov.in** and quote against these tenders. Manual quotations will not be entertained for these tenders. Closing and Opening time for all tenders are 14.15 hrs. Hindi version of tender notice is available on website **www.icf.indianrailways.gov.in.**

Sl. No	Tender No.	Tender Title	Quantity	Due Date / Time
1	03260046	RUBBER SPRING CENTERING	3028 Nos	19/10/2026
2	02262065	C/S of Sidewall Assembly (VB Sleeper NDTC CW)	10 Set	20/10/2026
3	03262478	SECONDARY VERTICAL SHOCK ABSORBER	858 Nos	20/10/2026
4	03262245	STEEL PLATES TO SPEC DIN EN:10025-5:2004 S355J2W+N.	Refer IREPS Website	21/10/2026
5	02261934	KIT ITEMS FOR UNDER FRAME FRAMEWORK (VB SLEEPER NDTC)	25 Set	21/10/2026
6	01265397	ARTHROSCOPY SHAVER UNIT	1 No	21/10/2026
7	03261630A	PRIMARY VERTICAL DAMPER	16077 Nos	22/10/2026
8	02260132	FRONT PART DETAILS KIT (LHB)	174 Set	22/10/2026
9	02262160	TROUGH FLOOR PART (VB SLEEPER MC, TC, NDTC, DTC)	394 Nos	23/10/2026
10	02260120	C/S of Side wall Assembly (VB Sleeper NDTC)	5 Set	23/10/2026
11	02260133	C/S of Side wall Frame Work, Welding Parts and Carline (LWACCN PP)	16 Set	23/10/2026
12	03262141	Adjusting Pull Rod for EMU/MEMU OB Coaches	5897 Nos	29/10/2026

CORRIGENDUM NO.40
Corrigendum has been issued to the following tender. Please check IREPS website for further details

Sl.No	Tender No	Existing Value	Modified Value
01	03262009	28/09/2026	05/10/2026
02	03262038	01/10/2026	15/10/2026
		Quantity 7335 Kgs	7540 Kgs
		Item Description Modified, Additions and Deletions of Drawing and Spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
03	02261666	28/09/2026	12/10/2026
04	02261917	28/09/2026	05/10/2026
		Item Description Modified, Additions and Deletions of Special Condition and Drawing and Spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
05	02261900	25/09/2026	05/10/2026
		Item Description Modified, Additions and Deletions of Special Condition and Drawing and Spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
06	02261358A	29/09/2026	06/10/2026
		Item Description Modified, Additions and Deletions of Drawing and Spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
07	02260108	29/09/2026	06/10/2026
		Item Description Modified, Additions and Deletions of Drawing and Spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	
08	02261762	29/09/2026	13/10/2026
09	02261796	01/10/2026	15/10/2026
10	02261808	06/10/2026	21/10/2026
		Additions and Deletions of Drawing and Spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website	
11	02261933	07/10/2026	14/10/2026
		Item Description Modified, Additions and Deletions of Drawing and Spec. Please refer Tender Document for details in IREPS website.	

READ
SPORTSTAR
EVERY FORTNIGHT.
TO SUBSCRIBE, VISIT
www.thehindugroup.in/subscribe

Spain breaks down a stubborn Czechia

The World Cup champion tops Group 3 in League A; Kane and Saka score a brace each as England outclasses Croatia to lie second

NATIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

World Cup winner Spain was made to work for a 3-1 win against Czechia in the Nations League on Saturday while England sparkled in thrashing Croatia 7-0.

Spain recorded its 41st consecutive unbeaten game, thanks to an exquisite finish from Lamine Yamal before goals from Rodri and Mikel Merino in Oviedo.

Just as he did at the World Cup, Merino came off the bench midway through the second half and produced a crucial goal at a point in the game when the Czechs seemed to be getting a foothold after Jiri Slama had pulled a goal back.

Spain claimed a third win from three group games.

Harry Kane and Bukayo Saka both scored twice as England overwhelmed Croatia in Rijeka, with Kane taking his record tally for his country to 89 goals.



Slotting it in: England captain Kane opens the floodgates against Croatia. REUTERS

Thomas Tuchel's side sliced through Slaven Bilic's side to make it two wins from its first three matches.

Real Madrid midfielder Jude Bellingham, restored to the starting line-up after Tuesday's 2-0 win against Czechia, also found the net to cap a commanding display featuring three assists.

Spain sits top of Group 3 of League A with three wins out of three, while World Cup semifinalist England is second on six.

Scotland finally got a win under new Belgian coach Sebastien Pocognoli as it beat North Macedonia 2-0 away.

A first-half goal from Kieron Bowie was followed by a John McGinn strike on a night when Andy Robertson won his 100th international cap.

The results: League A: Group 3: Croatia 0 lost to England 7 (Kane 8, 53, Bellingham 21, Gordon 39, Saka 45, 68, Rogers 87); Spain 3 (Yamal 6, Rodri 35, Merino 89) bt Czechia 1 (Slama 69).

League B: North Macedonia 0 lost to Scotland 2 (Bowie 7, McGinn 70); Switzerland 2 (Janza 10-og, Ndoye 38) bt Slovenia 1 (Vipotnik 2).

AROUND THE CITY

TN girls retain title, Rajasthan boys dethrone U.P.

Tamil Nadu girls retained their title while a dominant Rajasthan broke through to be crowned the new boys' champion at the 51st sub-junior National basketball championships in Vijayawada.

The final between TN and Maharashtra was a nail-biting, see-saw affair through the first two quarters. Then, a clinical tactical execution and superior conditioning allowed TN to seal a 65-55 win.

On the other hand, the boys' final was one-sided, with Rajasthan dethroning Uttar Pradesh with a convincing 77-56 triumph.

The results (final): Boys: Rajasthan 77 (Robin Dhanka 19, Daksh Choudhary 18) bt Uttar Pradesh 56 (Sahil Kumar 22, Vansh Tomar 10).

Girls: Tamil Nadu 65 (M. Dhanya 19, V. Anishika 13) bt Maharashtra 55 (Maitri Sha 13).

SKA SRMA Queens comes up trumps

SKA SRMC Queens defeated Believe CC by seven wickets in the final of the SMCA Diamond Lady Champions Trophy held recently in Chennai.

The scores: Believe 110/8 in 30 overs lost to SKA SRMC Queens 113/3 in 23 overs (Mridula 34, Deekshana 35 n.o.).

Player-of-the-Series: Cipora Clisters (Queens); **Player-of-the-Final:** Poorvi Rajesh (Queens); **Best performer:** T. Aaradhana (Believe); **Best batter:** M. Suhanni (Queens); **Best bowler:** S. Lithisha (PSCA); **Emerging player:** Hanushka (Believe).

Inter-school u-12 cricket from Friday

Friends CA will conduct an inter-school/academy under-12 boys' cricket tournament starting on October 9 at the N.M. Greens Ground.

The last date for entries is Wednesday. For details, contact Abdul at 99624 04093.



Champion: The triumphant Tamil Nadu sub-junior basketball team.

TNCA LEAGUE

Akshaanth's six-for sets up Madras Indians' win

CHENNAI: Akshaanth S. Karthikeyan's six for 43 enabled Madras Indians script a four-wicket victory over Universal in a TNCA league fifth division D zone match held recently.



Akshaanth (Madras Indians, 6/43), Yogender (ICI S & RC, 5/11, Shikeeshwar (Falcon, 5/14), Praveen (Gandhi, 5/19), Prabakaran (Gandhi, 5/30), Shajahan (Royapettah, 5/37) and Sai Shriraam (Venkateswara 5/68).

The scores: III-A:

SNJ 167/7 in 34 overs (N. Nishanth 40, S. Kamesh 34, V. Shashank 33 n.o.) lost to Ranji 168/8 in 33.2 overs (P. Naveen 30, M. Thennarasan 31). **Note:** Match reduced to 34 overs per side due to overnight rain.

Sir MCTM Old Boys SA 231/9 in 50 overs (S. Sanjay 30, V. Dinesh Kumar 62, J. Karthikeyan 57, A.M. Aravindhan 34, E. Tamizharasan 3/34) bt Aruna 229/8 in 50 overs (Sanjay Venkateshwar 54, M. Harikrishnan 77, R. Krishna Moorthy 39, G.M. Ezhil Vannan 3/46).

IOB 214/8 in 50 overs (Abhishek M. Hegde 66, K. Bharat Reddy 32, M. Shajahan 5/37) lost to Royapettah CC 217/6 in 48.2 overs (S. Avaikkarasan 53, M. Sadiqulameen 64, M. Parthiban 32 n.o., M. Jayaprakash 36).

Spic 158 in 48.4 overs (V. Harsshith 43, V. Rajinikanth 3/31) lost to Indian Bank 162/2 in 15.1 overs (S. Sanjay Shrinivas 98 n.o.).

Chatnath 250/6 in 50 overs (M. Abiseck 92, M. Arvindh 58, M. Thiyagarajan 51, V. Bharath Hariharan 32, R.T. Rhytheeswar 3/35) bt Mambalam Mosquitos 247/7 in 50 overs (T.A. Sanjay 76, S. Venkatesh 44, M. Vasisht 50, G. Selvakumar 3/50).

National RC 214 in 44.5 overs (R. Jaiganesh Kumar 87, C. Gokul 30, E. Gokul 57, T. Shikeeshwar 5/14) lost to Falcon 215/4 in 45 overs (T. Shikeeshwar 41, C. Saffin 75 n.o., V. Krishna 51 n.o.).

V-D: Venkateswara 268 in 49.2 overs (P. Gokulkrishnamoorthy 80, B. Jaffer Salim Sadiq 4/59) bt National CC 172 in 44.4 overs (K. Hemprasaath 87, S. Jawahar Santhosh 31, G. Sai Shriraam 5/68).

Madras Emmanuel 227/6 in 33 overs (S.J. Mahathevan 82, E.S. Vishal Rao 59, P. Enoch Rehoboth 34 n.o., J. Arun 3/61) bt TVS MSC 204/7 in 33 overs (R. Nishanth 36, D. Fabian Anand 75 n.o.). **Note:** Match reduced to 33 overs per side due to overnight rain.

ICI S & RC 154/9 in 30 overs (A. Hemanth 53, Abhishek Kumar 3/30, M. Hari Prasath 3/41) bt Saidapet Gymkhana 65 in 18.2 overs (M. Manikandan 3/14, R. Yogender Sharma 5/11). **Note:** Match reduced to 30 overs per side due to overnight rain.

Eagle 148 in 41.3 overs (Krishna Sai 52, S. Prabakaran 5/30, M. Praveen 5/19) lost to Gandhi 149/7 in 32.2 overs (Kishore Kumar 30, C. Karthick 37).

Universal 84 in 34.1 overs (K. Dhilepan 40 n.o., Akshaanth S. Karthikeyan 6/43) lost to Madras Indians 90/6 in 16.3 overs (G.K. Nidhish 3/39).

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA round-robin u-14 tournament, City-I vs Districts-III (Wahe Guru-A); City-II vs Districts-IV (Wahe Guru-B); Districts-I vs City-III (Pbel); Districts-II vs City-IV (Jones Krish), 9.30 a.m.

Knight Crusader should come good

HYDERABAD: The five-year-old gelding Knight Crusader, who ran second in his last start, should make amends in the Royal Calcutta Turf Club Trophy, the main event of Monday's (Oct. 5) races.

1 LAND OF GLORY PLATE (1,100m), 4-y-o and upward (Cat. III), 1.55 p.m.: 1. Calabasas (10) Swarup S 62, 2. Top In Class (4) Sohan K 61, 3. Starlight Dancer (8) Trevor 59.5, 4. The Pious (1) Kuldeep Sr. 59.5, 5. Great Giver (9) Sonu K 57, 6. Nyanza (6) Surya Prakash 56.5, 7. Winning Attitude (3) Md. Ekram 56.5, 8. Aloy (2) Arjun 53, 9. Taaliyah (5) Uday Kiran 53 and 10. Rate Of Interest (7) 50.

1. CALABASAS, 2. STARLIGHT DANCER, 3. THE PIOUS

2 BELOVED PRINCE PLATE (1,400m), Maiden, 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 2.30: 1. Champion Reef (5) Trevor 60, 2. Rajendra (7) Ashad Asbar 60, 3. Celestial Power (1) Uday Kiran 59.5, 4. Gacchamanasvin (6) Md. Ismail 59.5, 5. Khamagani (3) Gaurav 58.5, 6. Svalpaviryasaktih (8) Ajay K 58.5, 7. Sara (2) Mohit S 58, 8. Twilight King (9) D.S. Deora 58 and 9. Veera's Princess (4) Santosh Raj 58.

1. CHAMPION REEF, 2. GACCHAMANASVIN, 3. SARA

3 MYSORE RACE CLUB TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 3.05: 1. Shah Of Iran (6) Uday Kiran 60, 2. Trust Me (11) G. Naresh 59, 3. My Way My Rules (2) Akshay K 58, 4. Suryavanshi (7) Surya Prakash 58, 5. Power Of The Sea (10) Trevor 57.5, 6. Beverley (1) Arjun 54.5, 7. Dhanadeepa (12) B. Nikhil 52.5, 8. Lego (4) Kuldeep Sr. 52, 9. Cherish The Lady (8) Ajay K 51.5, 10. Lina O Lina (3) Afroz K 51, 11. Sha 'Carri (9) Neeraj 51 and 12. Star Lit (5) M.S. Deora 50.

1. MY WAY MY RULES, 2. POWER OF THE SEA, 3. BEVERLEY

4 CHARMINAR TROPHY (1,600m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 3.40: 1. Ashwa Jaffna (6) Gaurav 60, 2. Love In Paris (3) Akshay K 58.5, 3. Valledonna (5) Trevor 55.5, 4. Crimson Rose (4) Surya Prakash 53, 5. Kinship (2) D.S. Deora 52.5 and 6. Nkalanzinzi (1) Kuldeep Sr. 52.

1. LOVE IN PARIS, 2. VALLEDONNA, 3. ASHWA JAFFNA

5 ROYAL CALCUTTA TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 60 to 85 (Cat. II), 4.15: 1. Ragnarök (6) Surendra S 60, 2. Knight Crusader (10) B.R. Kumar 58.5, 3. Certainty (1) Arjun S 57, 4. Decoy (4) Akshay K 56.5, 5. Exclusive Black (3) Trevor 56.5, 6. Gloria (2) V.S. Shekhawat 55, 7. Dyanoosh (5) Kuldeep Jr. 54.5, 8. Shadow Of The Moon (7) Md. Ekram 53.5, 9. Glorious Power (8) Bhawani S 52 and 10. Catch The Worm (9) Neeraj 51.5.

1. KNIGHT CURSADER, 2. DECOY, 3. EXCLUSIVE BLACK

6 STAR OF GWALIOR PLATE (1,200m), 4-y-o and upward, rated upto 25 (Cat. III), 4.50: 1. December Rain (4) Mohit S 61.5, 2. Exclusive Luck (12) B. Nikhil 61.5, 3. Most Beautiful (3) Sonu K 61.5, 4. Vedanta (5) Kuldeep Jr. 60.5, 5. Fortune Art (1) Ashad Asbar 59.5, 6. Bien Pensant (13) Santosh Raj 58.5, 7. Amboseli (2) Surya Prakash 57.5, 8. Char Ek Char (9) Uday Kiran 57.5, 9. Mirzeta (6) Md. Ekram 57.5, 10. Deccan Ranger (11) Md. Ismail 55.5, 11. Iconic Star (8) Rafique Sk. 52.5, 12. Hopewell Island (10) G. Naresh 51 and 13. Niloufer The Great (7) Arjun 50.

1. DECEMBER RAIN, 2. FORTUNE ART, 3. ICONIC STAR

Day's Best: **CHAMPION REEF**

Jackpot: 2, 3, 4, 5 & 6.

Mini Jackpot: 3, 4, 5 & 6.

Treble: (i) 1, 2 & 3, (ii) 4, 5 & 6.

Tanala: All races.

Unfancied Buddy speeds to victory in the Deccan Derby

HYDERABAD: The 30-to-1 rank outsider Buddy, ridden by Mukesh Kumar, pulled off a major upset by winning the Race2win Foundation Hyderabad Deccan Derby (Gr. 1), the blue ribband of the Hyderabad Monsoon Races staged here on Sunday (Oct. 4). The winner is owned by M/s. Subodh Kumar Ananthula & Prabhakar Chowdary Tripuraneni and trained by Magan Singh Parmar.

Mukesh took this ward of Dali-Dangal to the front soon after the start and dictated the pace throughout. Entering the home straight, Buddy continued to travel well and comfortably held off the late challenge from Moonveil and Mahogany to score a convincing victory. This win was memorable for trainer Magan Singh Parmar as it was his maiden success in the Deccan Derby.



Powering to glory: Mukesh Kumar piloting Buddy past the post ahead of Moonveil (Trevor up) and Mahogany (Vivek astride). G. RAMAKRISHNA

1. DELHI RACE CLUB TROPHY (1,400M): BEAST MASTER (P. Sai Kumar) 1, Golden Aura (Sonu K) 2, Moonlite Rose (Surya Prakash) 3 and The Divinely (Rafique Sk.) 4. 5-1/2, 2 and 3. 1m, 27.77s. ₹24 (w), 14, 11 and 14 (p). SHP: 45, THP: 40, FP: 133, Q: 63, Tanala: 777. Favourite: Beast Master. Owners: Mr. Mukund Kakani & Mr. S. Prasad Raju. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju.

2. BANGALORE TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,600M): RANI RUCKUS (G. Naresh) 1, Sunny Day (Ashad Asbar) 2, Secret Option (Kuldeep Sr.) 3 and Only My Way (Sonu K) 4. 2-1/2, 4-3/4 and 2. 1m, 41.12s. ₹20 (w), 11, 10 and 16 (p). SHP: 16, THP: 35, FP: 68, Q: 21, Tanala: 196. Favourite: Rani Ruckus. Owner: Mr. Rakesh Reddy Kondakalla. Trainer: Robin R. Kondakalla.

3. TURF AUTHORITIES OF INDIA TROPHY (1,600M): PERCEPTION (Akshay Kumar) 1, Uchchaihshravas (Neeraj) 2, Star Of Night (Trevor) 3 and High Command (Afroz K) 4. 1-1/2, Neck and 1-1/2. 1m, 41.41s. ₹13 (w), 12 and 19 (p). SHP: 31, THP: 32, FP; 37, Q: 34, Tanala: 60. Favourite: Perception. Owner: Mr. Rakesh Reddy Kondakalla. Trainer: Robin R. Kondakalla.

4. MADRAS RACE CLUB TROPHY (1,800M): ONE NATION (P. Trevor) 1, Pristine Glory (Akshay K) 2, Pledge (Antony Raj) 3 and Bholi Punjaban (Surya Prakash) 4. Neck, Neck and 9-1/4. 1m, 53.64s. ₹40 (w), 12, 11 and 12 (p). SHP: 43, THP: 44, FP: 111, Q: 55, Tanala: 176. Favourite: Pledge. Owner: Col. Kuldeep Singh Garcha. Trainer: R.H. Sequeira.

5. ROYAL CALCUTTA TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,200M): AYUSHMAN (Afroz Khan) 1, Star Of Opera (Akshay K) 2, High Speed Dive (Ashad Asbar) 3 and State Man (Parmar) 4. Head, 1 and 3-1/2. 1m, 12. 10s. ₹63 (w), 18, 11 and 11 (p). SHP: 35, THP: 41, FP: 154, Q: 68, Tanala: 976. Favourite: Star Of Opera. Owners: M/s. Dhruv Rajesh Sanghani, Mriza Ayub Baig & Avanindra Kumar Dandamudi. Trainer: D. Netto.

6. ROYAL WESTERN INDIA TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,100M): EK (Akshay Kumar) 1, Catchme If You Can (B. Nikhil) 2, Dubai Touch (Sonu K) 3 and Diligence (D.S. Deora) 4. 1, Head and Neck. 1m, 7.02s. ₹27 (w), 11, 93 and 24 (p). SHP: 468, THP: 42, FP: 1,317, Q: 1,168, Tanala: 6,322. Favourite: Divine Tiger. wner: Mr. Syed Mohiuddin Mufeed. Trainer: Magan Singh.

7. RACE2WIN FOUNDATION HYDERABAD DECCAN DERBY (GR. 1) (2,000M): BUDDY (DALI-DANGAL) (MUKESH KUMAR) 1, Moonveil (Sanus Par Aquam-Electra) (Trevor) 2, Mahogany (Phoenix Tower-Maisha) (Vivek G) 3 and Quattro (Lord Admiral-Couleur Rouge) (Ashad Asbar) 4. 2, Neck and 1. 2m, 04.96s. ₹371 (w), 122, 18 and 16 (p). SHP: 59, THP: 52, FP: 13,145, Q: 2,689, Tanala: 81,682. Favourite: Madante. Owners: M/s. Subodh Kumar Ananthula & Prabhakar Chowdary Tripuraneni. Trainer: Magan Singh.

8. MYSORE RACE CLUB TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200M): DONTBLOCKMYWAY (Sonu Kumar) 1, Excalibur (Antony Raj) 2, Coming Home (B. Nikhil) 3 and Photograph (G. Naresh) 4. Not run: Adalynn. 3/4, 4-1/4 and 7-3/4. 1m, 14.19s. 3/4, 4-1/4 and 7-3/4. 1m, 14.19s. ₹48 (w), 15,10 and 37 (p). SHP: 30, THP: 138, FP: 87, Q: 28, Tanala: 2,063. Favourite: Excalibur. Owner: Mr. Syed Mohiuddin Mufeed. Trainer: M.F. Ali Khan.

NOTE: *Flare (Afroz K up) planted in the stalls and did not participate.*

Jackpot: 70%: ₹14,44,535 (c/o) & 30%: 1,03,181 (6 tkts.).

Mini Jackpot: (i) 1,526 (222 tkts.), (ii) 1,74,827 (c/o).

Treble: (i) 80 (387 tkts.), (ii) 794 (114 tkts.), (iii) 15,735 (7 tkts.).

The afterglow of the Asiad gold

For Shreyas, this was a much-needed victory. This campaign, away from probing eyes, would have facilitated his reintegration to progress further. The fact that he had most of his first-choice personnel around would have aided the process of refamiliarisation and put him in a good head-space

R. Kaushik

To be installed the overwhelming favourite ahead of any major sporting extravaganza is a double-edged sword. The moniker is suggestive of a formidable individual (or team) clearly more skilled, more temperamentally adjusted, and the most likely to go all the way, but it also comes with a rider. You are marked; the rest will be doubly determined to hunt you down and add a coveted scalp to their kitty.

Long before a single ball was bowled at the Asian Games, the Indian men's cricket team was fancied to come up trumps. The women too, of course, considering that they had just blazed to the Asia Cup in Dubai, sweeping everyone in front of them. Harmanpreet Kaur's intrepid bunch kept its tryst with gold in commanding fashion, brooking no opposition and flexing its not inconsiderable muscle with aplomb. Immediately thereafter, the spotlight turned to Shreyas Iyer and his lads, up against four other continental Test-playing nations who chose to put out experimental rather than full-strength outfits.

One of the talking points in the lead-up to the Asiad was why India's selectors had chosen to go with the tried and the tested. People harked back to the previous event in Hangzhou three years back, when Ruturaj Gaikwad led a second-string team to the gold medal after the final against Afghanistan was washed out, and wondered why a similar squad wasn't pieced together. For more than one reason, it is apparent.

The previous Asian Games overlapped with the 50-over World Cup hosted by India, thereby comprehensively ruling out the presence in China of the main squad. There is no gainsaying what personnel the selectors would have picked in the absence of the said overlap; that's delving into the realms of the hypothetical, which serves little purpose.

This time around too, India were involved in a three-match One-Day International series against West Indies at home; the first of the ODIs was played on September 27, a day before Shreyas' boys began their title defence in the quarterfinal against Afghanistan. While there are several players who are certainties in both white-ball formats internationally, India weren't too weakened by the absence from the 50-over set-up of Shreyas, the ODI vice-captain, and Ishan Kishan. Sure, they missed bowling spearheads Jasprit Bumrah and Axar Patel - Shubman Gill's unit conceded more than 1000 runs to the Caribbeans in the three fixtures - but what is the weight of an ODI series with little immediate import compared to an Asian Games gold medal?

Cricket authorities have worked tirelessly in ensuring the inclusion of the sport in multi-discipline events like the Asian Games and the Olympic Games. The International Cricket Council's avowed goal is to take the discipline to as many countries as possible. Having identified the 20-over format as the vehicle to drive that ambition, it has handed over memberships to a host of nations - the official T20I team rankings includes a staggering 102 countries - and conferred international status on matches involving even, say, Lesotho and Costa Rica, ranked 89th and joint-94th respectively.







Cricket authorities have worked tirelessly in ensuring the inclusion of the sport in multi-discipline events like the Asian Games and the Olympic Games. The ICC's avowed goal is to take the discipline to as many countries as possible

Perfect sense

It therefore makes perfect sense to honour their presence in these big bashes by sending out the strongest team possible under the circumstances. Perhaps Shreyas might not say so publicly, but one is pretty certain that he would cherish an Asian Games gold medal more than being on the right side of a 2-1 scoreline against West Indies in a largely meaningless ODI series which, even with the World Cup a year away, was largely bereft of context. Batathons on flat tracks that took away the joy of a contest might have appealed to the spectators but it did little to edify the sport. But then, we digress.

Weight of favouritism

Shreyas and stand-in head coach V.V.S. Laxman were aware of the weight of favouritism imposed on the side. They also had the belief and the confidence that, never mind the relative strengths of their opponents, they would be unstoppable if they played at even 90% of their potential. Even at full strength, which Afghanistan were last month when they quixotically hosted India at Delhi's Arun Jaitley Stadium, the rest of the field would have been hard pressed to stretch India. Given that Shreyas had all the big guns at his disposal, from Abhishek Sharma and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi to Sanju Samson and Kishan, and Bumrah and Axar, India had to play extraordinarily poorly and their opponents, whoever they might have been, had to play out of their skins to orchestrate an upset.

Banana skin

As their one-off T20I against Japan showcased last month, an abridged T20 game can be a banana skin. On a pitch that served as a horrible advertisement for a 5-overs-a-side affair, India huffed and puffed to a two-run victory. More than any other format, the 20-over slugfest narrows the gap between teams, and when that is reduced by 75%, the chances of a more level playing field increase exponentially.

Most pitches at the Asian Games weren't up to scratch, favouring the bowling sides to a massive degree - how the Indian and West Indian 50-over exponents would have loved that - even though the final was played on a pretty good surface that produced more 400 runs. India's overwhelming superiority was never more evident than in the semifinal against Sri Lanka when Kishan's unbeaten 80 was nearly twice as much as what the entire opposition managed. India played with flair and imagination, and without the burden of expectations and fear. A lot of credit for that should go to Laxman, as good a man-manager as any the country has been blessed with but temporarily - one hopes - lost to the coaching spectrum because of personal reasons.

Laxman has now shepherded India to successive Asian Games gold medals, even though he might not individually have anything to show for it. Were he the sort, he would clamber on to the tallest rooftop and tom-tom about his contributions. But he didn't do that when he was winning matches and shaping miracles for the country, so he is not going to embark on that journey now. In India, some people are more equal than others and that will never change, which is why Laxman's contributions will inevitably fly under the radar though as a batter, few have influenced the outcomes of Test matches more than the stylist from Hyderabad.

One of the prime tenets of Laxman's coaching philosophy is constancy and stability. Among the others is communication. During his playing career, Laxman suffered on both counts, so he is in a far better position to appreciate the significance of role clarity, of being made to feel wanted, and of being kept in the loop about developments so that no one is operating in a vacuum. Many of the players who travelled with him to Zimbabwe in July, immediately after the misadventures in Ireland and England, and to the Asian Games, have spoken in private of the positive influence of the 51-year-old and how his openness, approachability and his sense of balance and fairness have impacted them. Laxman is a firm believer in processes, but also in not rigidly sticking to them or making decisions on the fly, on a whim and a fancy. While no coach can ever be accused of winning or losing matches, it is undeniable that the environment they fashion within the changing room plays a massive part in how the wards approach the game. On that count, Laxman has few equals.

Lifting morale

For Shreyas, this was a much-needed victory. Brought back to the T20I fold after two and a half years and installed as the captain with India deciding to move on from Suryakumar Yadav - World Cup-winning skipper but short on runs - he must have felt the heat after surrendering 0-2 to Ireland and 0-4 to England in his first two assignments. The clean sweep against Afghanistan last month must have lifted his morale, but this campaign, away from probing eyes, would have facilitated his reintegration to progress further. The fact that he had most of his first-choice personnel around would have aided the process of refamiliarisation and put him in a good headspace, imperative because he is the designated ODI vice-captain and will be expected to play a big part with the bat at No. 4 in the lead-up to and during the World Cup.

Shreyas knows he has a great bunch to work with. He will have taken particular joy in the sustained good form of Kishan, for whom 2026 has heralded a breathtaking second coming, and the continued development as a batter, an individual and leader of Tilak Varma, his T20I deputy. Like he had in the Asia Cup final in Dubai in September last year when he steered India past Pakistan in a tense run-chase, the left-hander from Hyderabad upped his game against the old foe in the title clash on Saturday, his unbeaten 51, off just 22 deliveries, pushing the total past 200 and out of reach of a spirited Pakistan well served by the exciting Hasan Nawaz.

Tilak was batting at No. 6, somewhat below his normal and preferred position because India stacked up their batting even if it meant they were a bowler light. He walked in with just 41 deliveries left in the innings and made a spectacular impact, showing how far he has come in international cricket. Just 23 months back, in South Africa towards the end of 2024, he sought to occupy the No. 3 position that Suryakumar had made his own. When the skipper acquiesced, Tilak expressed his thanks with two hundreds in three nights, in Centurion and adjacent Johannesburg respectively. Now, he doesn't need the No. 3 position, which puts him in a position to play more balls than anyone else but the two openers, to unfurl his repertoire and shape the destination of 20-over games, which is exactly the kind of graph one would expect of a 23-year-old who is desperate to be a permanent for the country across formats.

Already, the Asian Games adventure is a thing of the past, what with the five-match T20I series against West Indies due to begin in Lucknow on Tuesday. A vast chunk of those who travelled to Japan will line up in the administrative and legislative capital of Uttar Pradesh, as a new challenge beckons. West Indies have shown in the ODIs that they are no pushovers and India will have their work cut out. And while they know that it doesn't guarantee victory, Shreyas and his boys will still bask in the afterglow of an Asian Games gold medal. Whyever not?

THE GIST

- Shreyas and stand-in head coach Laxman had the belief and the confidence that, never mind the relative strengths of their opponents, they would be unstoppable if they played at even 90% of their potential
- One of the prime tenets of Laxman's coaching philosophy is constancy and stability. Among the others is communication. Many of the players who travelled with him to Zimbabwe in July, immediately after the misadventures in Ireland and England, and to the Asian Games, have spoken in private of the positive influence of the 51-year-old
- Shreyas will have taken particular joy in the sustained good form of Kishan, for whom 2026 has heralded a breathtaking second coming, and the continued development as a batter, an individual and leader of Tilak, his deputy



Letting the wind flow freely is the secret to cooling our cities

Slower winds can affect how people experience heat; normally, the air immediately above the ground becomes saturated with water vapour due to evaporation; when winds blow faster, the saturated air is replaced with drier air; slower winds, however, also limit evaporation

Sambavi Parthasarathy
CHENNAI

India's cities are seeing buildings getting taller and populations becoming more dense. The hotter days in many of these cities also come with high humidity, and can make the experience of heat seem unforgiving. One of the reasons is often a perceived lack of winds, which often have to make their way through the nooks and crannies of crowded streets before reaching a window.

Slower winds can affect how people experience heat. Normally, the air immediately above the ground becomes saturated with water vapour due to evaporation. When winds blow faster, the saturated air is replaced with drier air. Slower winds, however, also limit evaporation.

Wind speed near the ground has been dropping worldwide, in a phenomenon called terrestrial stilling, since the 1980s.



A view of the South Mumbai skyline in 2024. When winds slam into high-rise buildings, they can be forced downwards along the structures in a phenomenon called the downdraught effect. DRONE MASTER/UNSPLASH

Disrupted flow

"Multiple factors lead to reduced wind speed specifically in the near surface level," according to Amruthraj M.N., a consultant with the Sustainable Energy Lab at the Indian Institute for Human Settlements (IIHS), Bengaluru.

"When we say surface level, it's typically around 10 m from the floor, where a lot of pedestrians move around the city and that's the place where typically there's reduced wind speed that has been seen over a few decades."

Aaron Serre, a meteorologist and recent graduate in atmospheric science from the University of Alabama in Huntsville, U.S., said dense urban infrastructure and high-rise buildings tend to disrupt wind flow, create turbulence, and increase surface friction, resulting in slower winds near the surface.

He also said the loss of vegetation and the introduction of asphalt and concrete instead drastically reduce evapotranspiration, intensifying the urban heat island effect.

"Urbanisation and buildings ... taking into account the analysis of wind speeds across these cities, can be built to ensure that there is wind flow at that level," Mr. Amruthraj noted. "Unfortunately, not a lot of people follow that approach."

He added that many structures like higher compound walls and podiums restrict wind flow in previously defined wind corridors.

Downdraught effect

India's metropolitan cities are replete with high compound walls, podiums, and high-rise buildings of varying heights, often clumped together without adequate spacing, affecting the wind's speed – rougher surfaces have a greater slowing effect – and direction.

When a wind's flow is interrupted by tall buildings, it can instead be funnelled through narrow spaces, where it accelerates and builds up into a gust before reaching the pedestrians walking around the buildings. This phenomenon is called the Venturi effect and has been observed in London and Jaipur, among other cities.

As well, when winds slam into high-rise buildings, they can be forced downwards along the structures in a phenomenon called the downdraught effect, which further pushes the wind lower down into stronger gusts.

However, Prasad Vaidya, a senior adviser at IIHS and lead of its Sustainable Energy Lab, said that while there have been studies showing stilling is underway, there are no specific studies that compare rural versus urban stilling to reveal the impact of urbanisation.

He also said wind speeds are changing even as cities are warming, losing trees, and losing water bodies – and it has been hard to establish causal relationships between them.

'Wind record'

Depending on their geometry, other physical characteristics, and their environs, tall buildings can also create pockets sheltered from winds along the streets surrounding them. If the people there are also experiencing an urban heat island, the lack of wind may distress them further. "While there are no specific studies that correlate it," Mr. Vaidya said, "there is enough experience to show that higher building forms that are unplanned will contribute to [lower] wind speeds and additional heat stress."

"We need to build a homogenised wind record firstly because, right now, the placement of an anemometer may be inconsistent," Yugank Goyal, associate professor and chair at the J.S.W. School of Public Policy at IIM Ahmedabad, said. (An anemometer is a device to measure wind speed.)

Slower winds can also take more time to disperse air pollution. "We have done some [computational fluid dynamics] simulations. What we found is that maintaining good air movement through a breezeway or corridor is not easy, because small changes in building shape ... can actually cause eddies and swirls and reduce the wind speed through the length of the breezeway," Mr. Vaidya said.

Computational fluid dynamics is a computer-based modelling technique to help simulate and analyse the behaviour of fluids in different conditions.

In other words, "the reality is that cities are so complex that little movements – somebody putting out a window or canopies – are going to affect the wind's movement."

'City ventilation maps'

Mr. Amruthraj said that while research is ongoing on how wind flows through cities, computational fluid dynamics modelling of how buildings' shapes, wind corridors, open spaces, and other features affect wind speeds is not routinely incorporated into urban design and planning.

One reason is computational fluid dynamics is expensive to implement. The computer simulation models and tracks motions within a turbulent fluid going from small to large, from fleeting to long-lived. To resolve them all, the simulation needs increasingly fine spatial grids and correspondingly shorter time-steps. As a result, the total computational cost of resolving a turbulent flow scales roughly as the cube of the Reynolds number, a number measuring the amount of turbulence.

Mr. Vaidya cited assessments by the governments of Stuttgart, Seoul, and Hong Kong to improve city-wide ventilation, and said, "Cities like Chennai and Mumbai can actually do something similar, but we haven't seen specific wind-related studies tied to heat and pollution happening in India, as much as we would like to see them."

According to him, "part of the reason is that these studies require [fluid dynamics] simulations, which are extremely computer-intensive and require expertise." "We need to use satellite imagery to evaluate each city's changing form," Dr. Goyal added. "We could potentially create city ventilation maps and connect all this to master plans."

sambavi.p@thehindu.co.in

THE GIST

- Wind speed near the ground has been dropping worldwide, in a phenomenon called terrestrial stilling, since the 1980s
- India's metropolitan cities are replete with high compound walls, podiums, and high-rise buildings of varying heights, often clumped together without adequate spacing, affecting the wind's speed — rougher surfaces have a greater slowing effect — and direction
- When a wind's flow is interrupted by tall buildings, it can instead be funnelled through narrow spaces, where it accelerates and builds up into a gust before reaching the pedestrians walking around the buildings
- This phenomenon is called the Venturi effect and has been observed in London and Jaipur, among other cities

BIG SHOT



People watch a shark nicknamed 'Bukangi' swimming in a canal at the North Port in Busan, South Korea, on Friday. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Tuvalu: Barely above water

Agence France-Presse

When leaders visit the coral atolls that form the Pacific nation of Tuvalu on October 5, they will find a once-vibrant ecosystem wiped out due to climate change. The pre-COP gathering, hosted by Fiji ahead of the annual UN climate conference in Turkey, has been billed as the Pacific's chance to show the world first-hand the damage wrought by climate change in the vast ocean region.

Leaders are also set to spend a day on low-lying Tuvalu, an atoll over 800 km north of Fiji. Here, scientists say, a marine heatwave in 2024 wiped out an estimated 99.9% of the coral that built the Tuvalu islands.

"The very system that created the islands has died. It wasn't pollution. It wasn't overfishing. Just a direct result from climate change," marine biologist Austin Bowden-Kerby, who visited last year and documented the devastation, said.

Thanks to rising sea levels, scientists fear the entire archipelago could be unliveable by the end of the century.

Local scientist Rajneel Singh said climate change has already affected the waters that have long sustained Tuvalu's population of 10,600. "Elders used to fish for red snappers and other things," he said. "It's no longer frequent in the catch. And the size of the fish has been reduced as well."

Scientists presented their findings to Tuvalu's fisheries minister in December last year and were met with disbelief. "They didn't know," Singh said of the meeting. "It was very difficult for him, to realise, to see photos and to listen about the situation."



Pacific Ocean waves hit the coast of Funafuti Atoll in Tuvalu on February 19, 2004. When leaders visit the coral atolls that form the Pacific nation of Tuvalu next week, they will find a once-vibrant ecosystem wiped out by climate change. AFP

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Mine-contaminated land acquired by India-backed project

1.98 in lakh sq. m. Nearly 198,000 square metres of mine-contaminated land in Cambodia's Koh Kong province has been cleared and handed over to the local community under India's Quick Impact Project, benefiting around 134 families, according to authorities and reports. PTI

Myanmar nationals repatriated from Malaysia

1,500 Nearly 1,500 Myanmar nationals who were sent back from Malaysia arrived in the country's largest city on Sunday, despite warnings from the United Nations refugee agency and rights groups that conditions for return remain unsafe. PTI

'Mostly Chinese' workers arrested by Philippines

244 Philippines authorities arrested more than 200 "mostly Chinese" foreign workers during a crackdown on illegal online gaming operators. The government is investigating possible human trafficking-related offences by a number of those arrested. AFP

Sites in Delhi approved by the Ministry for EV charging infra

382 Under the Delhi EV Policy, notified on June 30, all 382 sites were reassessed over the past three months for segment-wise deployment, with sites categorised separately for two-wheelers, three-wheelers and four-wheelers, Delhi Power Minister said on Sunday. PTI

Vote share of pro-Ukraine coalition which won Latvia polls

35 in per cent. Latvian lawmakers on Sunday planned to begin negotiations to form a new government following a parliamentary election in which pro-Ukraine Prime Minister Andris Kulbergs's four-party coalition emerged with 35% of the vote. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us facebook.com/thehindu X.com/the_hindu instagram.com/the_hindu

Does a visa guarantee entry into India?

Why was Turkmenistan citizen denied entry? What grounds did she cite in challenging the denial? What did the Centre argue about a foreigner's right to enter? Why did the court reject her Article 14 argument? What does the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 say? What have the Supreme Court's earlier rulings said?

EXPLAINER

Rizmi Lia M.

The story so far:

The Delhi High Court has held that possession of a valid visa does not give a foreign national an inherent or legally enforceable right to enter India.

Justice Amit Mahajan was hearing a petition filed by a Turkmenistan citizen who was stopped at the Indira Gandhi International Airport in New Delhi despite holding a valid business visa. She had arrived in India on March 25 on the same flight as her husband, who was permitted to enter the country. But she had to return to Turkmenistan the same day.

The petitioner sought a written order explaining why she had been denied entry and also sought permission to enter India with her business visa. The court dismissed the petition on September 30, holding that there is no inherent or legally enforceable right of a foreign national to enter India.

What was the case about?

The petitioner argued that she had a valid passport and business visa issued by the Indian Embassy in Ashgabat, Turkmenistan.

She contended that she was denied entry without being given reasons, while her husband, who had travelled with her and held a visa of the same category, was allowed into India.

She therefore challenged the action on two grounds: first, that the authorities had not provided reasons for refusing her entry; and second, that allowing her husband to enter while denying her entry amounted to discriminatory treatment in violation of Articles 14 and 21 of the Constitution.

The Centre, however, argued that a foreign national does not acquire an indefeasible right to enter India merely because a valid visa has been issued. According to the government, grant of a visa and permission to enter India are two distinct matters and entry remains subject to the immigration law and the powers of the competent authorities.



GETTY IMAGES

The authorities also told the court that "adverse inputs" had been received concerning the petitioner and that the decision was taken in the interest of national security and public order. The court examined material placed by the government in a sealed cover.

The material referred to discrepancies in the petitioner's personal details, the absence of a business card or invitation letter, and the lack of details about the business or company with which she was associated. The court also noted her travel history on medical and business visas.

What did the court rule?

The court held that "there is no inherent or legally enforceable right of a foreign national to seek entry into India".

It noted that issuance of a visa, refusal of entry and immigration clearance are sovereign functions of the State, involving considerations such as national security, foreign policy and administrative discretion. The court drew a distinction between satisfying the requirements for obtaining a visa and actually being admitted into the country. The court noted that "the statutory framework, therefore, does not treat the possession of a visa as creating an absolute and unconditional right of admission into India".

As for the Article 14 argument, the court said that the mere fact that the petitioner's husband was allowed to enter did not establish that the two were similarly situated in all respects. The authorities had stated that "adverse inputs" specifically concerned the petitioner.

Thus, the court held that since the petitioner could not establish infringement of a legally enforceable right, there was no basis for issuing a writ under Article 226. The petition was dismissed.

What is the law behind this?

The key legislation in the judgment is the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, which now governs the legal framework concerning foreigners in India.

Section 3 of the 2025 Act requires a foreigner seeking to enter India to possess a valid passport or travel document and a valid visa.

However, no foreigner shall be allowed to enter into or stay in India if he is found inadmissible to do so on account of a threat to national security, sovereignty and integrity of India, relations with a foreign State or public health or on such other grounds.

Section 3 of the Foreigners Act, 1946 (now repealed) as well as Section 7 of the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025 authorises the Central government to make provisions, either generally or with respect to all foreigners, for prohibiting, regulating or restricting the entry of foreigners into India or their departure therefrom or their presence or continued presence therein. The respondent authorities can therefore, or rather are entitled to, take into consideration all the relevant factors that may warrant scrutiny.

An examination by the Immigration Officer of the passport, travel document and visa of a foreigner at the stage of entry empowers the Immigration Officer to require such information as may be necessary and appropriate. The statutory framework, therefore, does not treat the possession of a visa as creating an absolute and unconditional right of admission into India.

The judgment majorly relied on two Supreme Court decisions. In *Hans Muller of Nurenburg v Superintendent, Presidency Jail* (1955) the Supreme Court held that the Foreigners Act, 1946, gave the Central government broad discretion in relation to foreigners, including the power to expel them.

Later, in *Louis De Raedt v. Union of India*(1991), the Supreme Court held that a foreigner's fundamental rights are confined to Article 21's protection of life and personal liberty. The right to reside and settle in India under Article 19(1)(e) is available only to citizens.

The court held that where the petitioner could not establish infringement of a legally enforceable right to enter India, there was no basis for issuing a writ directing the authorities to admit her.

THE GIST

- The Delhi High Court holds that a valid visa does not give a foreign national an inherent or legally enforceable right to enter India, and that entry remains subject to immigration laws and the powers of competent authorities
- The court upholds the denial of entry to a Turkmenistan citizen despite her valid business visa, citing 'adverse inputs' concerning her and rejecting her claim that the decision was discriminatory because her husband was allowed to enter
- The judgment relies on the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025, and earlier Supreme Court rulings to hold that the State has broad powers over the entry and presence of foreigners in India

Why are students across France blockading schools?

When did the protest begin? How has the government responded to the protest?

Nivedita S.

The story so far:

Across France, teenagers have been using trash cans and furniture to stage blockades (*blocus* in French) at the entrances of lycées or high schools in protest over poor conditions in schools. Over 5,000 people, mostly students, have been detained so far, including 1,949 people on October 1 alone.

When did the protest begin?

In mid-September, small protests began in lycées in the suburbs of Paris and spread rapidly across the country after word spread on social media. Lycées are upper secondary schools attended by students from the ages of 15 to 18. Out of the 3,700 lycées in the country, 1,027 have been affected, according to a release by the Interior Ministry. University students have also joined the protests, with blockades staged across 30 campuses.

The protests gained momentum and coincided with the larger public workers' protests over the planned budget cuts by the Emmanuel Macron government before the next year's presidential election. *AFP* reported that in the draft 2027 budget Bill, the government has planned to cut expenditure by €43 billion to reduce the deficit to 5%. Teachers, particularly from primary schools, and school staff have also joined the protest demanding better pay.

What are students protesting for?

Students are protesting over the poor condition of schools, dilapidated buildings, long hours, lack of teachers, overpacked classrooms, and schedules. Students complained of broken toilets and rodents on school premises. They have also been demanding equity funding, as schools in lower-income areas have been receiving considerably less funding compared to the higher-income areas.

Their main demands include more funds to be allocated for improving school infrastructure, reduced hours, and hiring more teachers.

France experienced one of the hottest summers this year, with heatwaves pushing temperatures above 40 degrees Celsius in several regions. This has been particularly grueling for students who are in classrooms with over 30 people, poor insulation, and no air conditioning for over nine hours a day. This has also been a major grievance that the students want to be addressed through the protest.

Student unions are calling for a national day of demonstrations on Tuesday.

How has the government responded to the protest?

Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu convened a crisis meeting on October 1 and cancelled Ministers' trips to manage the protests. The Prime Minister's Office warned of 'urban violence' by demonstrators and shifted online classes for many schools.

On September 30, around 85 police officers and gendarmes were injured in the clashes. Trash cans were set on fire, and projectiles were also thrown at schools by protesters. Two schools in Nantes and Le Havre were set on fire by the protesters, and a teacher was reportedly doused in petrol. Municipal tram lines were halted by the authorities. The riot police used less lethal crowd control measures like tear gas and rubber bullets, causing injuries to dozens of protesters, which have drawn criticism from the opposition.

Interior Minister Laurent Nuñez noted the escalation of the movement and said "troublemakers" were going to different schools to incite violence. He has asked the public to limit travel and deployed more security forces to maintain law and order.

The government, citing intelligence sources, has accused the far-left party La France Insoumise (LFI) of encouraging the protests and causing public disorder. LFI's presidential candidate Jean-Luc Mélenchon said that the party backs the "non-violent methods of struggle by the students" and accused the government of turning the issues raised by the students into a political battle.

Similar protests have also started in neighbouring Belgium, with authorities ordering schools to be closed in Liège on October 2, according to local media.

THE GIST

- Students across France are blockading schools over poor infrastructure, overcrowded classrooms, long hours, teacher shortages and inadequate funding, with the protests spreading from lycées to universities amid wider opposition to planned government spending cuts
- The protests have escalated into clashes and violence, with thousands detained. The government has deployed additional security forces and warned of further unrest, while opposition parties have criticised the police response

CACHE



U.S. President Donald Trump, with U.S. House Speaker Mike Johnson, Nvidia President Jensen Huang, OpenAI President Greg Brockman, SpaceX AI founder and CEO Elon Musk, and other tech leaders. REUTERS

What does Trump's AI accord mean for tech companies?

The AI accord signed by leading U.S. tech companies outlines four safety measures, including internal controls, safety teams, external audits and independent board oversight, but is not legally binding and carries no penalties

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far:

On September 29, U.S. President Donald Trump stood surrounded by the leaders of American AI giants. He announced that they had come together and signed something akin to a constitution.

The page-long document, titled 'White House Accord and the Joint Commitment on Frontier Responsibilities', was an agreement on AI safety commitments by tech companies that are developing frontier models. The accord misspelled "United States"; an error that was widely circulated on the internet.

What is U.S. President Trump's AI accord?

The pact stresses the need for tech companies to build safe AI products and foster public trust. It outlines four steps to make it happen, starting with robust internal controls to prevent unintended AI hacking, developing an internal team to manage safety operations and resolutions at the company, partnering with an independent external auditor for assessments, and designating an independent committee of the board of directors to address reports.

The document noted that "participating companies will meet regularly to establish standards and best practices to improve the safety of their systems."

The tech leaders who signed the AI accord were Google CEO Sundar Pichai, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei, Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg, OpenAI Co-founder/President Greg Brockman, XAI CEO Elon Musk, and Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang.

A notable omission was Microsoft, even though CEO Satya Nadella was included in a luncheon with the U.S. President, alongside other tech leaders.

Several technologists who signed the agreement shared their thoughts on AI regulation with Mr. Trump and the press. Nvidia's Huang insisted that there was no conflict amongst innovation, technology, and safety. By contrast, Anthropic's Amodei highlighted that the technology had very real risks, but called for collaboration nonetheless.

Some tech leaders took to social media to share their perspectives. Google's Pichai posted on X that the company is "focused on building the right way" and releasing models "only after they've been thoroughly reviewed."

Meta's Zuckerberg posted that leaders of every major American AI company "committed to implementing robust internal controls and multiple layers of audits and reviews" to boost people's trust in the technology these firms are building.

Critics pointed out that the accord lacks any penalty clause in the case of potential violations of the agreement.

Is the AI accord binding?

Not really. The very first sentence of the AI accord notes that "every company is responsible for developing its own technology safely and in a way that builds trust with customers and the public."

The White House's AI accord largely serves as a show of unity amongst AI companies and the President of the United States

Mr. Trump referred to the agreement as being "morally binding," and called it a "form of protection."

In other words, companies are being left to police themselves, apart from linking up with an external auditor. These are by no means groundbreaking regulations or directives. Rather, they are highly generalised guidelines and many were already in place.

The AI accord further noted that "over time, it may make sense to codify these steps into laws or regulations."

At the present moment, the four specified controls are not legally enforceable or mandated; as per the wording of the AI accord, the White House merely "believe[d]" that each company should implement the four listed audits.

The White House noted that implementing controls and audits was "critical" for a safe future and the companies that had signed the document were committed to their actions.

What will be the effect of the AI accord?

The White House's AI accord largely serves as a show of unity amongst AI companies and the President of the United States.

This comes in the face of criticism from lawmakers across the European Union and Australia, who seek to regulate built-in-America AI models by implementing more guardrails to protect user privacy and children's mental health.

There is also mounting backlash over AI agents "going rogue" and attempting to hack secure online platforms. Anthropic, OpenAI, and now Google have been named after their models were identified.

In late September, Australian Prime Minister Anthony Albanese reported that OpenAI's AI agent had hacked into the country's healthcare platform this June, but the incident was not formally reported until September 10.

The Australian PM confirmed he had taken OpenAI CEO Sam Altman to task over the delayed report, adding that the investigations were ongoing and promising there would be legal consequences.

The U.S. President is also shaping the way the world discusses AI. Mr. Trump on September 29 passed an executive order to inaugurate the era of "super intelligence," calling on the executive branch of his administration to use this term and "SI," instead of "Artificial Intelligence" and "AI."

This was to better capture the capabilities of the technology, according to him.

U.S. diplomats have been instructed to make the change in their communications, reported AP.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Test yourself on the career of the legendary director Singeetham Srinivasa Rao who passed away on October 3

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1
Singeetham began his career as an assistant to which esteemed director working on noted Telugu classics such as '*Mayabazaar*' and '*Jagadeka Veeruni Katha*'?

QUESTION 2
The critically acclaimed '*Dikkatra Parvathi*' won the National Film Award for Best Feature Film in Tamil in 1974. On which Bharat Ratna recipient's literary work was it based?

QUESTION 3
Singeetham had the honour of directing Rajkumar's 200th and Kamal Haasan's 100th film. Name the flicks.

QUESTION 4
Of his 61 films, what is special about these four: '*Bhagyada Lakshmi Baramma*', '*Samyuktha*', '*Ghatothkach*' and '*Welcome Obama*'?

QUESTION 5
Name the 1985 biographical dance film based on the life of Sudha Chandran, who lost her leg due to an accident.

QUESTION 6
He was an executive director of which National Award-winning 1970 film based on U.R. Ananthamurthy's book and starring Girish Karnad?

QUESTION 7
He is credited with creating the first dialogue-less feature film in 1987. Name the National Award-winning black comedy.

QUESTION 8
The famous song sequence '*Sundari Neeyum*' from '*Michael Madhana Kama Rajan*' was visualised differently. How?

QUESTION 9
A master of innovation, what is special about his final work '*Sing Geetham*', released earlier this year?



Visual Question:
This is a screengrab of Singeetham making a cameo with a bioscope to introduce a film with a song. Name the film.

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. If Raliyatbehn was his sister, who were the two brothers? **Ans: Laxmidas, Karsandas**
2. It is said that when he embarked for England, Gandhiji carried a letter of introduction to a cricketer. Name this legend. **Ans: K.S. Ranjitsinhji**
3. An incident that took place on the night of June 7, 1893, acted as a catalyst for Gandhiji to fight against race. **Ans: He was thrown out at the Pietermaritzburg station even though he had a valid FC ticket**
4. Name the main 'ashrams' set up by Gandhiji in South Africa. **Ans: Phoenix Settlement and Tolstoy Farm**
5. Gandhiji returned to India for good on January 9, 1915. How is the date commemorated now? **Ans: Pravasiya Bharat Diwas**
6. Who was responsible for giving Mohandas Gandhi the title 'Mahatma', and who first referred to him as 'Rashtriyapitha'? **Ans: 'Gurudev' Rabindranath Tagore and 'Netaji' Subhas Chandra Bose**
7. Who paid this tribute to Gandhiji: "Generations to come will scarce believe that such a one as this ever in flesh and blood walked upon this earth"? **Ans: Albert Einstein**
Visual: Name the gentleman. **Ans: Charlie Chaplin**
Early Birds: K.N. Viswanathan | Sandeep Radhakrishnan | Sudhir Thapa | Piyali Tuli | Haridas Pal

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in



KNOW YOUR ENGLISH

The school team bested its rivals in final

They reached the fag end of the celebrations

S. Upendran

"Congratulations! I heard you guys won the tournament. Were you the only team participating? I can't imagine..."

"Very funny! In all, there were 32 teams. We bested the five teams we had to play. We...."

"Bested five teams? What are you talking about? How can..."

"When you say that you 'bested' someone, what you mean is that you defeated the individual in a competition or fight."

"The word can also be used in the context of a game, I suppose?"

"Yes, it certainly can! My sister and I played a game of chess. She bested me quite convincingly."

"How about this example? You'll have to put in a lot more effort if you want to best Sowmya in the next round."

"It's no shame to be bested by the best team in the tournament."

"That's true! Since we're talking about sports, did you watch the Laver Cup over the weekend?"

"I caught the fag end of the trophy presentation."

"Fag end? Is it a new expression?"

"No, it's not! It's been around for some time. When you say that you were present for the fag end of the event, what you're suggesting..."

"You probably mean you walked in when the event had nearly ended. You were there for the last part."

"But the expression 'fag end' carries with it a negative meaning as well. The 'fag end' of something is the most boring part of something."

"In other words, when you talk about the fag end of an event, you're talking about the worst part of the event."

"That's right! It's the final and worst part of an event. Here's an example. It had been a long day, and the Chairman was in no hurry to make a decision at the fag end of the day. We decided to meet early the next morning."

"By the time the speaker reached the fag end of his talk, some of the members in the audience had already fallen asleep."

"I like to be early for everything. Unlike some people, I hate to walk in at the fag end of a talk. I think that's plain rude."

"If you ask me, there are some events when it's better to arrive late than early."

"Really? Like what? A political rally?"

"I've got better things to do than attend a political rally. No, I was thinking about arriving on time for a wedding reception."

"Based on my experience, if you arrive on time for a reception, you're likely to be the only one in the hall. You won't find anybody else. Not even the bride and groom."

"That's true! The couple and their parents will be at the beauty salon making themselves presentable. The best thing to do would be to leave and return back after some time."

"Why do you say 'return back'?"

"In other words, the word 'return' means 'to come back'."

"Exactly! The word 'back' is redundant or unnecessary. Here's an example. The guests returned later than expected."

"After the meeting with the client, I'll be going home. I will not be returning to office."

"That's an excellent example. No point in returning to this place at the fag end of the day."

upendrankye@gmail.com

Word of the day

Banal:
repeated too often; overfamiliar through overuse

Synonyms: boring, bland, insipid, dull, tiring

Usage: *She was tired of hearing the same banal advice.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/banal

International Phonetic Alphabet: /bəna:l/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'